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PLACEMENTS

BTC 2026

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REAL INTERVIEW
QUESTIONS



WHAT ACTUALLY
WORKED



PM FRAMEWORKS
& PLAYBOOKS



LEARNING
PATHWAYS



NEGOTIATION
LESSONS

YOUR PLAYBOOK
FOR PM INTERVIEWS.

LEARN. GET BETTER.
CRACK IT.



PREPARE



PRACTICE



BUILD



POLISH



CRACK



OUR BATCH.
YOUR ADVANTAGE.



Learn from
our journey.



Use our
insights.



Do better
than we did.

FOREWORD

Hey Co'27,

Core terms are already over, and the next phase in your ISB journey is likely to be one of the more intense parts of it. Over the coming months, campus may occasionally feel like a strange mix of anxiety, FOMO, interview prep, and people becoming very interested in each other's shortlist updates.

But alongside all of that, you will also see what makes ISB special: friends helping each other, people sharing notes, alumni stepping forward to review resumes, take mock interviews, and classmates genuinely rooting for one another.

This handbook is a culmination of our experiences and those shared by alumni from previous batches. We hope it helps make the path to PM roles a little clearer and saves you from having to discover every lesson the hard way.

Our placement season had its wins, surprises, disappointments, and the occasional interview that made us question every life decision that led us there. Some of us got what we were aiming for, some got something even better, and some had a very different outcome. Through it all, we learnt a lot about PM interviews, companies, ourselves, and, importantly, what is actually within our control.

This handbook is meant to be a structured reference for your preparation and D-day. We have added a few sections beyond earlier versions, covering product prototyping, AI-based interview questions, negotiation, and B2B interviews.

That said, please don't treat this handbook as something to be completed cover to cover and then declare yourself interview-ready. Your real preparation will come from practising cases. On D-day, you will get only a handful of opportunities to perform, so the objective is to make those few attempts count. Practise enough to identify your weak areas, sharpen your strengths, become comfortable with ambiguity, and learn to think clearly even when someone is staring at you waiting for an answer.

And one practical reminder: placement season is important, but it is still a few months of your life. Eat properly, sleep when you can, keep moving, and don't let the campus atmosphere convince you that every interview result is a referendum on your intelligence.

We hope this helps. Go prepare well, help each other, and make the most of the process.

Sincerely,
BTC Co'26

MEET BTC CORE Co'26



Hyderabad

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GUIDE TO PLACEMENT SEASON

A common mistake is to wait too long before starting to prepare for placements. This is entirely avoidable. Although the year at ISB can be intense and challenging, it is immensely helpful to begin preparation as early as possible. By preparation, we don't mean you should start practising mock interviews from day one. However, there are other activities you can do to get a head start.

Time to Go for Placements	Activities you Should Focus On
3-5 Months	Attending BTC sessions to get an overview of the different kinds of product management roles, assessing the skills needed etc. - This helps you understand the world of Product Management from a job perspective. - It also helps you pick up on the terminologies and buzzwords that PMs use, to sound more relatable in interviews. - There are dedicated placements focused BTC sessions which help you prepare for core interview topics. - Finally, it helps you connect with alumni, which can be useful later during placements and in your career. Trying out new Apps: In your free time, you can install Apps from different sectors - ecommerce, gaming, productivity, etc and just browse through the features. Ask yourself why a particular feature exists, how you can improve it, etc. - Helps build product sense - Helps generate ideas for product design questions (helpful later) Listening to PM Podcasts (recommendation: Lenny's) Case Competitions: Needless to say, try to participate in product-related case competitions, especially if you do not have product experience. - Helps build confidence in product management - Helps build good resume pointers - Helps in getting your deck formats ready for placement season. Many companies ask for decks as an assessment criterion.
2-3 Months	Case competitions (Contd.) Resume building - Download resumes of past batches from KMP to get an

	idea of how the resume is supposed to be formatted. Create version 1 of the resume in this format. Get it peer reviewed before getting it reviewed by alumni. b. BTC and CAPD will help with alumni mapping. Make the most of this opportunity to get multiple resume reviews. Prefer to get the point of view of at least 2 alums. c. You may need to prepare separate resumes for consulting, product, marketing, etc. Make sure you devote enough time to this activity.
0-1.5 Months	1. Interview Prep - Form a case group with fellow product enthusiasts, create a timetable to devote enough time to tackle each interview question type. a. Pair up and practice away. Use resources like Exponent, PM Exercises, YouTube, BTC Handbook to come up with interview questions. Stick to 1 or 2 resources rather than being overwhelmed by multiple resources.

LEARNING RESOURCES

It's the end of August; if you are starting your PM prep now, don't try to do everything on this list. Here's what matters right now:

- **Build a daily reading habit (45 mins/day).** This is the single highest-leverage thing you can do at this stage. Read news/product articles daily; The Ken, Inc42, TechCrunch, Growth Design, Lenny's Newsletter (free posts) all work. Consistency matters more than volume.
- **Read BTC Handbook.** It's the most ISB-specific, interview-relevant resource you have. Prioritize it over external books for now.
- **Start watching Exponent videos.** Best return on time for building interview vocabulary and seeing how real answers are structured.
- **Form Your Case Prep Group:** Now is also a good time to form your case prep group and start practising cases (go slow at first); PM exercises & Exponent are good places to get practice questions from along with this handbook.

Everything else on this page, the books, the other YouTube channels, the Twitter accounts, the full product-teardown table, is genuinely useful, and worth going through **if and when you have spare time**. But given where the placement timeline stands, the three things above should be your default daily habit, not the full list

Books

Must-Read: These will help you directly in your placement prep, at this point in time (September onwards, these two resources will be your go to)

- This BTC Handbook
- IIMA Product Case Book (Good for practising cases and using the sample answers as a baseline. In an actual interview, however, your answers should be more thoughtfully structured, well-rounded, and with deeper user empathy than the ones provided here)

Good to Read: These will help you develop a perspective on real-world product thinking and make for good conversation pieces in an interview. Reading these should only be done when you have plenty of time to read and digest the content.

- Tech Simplified by Deepak Singh
- Decode and Conquer by Lewis C. Lin
- The Product Manager Interview: 164 Actual Questions and Answers by Lewis Lin
- Cracking the PM Interview by Jackie Bavaro
- Swipe to Unlock
- Hooked by Nir Eyal

YouTube Channels

- Exponent
- StellarPeers
- PMExercises
- Dianna Yau
- Aakash Gupta (very active on ai pm interview prep)

Products to Read Up On

This is a list of popular products per industry. It is recommended to do a full product teardown/case study/high-level analysis (based on time at hand) on at least one product per industry before your interviews.

Industry	Products
Fintech / Payments	Razorpay, PhonePe, Google Pay, Paytm, WhatsApp Pay
Investments	Groww, Zerodha, Smallcase
Food Delivery	Zomato, Swiggy, Magicpin
Grocery Delivery	Swiggy Instamart, Big Basket, Amazon Fresh, Zepto
Ride Sharing	Uber, Ola, Rapido
E-Commerce	Amazon, Flipkart, Myntra
Social Media	Instagram, Threads, Facebook, Twitter, Snapchat
SuperApp	WeChat, Paytm
Cloud Computing	Amazon Web Services (AWS), Google Cloud, Microsoft Azure
Over-the-top (OTT)	Netflix, Amazon Prime, JioHotstar
Messaging / Comm.	WhatsApp, Messenger, Telegram, Gmail

Ad-supported Media	YouTube, Spotify, Twitch, Moj
Gaming	Zynga
Analytics	Thoughtspot, Amplitude
Ad Tech	InMobi, Media.Net, Meta, Google

Twitter/X Accounts to Follow

It's a great place to follow product leaders.

- **Shreyas Doshi (@shreyas)**: Product leader, ex-Stripe, Google.
- **Aakash Gupta (@aakashg0)**: AI PM content, very current
- **Hiten Shah (@hnshah)**: Founder, KISSMetrics.
- **Ryan Hoover (@rrhoover)**: Founder of Product Hunt.
- **Lenny Rachitsky (@lennysan)**: Author of a popular PM newsletter.
- **Teresa Torres (@ttorres)**: Talks about user research and product leadership.
- **Arindam Paul (@arindam_paul)**: Founder, Atomberg fans. Practical tips on marketplaces, growth, marketing.
- **Deepak Singh (@deepak_singh)**: Author, Tech Simplified.
- **Hardik Pandya (@hpandya)**: Head of design, Unacademy.

Websites

- **Growth.design**: Case studies on growth strategies.
- **theKen**: Deep dives and new into products
- **techcrunch.com**: Latest happenings in the tech world.
- **inc42.com**: TechCrunch for India.
- **a16z.com**: Blog of a prominent tech VC.
- **stratechery.com**: Analysis of the strategy and business side of technology.
- **lennysnewsletter.com**: Best of Lenny's newsletter.

Note: A few of these blogs, such as **Stratechery** and **Lenny's Newsletter**, operate under a paywall. While free articles are accessible, a group membership can be considered by either the BTC club or your preparation group if there is sufficient consensus.

CASE COMPETITIONS & PRE-INTERVIEW CASES

What this chapter covers. How to approach case work as a process: choosing competitions, working in a team, managing time and disagreement, and deciding what will actually set your entry apart. It covers two situations that share a skill set but not a working mode, namely case competitions and the pre-interview case you are given during campus placements.

What it does not cover. How to build the artefact itself. Deck construction, slide craft, frameworks and prototype building are the subject of the next chapter and are not repeated here.

1. Two Different Games

Roughly 70% of PM roles include a case component at some point in the process, so this is not an optional skill. But the two contexts in which you will do case work are less similar than they first appear, and treating them the same is the most common preparation error.

	Case competitions	Pre-interview cases
Who works on it	A team, usually three to five	You, alone
Time available	Days to weeks, across rounds	Often half a day, alongside everything else
Content depth	Dense; the slide cap constrains format, not depth	Lighter by necessity; fewer things, covered properly
What is being decided	A prize, and often a PPI or PPO	Whether you get an interview at all
Later rounds	Frequently a live presentation and Q&A	Your submission usually becomes the first interview

The point about depth is where people get the calibration wrong in both directions. A six-slide competition deck is dense throughout, because a team has had days and it shows. A six-slide pre-interview deck built solo in half a day cannot be, and should not try to be. Under that constraint the skill is not compression, it is *selection*. Decide what you will not cover, and cover what remains properly. A deck that gestures at eight things badly reads worse than one that does four things well and says why the others were out of scope.

What transfers between the two is the discipline: structured problem-solving, defensible assumptions, a clear narrative, and knowing your own solution well enough to defend it. What does not transfer is the working mode. Sections 2 and 3 are about team competitions specifically. Section 4 covers what replaces them when you are on your own.

2. Competitions: Choosing Them and Building a Team

Choose where to spend your effort

You cannot enter everything alongside coursework. Prioritize deliberately:

- Competitions that carry a PPI or PPO, which are worth far more than prize money
- Competitions with lower participation, where the odds are simply better
- Prestigious competitions worth having on a CV even without a podium finish
- Find out early whether the company is running it for recruitment or purely for ideas. If it is recruitment-oriented, treat every round as an interview, because it is one

Pick teammates for commitment, not for a skills checklist

This is the clearest and most consistent lesson from people who have won. Complementary skills were not what winning teams optimized for. What mattered was finding people who were equally invested and would actually put in the hours during a term full of assignments and midterms. A team where everyone has bought in fully will outperform a better-credentialed team where two people are coasting.

Being close friends is neither necessary nor a problem. What you do need is someone you can genuinely think with, who can hold a real brainstorming conversation and push an idea forward without immediately outsourcing the thinking to an AI tool.

The failure mode to avoid is a team of people who all think alike. Agreement feels efficient, but a solution that has never been properly challenged is usually a shallow one. You want enough difference in perspective that ideas get stress-tested before a judge does it for you.

***When this applies:** Team formation is often constrained by what is available. A qualifying round may limit the pool, or people may already be committed elsewhere. If you cannot assemble an ideal team, form one anyway and move. Reaching out widely and starting early matters more than holding out for a perfect composition.*

3. Competitions: Working as a Team

Start from a hypothesis, not from research

Work backwards. Decide roughly what answer you believe, lay out the argument that would support it, and only then do the research that fills the gaps or forces you to change your mind. Starting with open-ended research and hoping a solution emerges tends to consume the whole timeline.

Expect to spend real time here. Getting stuck is normal, and it almost always happens during ideation rather than during execution. Teams routinely cycle through ideas, discard them, and return to something they had dismissed earlier. Giving each idea a fair second hearing is part of the process, not a sign it is going badly.

Do not get trapped in the discussion loop

The counterpart to that is a real risk. A team can debate indefinitely, because someone will always have an objection to some part of any solution, and then discover the deadline is two days away with nothing built. Set internal milestones and hold to them. If you have no convergence by a certain point, start building anyway. Draft the problem statement, lay out the structure, sketch what it will look like. Work in progress often unblocks the thinking that pure discussion could not.

The same applies to parallel work. If the core idea is stuck, other pieces such as market research, problem framing and personas can usually proceed without it.

Handle disagreement according to how much time is left

Disagreement early is an asset. It is how ideas get sharpened, and winning teams debated a great deal before converging. The discipline is in how you disagree: state your assumptions, engage with what is actually driving the other person's view, and keep testing every option against the same question, which is which one answers the case objective best and will be easiest to defend under challenge.

Close to a deadline, that calculus changes. There is no time to go back to the drawing board, so split the work, let each person own their section, and trust them. This works only if you have already agreed on the overall narrative. With a shared storyline, separately written sections still connect. Without one, you get a deck that reads as several documents stapled together.

4. Pre-Interview Cases: Working Alone, Well

A pre-interview case is solo work under a hard time constraint, and most of the previous section does not apply. There is no team to disagree with and no work to split. What you lose is not just hands, but the thing a team gives you almost incidentally, which is someone to say your idea out loud to before you commit to it.

Find a sounding board

Even working alone, ten minutes of someone else's attention is worth a great deal, whether to sanity-check that your framing makes sense or to read your deck once before you submit it. Keep two or three people in mind for this in advance, so you are not looking for them at midnight.

There is a practical reason to look beyond the people preparing for the same roles as you. Anyone on the PM track is likely to have their own submission due in the same window, and will have neither the time nor the distance to help. Someone outside that track has both. They also bring genuinely fresh eyes: if your framing only makes sense to a person already fluent in case logic, that is useful to discover before an evaluator finds it.

Where the line sits: Sharing structural feedback, tooling knowledge and background research is collaboration. Converging on a shared solution is not, and it is self-defeating, because evaluators read submissions in batches and notice when several look alike. The differentiating thinking must be yours.

Budget your time before you start

- Decide upfront how many hours you actually have, and work backwards from the submission deadline rather than forwards from now
- Reserve the last stretch for assembly and checking, not for thinking. Running out of time mid-idea is how good analysis ends up unsubmitted

- Scope to what fits. Choosing three areas and covering them properly beats attempting everything the brief mentions

5. Differentiating Your Entry

Assume the field is strong. Slide quality is no longer a differentiator on its own, because anyone can produce a polished deck now. What separates submissions is the thinking. This applies in both contexts, though you will have more room to act on it in a competition.

- Choose the less obvious angle on the problem. The easy interpretation is the one most entries will take, and a defensible harder angle stands out immediately
- **Match the ambition of your idea to what the brief actually asked for.** If the brief asks you to improve an existing product, a well-reasoned improvement is the right answer and a speculative new business is a misread. If it asks for a new bet, incrementalism reads as timidity. In either case the work has to be well rounded: the question decides the direction, not your appetite for novelty.
- Check what the company has already built before proposing it. Suggesting a better version of something they already run is a common and avoidable failure
- Bring your own professional experience into the analysis explicitly. Speaking from a lens you actually developed at work carries far more weight than a generic recommendation, and it is underused

It is also worth looking at what previous winning submissions did, where those are available. The point is not to copy the content but to see the level of effort that wins. Losing to something you could have easily done and simply did not is an avoidable outcome.

Build a prototype even when nobody asked: This holds for competitions as much as for pre-interview cases. It makes your solution concrete rather than described, and it forces you to resolve decisions a deck lets you leave vague. Two caveats: a prototype is no longer unusual, so it earns nothing for effort alone, and it is an addition rather than a substitute. Finish the required deliverable properly first, then build one if time remains. The next chapter covers what separates a good one.

Ground the work in something real

Secondary research is now fast and widely available, which means it is no longer where you gain an edge. Depth is. Where a case allows it, going beyond desk research, whether by speaking to people in the industry or capturing an actual user perspective, lends your assumptions credibility that a purely researched submission cannot match.

When this applies: Access to industry contacts varies, and outreach does not always yield anything useful. Treat it as an upside rather than a requirement, and start early enough that a slow reply does not derail your timeline. In a half-day pre-interview case, this is usually out of reach, so do not sacrifice a required section to chase it.

6. Using AI Well

Every team that has won recently used AI tools, and all of them drew the line in the same place:

Use AI to fill in structure you have already built. Do not use it to originate your idea or your narrative.

Where it works

- Deep research, and getting up to speed quickly on an unfamiliar industry
- Filling in sections once the storyline and headline messages are set
- Curating and tightening content
- Refining how an argument is sequenced once you know what you are arguing
- Stress-testing your own work, finding gaps, weak assumptions and loopholes before an evaluator does
- Generating the questions a panel is likely to ask, so you can prepare answers in advance

Where it does not

Feeding in the problem statement and asking for ideas to choose from is the approach most likely to produce a submission indistinguishable from everyone else's. An idea that is slightly off-beat but backed by real research will beat a well-produced consensus answer. The same applies to the narrative: the flow of your argument, the angle you take and the message you want to land should be yours.

7. The Final Round

This section applies to competitions, and to any process that ends in a live presentation.

Prepare for the questions before you are asked them

Teams that do well treat the Q&A as something to be prepared for, not survived. Work out in advance where your solution is weakest, what a sceptical panel will push on, and what your answer is. Building supporting material for those anticipated questions, whether appendix slides, backup analysis or the numbers behind an assumption, means a challenge becomes a chance to demonstrate depth rather than a scramble.

If your idea is genuinely novel, expect to be asked for numbers even when precise ones are hard to produce. Blue-sky ideas still need estimated economics, a rough capital requirement, a plausible path to profitability, and a clear statement of which business metric you are moving. Benchmarks and guesstimates are acceptable; having nothing is not.

Keep the level of detail consistent

A recurring piece of judge feedback is inconsistent granularity. If parts of your deck sit at strategic altitude and other parts drop into operational detail, the work reads as scattered even when each individual slide is good. Decide what altitude you are presenting at and hold it across the whole submission.

Under challenge, explain the reasoning

Panels will challenge assumptions, sometimes strongly. The instinct is to defend the conclusion immediately. The better response is to walk through the reasoning that led

there: what you assumed, why, and what would change your mind. Composure matters more than polish, because a presenter who is comfortable will handle a hard question better than one who is rigidly on script.

8. After It Is Over

A win is a visible spike on a CV, and it will come up in interviews frequently and in detail. Expect questions about the solution itself, and about who judged it, since that tells an interviewer how much scrutiny the work actually withstood.

Know the whole submission, not just your part. In a team it is natural to own one section and stay out of the others. But in an interview you are asked about the work as a whole, and being unable to speak to the technical or analytical portion a teammate handled is a poor answer to what should be an easy question. Before you leave a competition behind, make sure you can explain every part of what your team produced and why.

Keep the artefacts too: the deck, the prototype, the research, and the reasoning behind your decisions. You will want them months later when an interviewer asks you to walk through it.

9. Quick Checklist

- **Pick competitions deliberately:** PPI or PPO potential, realistic odds, or genuine prestige.
- **Pick teammates who will do the work.** Commitment beats a tidy skills matrix.
- **Avoid a team that agrees with itself.** Unchallenged ideas stay shallow.
- **For a solo case, line up a sounding board in advance,** ideally someone not on the PM track.
- **Scope to the time you actually have.** Four things done properly beats eight gestured at.
- **Start from a hypothesis,** then research against it.
- **Set milestones and honour them.** If you have not converged, start building anyway.
- **Debate early, split late.** Agree the narrative before dividing the work.
- **Match your idea's ambition to the brief.** Improvement questions want improvements.
- **Check what the company already does** before proposing it.
- **Use AI to fill in and stress-test, never to originate.**
- **Prepare the Q&A in advance,** including numbers for novel ideas.
- **Know every part of your submission** before an interviewer asks about it.

AI-PROTOTYPES & DECKS (BUILDING THE SUBMISSION)

What this chapter covers. How to build the artefact once you have a brief in hand: reading the prompt, constructing the deck, and building an AI prototype. It applies to both case competitions and pre-interview cases, and where the two demand different things, that is called out.

Part 1: Understanding the Case

1A. Where the case round sits

A typical campus PM process runs shortlist from CV, then a case submission round, then one or more interviews. The case round is usually the sharpest funnel in the process, because interviews are expensive and companies use the case to cut hard before spending panel time.

Two implications follow, and people underweight both. First, your submission needs to survive a two-minute skim before it can earn a twenty-minute read.

Second, the case does not stop mattering once you clear it. In most processes, the interview is built directly on your submission. The panel will ask why you prioritized that feature over the other one, where your revenue number came from, and what happens to your metric if the assumption underneath it is wrong.

1B. Six case archetypes

Almost every case you receive is a variant of one of six shapes. A brief can straddle two, so identify the dominant one and let the secondary shape inform your appendix.

1. **Improve an existing product.** You are given a live product and a problem inside it. These test depth, meaning whether you can get specific about users and mechanisms rather than staying at strategy altitude.
2. **Build a new product inside an existing company.** The company exists, the capability exists, the product does not. Define scope, MVP and success. These test whether you can constrain yourself.
3. **Enter a new vertical or market.** These test whether you can reason about right-to-win rather than opportunity size. The question is why *this* company, with *these* assets, beats the incumbents already there.
4. **Make a strategic bet.** Usually a choice between several paths with large numbers attached. These test conviction and the quality of your rejection reasoning. The failure mode is hedging: picking a path and then quietly building something that would work under any of them.
5. **Diagnose and resolve a systemic problem.** A metric is moving badly, or a marketplace has developed a pathology. These are multi-stakeholder by nature and test whether you can hold competing interests in view without collapsing into one side.
6. **Monetize an asset.** A company has data, distribution or infrastructure and wants revenue from it. These test commercial imagination and market sizing.

1C. What real briefs have looked like

These are paraphrased from cases that came to campus in the 2025–26 placement season, compressed to their essentials and stripped of identifying detail. They are not reproduced verbatim.

1. **A ride-hailing and delivery platform** (diagnose and resolve): restaurants list higher prices on the delivery app than they charge in-store, in some markets by double digits, largely to offset platform commissions. This erodes customer value perception and conversion, but clamping down risks merchant profitability and supply. Candidates had to work the problem across consumers, merchants, couriers, the platform itself and regulators, then prioritize, define an MVP, and specify how they would measure and govern it. The brief explicitly asked whether the company should prioritize solving this at all.
2. **A healthcare data company** (new product inside an existing company): payer and provider contracting is manual, slow and asymmetric. Candidates chose one of three modules to design: rate benchmarking on public price transparency data, an NLP negotiation co-pilot, or a what-if contract simulator. Eight slides maximum, a required wireframe section, and an explicit instruction to identify synergies with the two modules not chosen. The brief came with a glossary, which tells you the domain knowledge was expected to be acquired, not assumed.
3. **A global payments network** (monetize an asset): the company captures rich transaction data across corporate travel, purchasing and fleet card programmes. Candidates were asked what new data products could be built on it, how to size that market, how to take it to market across several global regions, what single metric they would track, and what technical factors would make it fast to build and easy to adopt. Five distinct questions, which is effectively a five-section structure handed to you.
4. **An adtech company** (new product, with a prototype requirement): four options, including a self-serve campaign tool for SMB advertisers, an anomaly alerting system for campaign performance, and AI-driven personalization for travel booking. Five to seven pages of documentation plus a working prototype on a publicly accessible hosted URL, built on any vibe-coding platform, in thirty-six to forty-eight hours. The brief published its six evaluation parameters and closed by noting they had already seen several generic AI-generated ideas, and that fresh thinking would be what stood out.
5. **A payments company** (new vertical): design a live events discovery and ticketing platform inside a music streaming service, using listening data to connect fans to concerts, against an incumbent with roughly seventy percent share and universally disliked fees. Six slides maximum, with a fixed budget, an eight-month build window, no disruption to the core listening experience, and a stated three-year revenue target candidates had to show a path to.
6. **The same payments company** (strategic bet): a streaming service's games have roughly one percent subscriber engagement and no direct revenue. Candidates had to pick one clear direction, whether competing for hardcore gamers, leaning into IP and interactive storytelling, building social casual gaming, or investing in first-party studios, and build a launch plan to a stated three-year revenue target under a fixed budget. Six slides, an executive summary required up front, and an explicit instruction to explain why the rejected alternatives were rejected.

7. **A digital advertising company** (new vertical): a large e-commerce player, with its commerce reach, logistics network and digital ecosystem, is considering entry into video streaming. Candidates had to cover MVP specification, target user profile and potential challenges, with success metrics and prioritization. Three pages or five slides, minimum ten-point font. Two instructions stood out: every point had to be backed by a known or assumed data point with assumptions stated, and candidates were invited to argue the whole thing was a bad idea if their research pointed that way.
8. **An adtech and mobile marketing company** (strategic bet): how is digital advertising evolving, and what high-impact problem can AI solve today? Candidates picked one advertiser persona and one publisher persona from two given sets, identified a single problem to solve for that combination, stated which side they were primarily solving for and how the other was affected, and provided business rationale, solution and execution plan.

1D. Submission mechanics

Unglamorous, and the cheapest marks in the process to lose.

- **Submit early.**
- **Read the submission guidelines properly:** file naming, file format, where to submit, and what to include.
- **Check access permissions.** If you are submitting any link, set it to publicly accessible and then open it in an incognito window to verify.
- **Follow hard limits mechanically:** page, slide, word and font-size limits.
- **Ask when unsure.** Ask your placement representatives rather than assuming a favourable reading when guidelines are ambiguous.

Part 2: Building the Deck

2A. Read the prompt properly

1. **What is explicitly asked.** The named deliverables and coverage areas.
2. **What is implied.** A brief that says “achieve a stated revenue target by year three” is implicitly asking for a financial model.
3. **What is deliberately left open.** Where a brief gives you a choice, whether of module, strategic path or topic, the choice itself is being evaluated.

2B. Find precedents, parallels and contrasts

Before generating solutions, spend real time on what already exists.

- **Precedents:** has this exact thing been tried, by this company or another?
- **Parallels:** where has a structurally identical problem been solved in a different industry? Price parity between an aggregator’s listed prices and a merchant’s direct prices is not unique to food delivery. Hotels and airlines have fought it for two decades.
- **Contrasts:** where does the obvious analogy break? This is where judgement shows. Noting the hotel parity playbook exists is good. Noting that it partly does not transfer, because delivery merchants are far more fragmented and price-sensitive and parity clauses attract competition-law scrutiny, is much better.

2C. Build the storyline before the slides

Before opening a deck tool, write your argument as a sequence of complete assertions, one per intended slide. The test is whether someone could read only that sequence and still get your answer.

Weak, because these are topics rather than claims:

“Problem. Personas. Solution. Metrics. Roadmap.”

Every deck in the pile has these five slides. The sequence tells the reader nothing about what you concluded, so it cannot be wrong, and it cannot be interesting either. You could hand this outline to any candidate for any case.

Strong, because each line commits to something:

“Menu price inflation is a trust problem, not a pricing problem, and it is concentrated in SMB merchants who lack pricing tooling. It costs the platform more in suppressed conversion than it saves merchants in margin. We therefore give merchants the tooling to price competitively before we penalize them for not doing so. We measure it on consumer repeat rate, not on parity compliance. We pilot in two SMB-heavy cities with a defined gate before scale.”

This version names a diagnosis, quantifies why it matters, chooses an intervention, rejects the obvious alternative measure, and constrains the rollout. It is specific enough to disagree with, which is exactly what makes it worth reading. It is also the same five slides.

2D. Deck building blocks

Pick the ones the brief demands, add the ones your argument needs, and leave the rest.

- **Problem framing.** Use two or three dimensions: why it happens (the mechanism, not the symptom), why it matters now, who it hurts and how much, second-order effects, and the regulatory angle where it is genuinely load-bearing.
- **Company positioning.** For a market-entry case this is the most important slide and the one most often skipped. Cover right-to-win, meaning which specific assets give this company an advantage a new entrant would not have. “Wide customer reach” is not a right to win. “Purchase-intent data and an existing payments relationship with a customer base that overlaps the target segment” is closer. In a multi-sided market, be explicit about which side you are solving for and which you are constraining, and state what you are *not* doing.
- **Personas.** Two or three maximum. For each: context and behaviour rather than demographics, needs and jobs to be done framed independently of your solution, and current pain alongside current workaround. The workaround matters more than the pain, because if there is none the pain may not be real. And critically, why you prioritized this persona over the others, with the criterion stated and visibly applied.
- **User journeys.** A journey map earns its slide when it reveals where the problem actually lives. Lay out stages horizontally with rows for actions, touchpoints, emotional state, pain points, and the metric that would detect the problem at each stage. For

system behaviour, a flowchart is the better instrument, with explicit decision nodes and failure paths. A flow showing only the happy path is describing a demo, not a system.

- **MVP definition.** Two distinct things: the MVP vision, meaning what the product becomes if this works, and the MVP formulation, meaning what specifically ships first and what does not. Attach a hypothesis: what you believe, and what result would falsify it.
- **Features and solution.** Each feature needs three things to land: what it does, who it is for, and why it beats the alternative.
- **Prioritization.** Present the criteria and let the ranking fall out of them. The criteria are the argument, the ranking is the output. Apply your framework visibly, with actual scores and where they came from. An unpopulated framework diagram is decoration.
- **Metrics, in layers.** A North Star that captures delivered value and moves only if users are genuinely better off; two to four input metrics you can actually influence; output metrics such as revenue and retention, which lag; guardrail metrics that must not degrade while you optimize; and counter-metrics naming how your primary metric could be gamed. Give targets, not just names. “Seven-day retention, target thirty percent by month six” is a metric. “Retention” is a word.
- **Business model.** Revenue streams named and sized; pricing structure with a reason for your choice; pricing strategy, whether cost-plus, competitive, value-based, penetration or premium; unit economics with cost lines shown. Every number should trace to a stated assumption, because numbers without provenance are the fastest way to lose credibility in the follow-up interview.
- **Roadmap.** The axis you choose signals how you think: by time, where phases beat dates because you can attach gates, or by persona, capability or market.
- **Go-to-market.** A GTM slide has to answer five things: who you launch to first and why that segment ahead of the others; how the product is positioned to them, meaning the value proposition in a line; which channels reach them, split by online and offline and by existing versus new users; what you charge and what launch incentives apply, where pricing is material to the case; and what has to be true operationally, which on a marketplace means the supply side as much as the demand side. Sequence matters more than coverage, so name the cities, segments and partners in order with the reason for that order. The most common weakness is listing channels with no acquisition economics attached.
- **Risks.** Three to five, each with a mitigation and, where possible, a leading indicator that the risk is materializing. Generic risks such as “execution risk” are filler.

2E. Slide craft

A case deck is read, not presented, so it must be self-sufficient.

- **One assertion per slide, in the headline.** The title should be the claim, not the topic. “Personas” is a topic. “SMB merchants inflate prices twice as often as chains because they lack margin visibility” is a claim, and a reader who reads only your headlines still gets your argument.
- **Design for the two-minute skim.** Assume the first pass reads headlines and looks at one visual per slide.

- **Density through structure, not volume.** Under a slide limit the instinct is to shrink text and add bullets. The better move is a structure that carries more meaning per unit of space, such as a matrix or one well-labelled diagram. A two-by-two can do the work of eight bullets and is read in a quarter of the time.
- **Make the visual carry weight.** Every slide should have one thing the eye lands on. An all-text slide will be skimmed and lost.
- **Be consistent and legible.** One type scale, one colour palette, consistent alignment, sufficient contrast, real margins. A brief that specifies a font floor is telling you this is being noticed.

Part 3: AI Prototypes

3A. What a prototype is actually judged on

Just having a prototype was a differentiator two years ago. That doesn't suffice any more. Most submissions now include one; tools have made them cheap to produce, and in some briefs the prototype is the entire deliverable with no deck attached. Building one buys you nothing on its own.

What separates submissions now is whether the mandatory deliverable is genuinely good, or whether effort was spread thin across two surfaces so that both are merely present. If the brief asks for a deck and a prototype, the deck is still what carries your argument, and a beautiful prototype attached to a thin deck reads worse than a strong deck with a rough prototype. If the prototype is the whole deliverable, it has to carry the argument by itself, which is a higher bar than most people prepare for.

- **How clearly the reviewer understands your solution from it.** An evaluator opens your link with no context, spends perhaps ninety seconds, and forms a judgement. If they cannot work out what the product is, who it is for, and what to do first, the thinking underneath never gets discovered. This is not a presentation nicety. A PM who cannot make their own solution legible in ninety seconds will struggle to make it legible to an engineering team.
- **How novel and complete it is relative to others' submissions.** Evaluators read in batches. A competent prototype of an obvious idea sits in the middle of a large pile of exactly that. What stands out is either an idea the reviewer has not seen, or an execution that goes further, with one flow genuinely finished, including the states most candidates skip. Novelty without completeness reads as a sketch. Completeness without novelty reads as competent and forgettable.

***When this applies:** Judge this honestly against the clock. In a half-day pre-interview case, the time for an optional prototype usually does not exist, and starting one anyway is how a required section ends up thin. In a competition, with days and a team, it usually does.*

3B. From decision to interface

The solutioning does not change between a deck and a prototype. The problem framing, prioritization, metrics and business model are the same work, covered in Part 2. What changes is what you have to specify.

A deck can *state* a decision and move on. “We surface a margin comparison to the merchant at the point of pricing” is a complete sentence and a complete slide. A prototype has to *show* it, and the moment you try, questions appear that the deck never forced you to answer. Which screen is this on? What does the merchant see before they have any data? Is the comparison a number, a chart or a warning? What happens when they disagree with it?

This is why a prompt to an AI builder needs far more detail than the corresponding deck bullet. You are not asking it to summarize a decision, you are asking it to render one, and anything you leave unspecified it will invent, usually in the most generic way available. A useful prompt names the screens, the primary action on each, the data shown, the states, and the one path you want a reviewer to walk.

Treat this as a design step rather than an export step. It is also where a prototype pays you back, because the questions it forces are ones an interviewer is likely to ask anyway.

3C. Building it well

1. **Build one path completely.** Pick the journey that carries your core argument, usually your MVP’s primary use case, and make it work end to end. A user should be able to start at the entry point, move through the flow, take the key action, and see a result.
2. **Match fidelity to purpose.** A high-fidelity golden path plus low-fidelity supporting screens is a legitimate and legible choice. If the brief asks for wireframes rather than a working app, low fidelity is what was requested, and building a polished app instead is not extra credit, it is not reading the brief.
3. **Use realistic data.** Plausible names, real-looking prices, believable timestamps, and numbers that are internally consistent. This costs almost nothing and materially changes how the prototype reads.
4. **Build in-app guidance.** This is one of the few places where the usual product instinct, which is to minimize instruction and let the interface speak, is wrong. You are optimizing for a first-time evaluator on a clock, not a returning user. An entry screen stating what this is and what to try, a short walkthrough on first load, a visibly suggested path, and labelled demo data all pay for themselves.
5. **Show the real states, if you have time.** An interface that only ever shows the ideal case is a mockup. Showing what happens when a list is empty, a request fails, or a new user arrives with no history demonstrates product thinking most candidates skip.
6. **Verify the hosting.** Validate in an incognito window logged out of everything, and check on a phone as well as a laptop. No login, no signup wall, no access request. Put the link in the deck itself as a real hyperlink on an early slide, not only in the submission form. A short recorded walkthrough or screenshot appendix protects you if the hosted version breaks.

3D. Tools

The AI prototyping landscape changes on a timescale of months. What follows is a snapshot and a way of thinking about the categories, not a recommendation to follow without checking.

Tool	Category	Best for	Watch out for
Lovable	Full-stack builder	Complete apps with working backend; strong default for a functional MVP	Credit consumption; over-builds if you are not specific about scope
Bolt	Full-stack builder	Fastest route from prompt to live hosted link	Quality degrades on complex state; better for throwaway demos
v0 (Vercel)	UI generator	The cleanest, most production-looking interfaces; smooth deploy	No backend generation, so you wire up data yourself
Replit	Builder + IDE	Environment, database, hosting and deploy in one place	Steeper than pure prompt tools; slower to first result
Cursor	AI code editor	Maximum control if you can already code	You handle setup, hosting and deployment
Claude	Conversational build	Fast interactive artefacts; strong for logic-heavy prototypes	Not a hosting solution on its own
Google AI Studio	Conversational build	Free prototyping; low barrier to entry	Less polished output; weaker hosting story
Figma Make	Design-native	Best on-ramp if your work started in Figma	Oriented to prototypes rather than production apps
Base44	Lightweight builder	Simple dashboards and internal-tool-style products	Credits consumed on failed generations too
Emergent	Agentic full-stack	Genuinely production-shaped backends	Cost is high on a student budget
Rocket.new	Agentic full-stack	Full-stack web and mobile from one prompt, with auth and hosting	Newer and less predictable
n8n	Workflow automation	Demonstrating backend pipelines, alerting logic or agent workflows	Not an app builder, so wrong for a UI-led case

Guidance more stable than the table:

- **Pick one tool and learn it properly** before placements start, rather than sampling five during a live case.
- **Free tiers and credits run out mid-build.** Find this out in advance, not at hour thirty of a forty-eight-hour case.
- **Get to a hosted link early**, within the first couple of hours, so you always have something submittable. Improve from there.

3E. How much design matters

Design is not what you are being evaluated on. Nobody shortlists a candidate for elegant spacing. But bad design derails a good case, because an evaluator who cannot parse the interface stops reading the thinking behind it. The goal is therefore not excellence; it is clearing the bar cleanly and spending your remaining time elsewhere.

The baseline: get these present and unremarkable, then stop.

Navigation, buttons, forms and inputs, cards, data tables, modals, empty states and loading indicators. Whatever tool you use will give you a competent default version of all of these, and the default is fine. Polishing them further is invisible to an evaluator. The only real failure here is inconsistency, meaning three button styles and four spacing values in one prototype, which reads as carelessness even to someone who cannot name why.

Where marginal effort actually pays.

These are noticed precisely because most submissions skip them, and each one signals product thinking rather than tool proficiency:

- **Error and failure states.** What the user sees when something goes wrong, and what they can do about it. Very few candidates build these.
- **Tooltips and hints at genuinely ambiguous points,** not decoratively scattered. One well-placed hint where a user would actually hesitate is worth more than twenty generic ones.
- **Onboarding or a suggested path,** which doubles as the reviewer orientation described in 3C.
- **Realistic, internally consistent data,** which does more for perceived quality than any amount of visual refinement.

***When this applies:** If your prototype currently has no working flow, do not spend time on error states. Finish the golden path first. This ordering only holds once the core journey works end to end.*

3F. Learn from published design systems

Published design systems are free, thorough, and written for people who are not designers. Reading one properly is a few hours that upgrades every submission you make afterwards. Read one, ideally Material or Polaris, and consult the others when a specific pattern shows.

- **Apple Human Interface Guidelines:** the best writing on interaction principles, and strong on when to use which control.
- **Material Design:** the most complete treatment of foundations such as spacing, type scale and elevation.
- **Salesforce Lightning:** the best reference for dense, enterprise, data-heavy interfaces, which is a large share of what comes to campus.
- **IBM Carbon:** excellent on data visualization and enterprise patterns.
- **Shopify Polaris:** strong on commerce and merchant-facing patterns, and unusually good at explaining its reasoning.

Part 4: Framework Reference

Frameworks are compression tools. They communicate a structured judgement in less space than prose. Each entry gives what it does, when it earns its place, and when it becomes decoration. Use them to structure thinking, not to fill slides.

Problem structuring

Framework	What it does	Earns its place when	Becomes decoration when
First principles	Decomposes a problem to its irreducible components	The brief is unfamiliar, or the conventional framing seems wrong	Used as a label for ordinary analysis
Issue tree / MECE	Breaks a question into mutually exclusive, collectively exhaustive branches	You need to show the solution space was covered systematically	The branches overlap, which they usually do
Five Whys	Traces a symptom to a root cause	Diagnostic cases where the stated problem is a symptom	Shown as a diagram rather than used to reach an insight
Jobs To Be Done	Frames needs as outcomes users are trying to achieve	Persona work, and anywhere you want to avoid solution-first thinking	Reduced to a fill-in-the-blank sentence with no research behind it

Prioritization

Framework	What it does	Earns its place when	Becomes decoration when
RICE	Scores by Reach, Impact, Confidence and Effort	You have five or more candidates and need a defensible ranking	The inputs are invented, making the output arbitrary precision
ICE	Lighter version: Impact, Confidence, Ease	Time is short and RICE is overkill	Same as RICE, and more so
Impact/Effort matrix	Two-by-two plotting value against cost	Communicating a ranking quickly and visually	Items placed by intuition and the axes unlabelled
MoSCoW	Sorts into Must, Should, Could, Won't have	Defining MVP scope, especially the "won't" list	Everything ends up a Must, so no prioritization happened
Kano model	Classifies features as basic, performance or delight	Arguing a feature creates disproportionate satisfaction	Applied without any user input, which the model depends on

Framework	What it does	Earns its place when	Becomes decoration when
Weighted scoring	Scores options against criteria with explicit weights	The criteria themselves are the argument	The weights were chosen to produce the answer you wanted

Users and journeys

Framework	What it does	Earns its place when	Becomes decoration when
Personas	Consolidates user research into two or three archetypes	You need to justify prioritizing one group over another	They are demographic sketches with no behavioural content
Empathy map	Captures what a user says, thinks, does and feels	Consumer cases where emotional state drives behaviour	Filled with speculation presented as insight
Journey map	Maps stages, actions, touchpoints, emotions and pain	Locating where in the experience the problem actually lives	It has no metric row and connects to nothing later
Service blueprint	Extends a journey map to backstage processes	Operations-heavy cases with real behind-the-scenes complexity	The case is a simple consumer flow and this adds nothing

Metrics

Framework	What it does	Earns its place when	Becomes decoration when
North Star + inputs	One value metric with the levers that drive it	Almost always; this is the default metrics structure	The North Star is a vanity metric like total registered users
AARRR	Acquisition, Activation, Retention, Referral, Revenue	Consumer growth cases with a clear funnel	Applied to B2B products where the funnel differs
HEART	Happiness, Engagement, Adoption, Retention, Task success	UX-quality cases where experience is the subject	Used as a checklist producing five metrics with no priority
Guardrails and counter-metrics	Names what must not degrade, and how the metric could be gamed	Any optimization with a plausible victim, which is most	Omitted, which is the usual case and the reason to include them
OKRs	Objectives with measurable key results	Showing how a team would be steered over a quarter	Used as a synonym for “goals”

Strategy and market

Framework	What it does	Earns its place when	Becomes decoration when
TAM / SAM / SOM	Sizes total, addressable and obtainable market	Market entry and monetization cases; usually required	The numbers come from a search result with no derivation
Porter's Five Forces	Assesses structural industry attractiveness	Entering an industry with strong incumbents or supplier power	Applied to a feature decision, where it has nothing to say
SWOT	Strengths, weaknesses, opportunities, threats	Rarely; the least discriminating framework on this list	Almost always; prefer a right-to-win argument instead
Ansoff matrix	Maps growth as existing or new product against existing or new market	Naming precisely what kind of growth bet is being made	Shown without informing any subsequent decision
Business Model / Lean Canvas	Lays out the full business model on one page	New business cases where the whole model is in question	Used as a summary slide repeating content already covered
Blue Ocean / ERRC	Eliminate, Reduce, Raise, Create; reframes competition	Arguing you will compete on a different axis than incumbents	The "create" quadrant contains something competitors already do
Value chain	Maps activities from input to customer	Identifying where structural advantage actually sits	Drawn generically rather than for this specific company

Go-to-market and execution

Framework	What it does	Earns its place when	Becomes decoration when
STP	Segmentation, targeting, positioning	GTM sections needing a clear "who first, and why them"	Segments are named but never used to shape the plan
Bullseye	Ranks acquisition channels to find the one that works	Channel strategy where the choice is genuinely open	All channels listed as equally promising
RACI	Assigns Responsible, Accountable, Consulted, Informed	Operations and governance sections	Included in a case with no organizational dimension
Phase gates	Defines what must be true before the next stage begins	Any roadmap; substantially stronger than dates alone	Gates are named but have no thresholds attached

Part 5: Resources

Read this before you click anything: These are for building capability in advance, not for consulting mid-case. Working through a design system the night before a submission is due is a way of feeling productive while losing hours you needed for the actual thinking. The exception is the icon and illustration libraries, which are genuinely quick wins during deck building.

Design systems

- [Apple Human Interface Guidelines](#)
- [Material Design](#)
- [Salesforce Lightning Design System](#)
- [IBM Carbon](#)
- [Shopify Polaris](#)
- [Atlassian Design System](#)

Icons

- [Lucide](#): clean, consistent, widely used, and the safe default.
- [Phosphor](#): six weights, good for building hierarchy.
- [Heroicons](#): pairs naturally with Tailwind-based prototypes.
- [Tabler](#): very large set, consistent stroke.
- [Material Symbols](#): enormous coverage, variable weight and fill.
- [Iconify](#): an aggregator across many sets, useful for finding a specific icon.
- [The Noun Project](#): broad and unusual concepts, but check attribution requirements.

Illustration

- [unDraw](#): recolourable to your palette, which is why it is the most useful of these.
- [Storyset](#): customizable, some animated.
- [Humaaans](#): mix-and-match figures.
- [Open Peeps](#): hand-drawn style.

Diagramming and design

- [Figma](#)
- [Lucidchart](#)
- [Excalidraw](#)
- [Balsamiq](#)
- [Mermaid](#)

RESUME PREPARATION

Your master resume is the source of truth; your submitted versions are different ways of positioning that same underlying experience.

You will find previous years' resumes on the KMP portal. Start by pulling resumes of people who were shortlisted by your **target companies and target sectors**, particularly those with backgrounds similar to yours. Look beyond the exact role: resumes from adjacent industries can help you understand how the same experience is positioned for a different role.

Use an LLM to accelerate this comparison. Feed a small set of relevant shortlisted resumes, along with the role or sector you are targeting, and ask it to identify recurring themes, terminology, types of impact, metrics and experiences that are emphasised. Use this as an input to your customization, not as a substitute for your own judgement.

Think in versions

Your ten versions of resume should not be ten cosmetic variations of the same resume. Treat them as a **portfolio of positioning choices**. The right mix depends on your target roles and can change as you learn more during the placement process.

If PM is your primary target, roughly **six versions can be reserved for PM**, differentiated where useful by role or sector, such as:

- B2C/consumer PM
- B2B/enterprise PM
- Technology/platform PM
- Fintech / another target sector
- General PM
- Specific high-priority company or role cluster (Product Strategy, Product Owner, etc)

No one would have work-ex across all these areas. The key is to find parallels between the target sector and your work, and frame your points in a way to highlight those skills/experiences. The remaining versions can cover consulting, Founder's Office, General Management, Marketing or other roles you genuinely intend to pursue.

You do not need to lock the final mix immediately. A balanced initial portfolio is sensible to start with, particularly since applications to consulting companies open early.

Think of the later edit windows as reallocation opportunities.

1. New ISB experiences may give you stronger points to add (case competitions)
2. Company research may change which roles or sectors you want to prioritise.
3. Your shortlists' status may change which roles you want to prioritize your further applications on
4. Use the October edit windows to convert lower-priority resume versions into versions for the roles that have become more important.

Customization

Customize for the role, but do not rewrite the underlying facts. Your master resume has already fixed the underlying metrics and achievements. Customization should therefore come primarily from **selection, ordering, compression and wording**: which points you surface, which you shorten, what you emphasise, and how you describe the same experience for a particular role.

Use past or online JDs of target roles, shortlisted KMP resumes and your understanding of the company to identify what matters most. For example, a B2C PM role may warrant greater emphasis on user behaviour, adoption and engagement, while a B2B role may warrant greater emphasis on enterprise workflows, stakeholders, revenue or operational metrics.

General Bucketing

In general, the “Education” section should be 20% of your resume, Experience should be 70%, and “Extracurriculars” should be the remaining 10% “Experience”

- **Education:** Should include ISB (with intended majors), your PORs or SIGs, any case competition wins while at ISB, ELPs, pro-bono work, and Masters/Bachelor's degree
- **Experience:** Should only include your full-time work experience; internships are not counted. This is the most important section; make sure you demonstrate **impact, ownership and transferable skills** for the role you are aiming for. The same experience can be positioned differently across versions depending on the role.
- **Extracurriculars:** Should include activities beyond work or academics. This is a great opportunity to connect with interviewers, so make it count with activities you're passionate about.

Content & Formatting

Format: There is no preference between **STAR and RAC**. Choose the structure that works better for your experience and **stick to it consistently** across your resume.

STAR: Situation → Task → Action → Result

STAR works by briefly establishing the **context and objective**, followed by what you personally did and the resulting impact. On a resume, it is usually compressed into **Action + Result**, with only the context needed to make the achievement understandable.

Pros

- Makes the problem and your contribution easy to understand.
- Useful when the context is important to appreciating the achievement.
- Naturally shows the link between what you did and the outcome.

Cons

- Can become wordy when the Situation and Task are already obvious.
- Less effective when strict one-line limits leave little room for context.

Not following STAR: Worked closely with the engineering, design, sales, and operations teams to improve the onboarding journey, identifying several friction points and implementing changes across multiple stages of the process, resulting in significantly improved customer activation.

STAR: Redesigned onboarding journey to reduce drop-offs, improving activation by 18% (42% → 60%) through 4 key funnel interventions.

RAC: Result → Action → Context

RAC leads with the **outcome**, then explains **what you did** and finally provides just enough context to understand the achievement. This makes the impact immediately visible and is particularly useful when resume space is tight.

Pros

- Puts the most important information, the result, first.
- Naturally concise and easy to scan.
- Works particularly well when the impact is the strongest part of the story.

Cons

- Can become vague if the context is compressed too aggressively.
- A strong result without enough context may make the scale or difficulty of the achievement unclear.

Not following RAC: Responsible for analyzing customer complaints, working with multiple teams to understand why users were abandoning the process, and then recommending and implementing changes that eventually reduced customer support requests.

RAC: Reduced support requests 25% by analyzing complaint patterns and redesigning the highest-friction steps in the customer journey.

Rule of thumb

- **STAR:** select this if the *problem/context* makes the achievement more impressive or understandable (in most parts of your work)
- **RAC:** select this if the *result* is strong enough to lead with (in most parts of your work), and you need maximum scanability.
- For either format, the final point should make three things clear: what changed, what you did, and why it mattered.

Other Important Factors:

- **Brevity:** It's advisable that a single bullet point doesn't go over one line. You can use sub-bullets to add more parts to a particular project.
- **Quantify:** Benchmark all numbers or percentages clearly (Instead of only saying ("Grew monthly downloads by 10%", also mention (20L to 22L)"). (Assuming you already have these in your master version)
- **Language:** Use strong PM action verbs (see table below) and as many product terminology and metrics as you can (e.g., "Reduced turnaround time" instead of "Reduced time to ship"). Talk in the language of a PM. Use action words like

“prioritised”, “shipped”, “prototyped”, “researched user behaviour”, “managed stakeholders”, etc. [Commonly Used Action Verbs](#)

- **Focus on Impact:** Don’t talk about duties, translate them into wins. Translate responsibilities into measurable results or improvements. Focus on measurable results and make your **individual contribution** clear. Prioritise managerial, technological, product, customer and financial impact according to the role you are targeting.
- **PORs:** A leadership role (POR) is valuable only if you quantify the impact you created.
- **GPA:** GPA doesn’t matter much for product management hiring; feel free to not disclose it where it's optional. Although about half of the companies might have mandatory GPA disclosure
- Prepare to be grilled for 30 minutes on every project on your resume in the interview

Review Process

- **Peer Review:** Start by getting your resume reviewed by peers to remove obvious grammatical errors, spelling mistakes, or formatting issues. Ask at least one person who understands your target role to assess whether the resume communicates the intended positioning quickly.
- **Alumni Review:** Do plenty of alum reviews of your resume. Your resume will not be finalised until around 5 - 6 alums have reviewed it. Don’t change your resume after every single review; get advice from all and then make changes in bulk. Remember that alums might give contradictory advice based on their experience.

INTERVIEW PREPARATION

What Changes When the Answer Is Spoken

A written submission is composed, revised, and read at the evaluator's pace. A live answer is none of those things, and three differences drive everything in this chapter.

- The interviewer is a participant. In a root cause question, they hold the data and release it only when you ask for it, so the questions you ask are themselves part of what is being marked.
- You cannot revise. Structure must be announced before you use it, because the interviewer is following in real time and cannot skim back to work out where you are.
- You will be interrupted and redirected. A rigid framework recital falls apart the moment they pull you off it, which experienced interviewers do deliberately.

The practical consequence runs through every section below. Use frameworks to organize your thinking, not as a script to perform **(Only comes with extensive case interview prep)**. Say what you are about to do, do it, then check whether the interviewer wants you to go deeper or move on. They can tell within a minute whether you are thinking or reciting.

Clarifying and stalling are not the same thing and mixing them up is one of the most common ways candidates lose the room. Ask enough to pin down what is actually being asked, then commit to an assumption and move. "I would want to see the usage data before I say anything" is not a diligent answer; it is a non-answer, because the interviewer already knows you would do proper research on the job. What they are testing is how you reason without it, right now. If you do not have a number, state a reasonable one and flag it as an assumption, and keep going. The interviewer can always correct an assumption. They cannot grade an answer you never gave.

BEHAVIOURAL & WORK-EX INTERVIEW

While immersed in 'case prep', people often deprioritize preparing for this round. Ensure that you give it enough time; it is as important or more than the case rounds.

Across several interview experiences our batchmates shared for the Co'26 placement cycle, some version of "resume deep-dive" or "behavioural" showed up in nearly every single process, often as Round 1, and almost always as at least one full round on its own. Companies as different as Ethos, Teradata, Uber, and Target all ran multi-round processes in which 2-3 rounds had a resume/behavioural component. This is not a box-ticking round. It is very often the round that decides whether you get a second one.

This section covers how to prepare for it properly: what interviewers are actually testing, how to build your material, and how to hold up when they push back.

1. What This Round Is Actually Testing

Two different things get bundled into "behavioural," and it helps to separate them:

- **Fit and motivation:** why product, why this company, why you specifically. This is usually where the round opens.
- **How you actually operate:** how you make decisions, handle conflict, recover from mistakes, and work with people. This is usually tested through your resume and past projects, not hypotheticals.

A few interviewers will also fold in a light stress-test, more on that in Section 6. But the baseline is: they are trying to find out if you're a safe, effective person to hand ambiguous problems to, and whether your account of your own work holds up under scrutiny.

Unlike a case round, this conversation has no fixed path. An interviewer can move from your resume to motivation, from a project to a disagreement, or from work experience to a product or industry question within minutes. Prepare the underlying material well enough that you can move with the conversation rather than trying to force every question into a predefined structure.

2. Tell Me About Yourself (~2 minutes)

Keep it to roughly two minutes. Don't narrate your CV chronologically; that's what the resume is for. Instead, explain the choices behind your resume, and the thread that connects them. Why did you choose your education? Why did you make each major career move? What have you consistently gravitated toward? What does your experience say about how you work, and why does the next step make sense?

Tailor this to the role and your actual background. Someone moving from engineering to PM will have a different story from someone who has already worked in product. The goal is not to manufacture a "why PM" story; it is to make the choices on your resume understandable and relevant to why you are sitting in this interview.

Do not memorise a speech. Prepare the points you want the interviewer to understand and connect them naturally.

3. Why PM / Why This Company

Almost every process in our dataset opened or closed with some version of this; Sirion asked "why move from e-commerce to fintech," Flipkart asked "why PM, why Flipkart, where do you see yourself in 5 years," Razorpay asked "why product after such deeply technical SDE roles," Media.net asked "why do you want to join ad-tech." HiLabs put it even more bluntly: one interviewer asked candidates to describe PM in a single word, he was listening for "prioritization."

What separates a strong answer from a weak one here isn't cleverness; it's specificity:

- **Personalize it.** A templated "I love solving problems and working cross-functionally" answer is instantly forgettable, and most interviewers have heard it a hundred times that placement season. Anchor it in a real moment from your own work-ex or resume; the templated version and the true version take the same amount of time to say.
- **Do the company homework.** Multiple batchmates flagged this independently as the difference-maker: know the company's products, recent moves, and where they're

headed, and be ready to have an actual point of view in the conversation rather than just reciting facts back. One Acko candidate noted that "having a dialogue about their strategy while providing your point of view goes a long way in showing interest."

- **Answer the unspoken question too.** "Why this company" is really "*why should we pick you over the other 40 people who also did their homework*", so don't stop at admiration for the company; close the loop on what you specifically bring.

4. The Resume Deep-Dive

This is the single most common format in the dataset, and it is not just "walk me through your CV." Interviewers use your resume as raw material for cross-questioning, Mastercard's round was described as "detailed grilling on each and every point of the resume," Sirion asked for a "detailed deep-dive into a project where you showcased a skill-set," and Teradata's opening round moved systematically through "what, why, how, results" on real projects before pivoting into situational questions built off them.

Prepare every project on your resume, not just your "main" one, to be narrated on the spot, using this structure:

- **Why** you did it (what problem, whose problem)
- **What** you actually did (your specific contribution, not the team's)
- **How** you did it (the approach, the trade-offs, who you worked with)
- **Impact** generated [numbers if you have them (preferred), direction of change if you don't]
- **Future scope:** what you'd improve or do differently if you kept working on it

That last point matters more than it looks like on paper: several interviewers explicitly asked what a candidate would improve *next*, and "iterate on the actual next-thing" plays much better than "it went well and we shipped it." Real, first-hand product thinking looks like an evolving Plan B, not a settled Plan A; nobody actually believes your first plan worked out exactly as designed, and pretending otherwise reads as either naive or dishonest.

Have a real, specific story ready for every line, however small. This came up over and over, independent of company or interviewer: "if you don't know something and have faffed on your CV, or try to faff, they will see through it." Whatever is written on your resume, you will be asked to defend it live, so before the interview, walk your own resume line by line and make sure you could talk for two minutes on each one if pushed. One InMobi candidate noted a peer wasn't shortlisted purely because their otherwise-strong case had no name on the file; the smallest details of how you present yourself are being watched too.

Prepare for the branch, not just the headline. "Tell me about this project" can quickly become "Why did you choose that approach?", "What would you do differently?", "What happened when someone disagreed?", "What went wrong?", or "What would you do next?" Prepare the decisions, trade-offs, stakeholder dynamics and lessons behind each resume point, not just a polished narration.

5. Building Your Story Bank

Once you're past "why PM" and into "tell me about a time," you need pre-built material, not answers you're constructing live. In practice, almost every behavioural question batchmates were actually asked collapses into one of five underlying stories:

1. **Leadership:** a time you led a team or project: your style, what got hard, and the outcome. Interviewers are reading for how you motivate people and make calls under pressure, not just what you shipped.
2. **Overcoming adversity:** a real setback or failure and how you worked through it. This is the one people under-prepare for, because it means talking about something that didn't go well, but "everything worked out great" is a weaker signal than a real recovery.
3. **Innovation or initiative:** a time you pushed a new idea, fixed a broken process, or solved something in a non-obvious way, on your own steam rather than because you were told to.
4. **Teamwork and collaboration:** how you actually operate inside a team: your specific role, how you handled a mix of personalities or priorities, and what the team produced together (not what you produced alone).
5. **Decision-making under ambiguity:** a time you made an important decision with incomplete information, unclear goals, time pressure or competing priorities. Interviewers are looking for your decision criteria, not whether you happened to make the perfect call.
6. **Execution and ownership:** a time you led something end-to-end, recovered a project that was off-track, improved a process, or had to make a difficult execution trade-off.
7. **Career aspiration and growth:** why your path looks the way it does, and what it says about your self-awareness and what you're optimizing for next.

The questions that were actually asked map onto these directly, almost one-to-one:

- *"Tell me about a time you handled a difficult stakeholder"* → Teamwork/Collaboration, sometimes Leadership
- *"Tell me about a time you disagreed with your manager"* (asked at Ethos, both a version where the candidate was right, and one where the manager was) → Teamwork/Collaboration, occasionally Adversity
- *"Give up on short-term gains for long-term value"* (Ethos) → Adversity or Leadership, depending on the story
- *"A time you didn't build a feature despite planning to, what made you stop, how did you communicate it"* (Ethos) → Adversity + Stakeholder management
- *"Biggest problem you've ever solved" / "most complex project you've worked on"* (Ethos, Teradata) → Innovation/Initiative
- *"What are your key strengths and weaknesses"* (Paytm asked for "one quality you'd hate seeing in a teammate", the same question from the other side) → Growth/self-awareness

Prepare 5-6 stories minimum, but use STAR as a preparation aid rather than an interview script. STAR is useful for checking whether a story contains the basic ingredients: Situation, Task, Action and Result. In a live interview, however, forcing every answer through four rigid boxes can make the story sound rehearsed. Interviewers may interrupt after the Situation, ask why you chose an action, challenge the Result, or take the story in another direction.

Prepare each story as **bullet-point memories**, not a memorised answer. Know:

- **Context:** what was happening and what was at stake
- **Your role:** what you owned, rather than what the team did
- **Key decisions:** what choices you made and why
- **Actions:** the important things you personally did
- **Stakeholders:** who disagreed, depended on you, or had to be convinced
- **Result:** numbers where available, direction of change otherwise
- **Reflection:** what went wrong, what you learned, or what you would do differently

The objective is to know the story deeply enough that you can **twist and mould it to the question**. The same experience might answer a question about conflict, leadership, prioritisation or failure depending on which part of the story you emphasise.

6. When It Turns Into a Stress Test

Be ready for interviewers who deliberately push, rather than just listen. This showed up often enough across very different companies that it's clearly not a one-off style, it's a real, common tactic:

- At **Mastercard**, one interviewer asked for a candidate's favourite data product, then their second favourite, then their third, before finally engaging, deliberately testing whether the candidate stayed composed while being repeatedly redirected.
- At **Navi**, a candidate described an entire round as "stress-based", heavy on situational questions about their own judgment and decision criteria, with the interviewer clearly probing for cracks rather than just collecting information.
- At **Cashfree**, the CPO round dug into non-work passion projects specifically to see how the candidate thought about measuring success in an unstructured context, there's no "right" framework to fall back on.
- At **Uber**, one round was described as "lots of grilling" on previous work experience, going well past a first answer into repeated follow-ups.

None of this means something is wrong or that you're failing; it's frequently the *format*, not a signal you're doing badly. The way through it is not to have a cleverer answer, but to **stay calm, stay consistent, and don't fabricate a better version of the story to satisfy the pushback**. If an interviewer keeps drilling into the same point, it usually means they want to see if your story holds up under repetition, not that they expect a different story to appear.

Be ready to switch modes. The interviewer can move from behavioural → product, resume → technical depth, work experience → industry, company motivation → competitor, or

favourite product → product improvement. Do not prepare separate “rounds” in your head; prepare the underlying material.

Prepare products outside your work domain. A fintech candidate may be asked about streaming, maps or hardware; a consumer-tech candidate may be asked about an enterprise workflow. Product sense should travel beyond the domain on your resume.

Prep Checklist

- ☐ "Tell me about yourself", under 2 minutes
- ☐ "Why PM / why this company", personalized, backed by real company research, not templated
- ☐ Every project on your resume prepped for live narration using Why / What / How / Impact / Future Scope, not just your headline one
- ☐ Walked your own resume line by line and confirmed you can defend every point live, however small
- ☐ 5-6 core stories prepared as flexible bullet points, covering Leadership, Adversity, Innovation, Teamwork, Ambiguity and Execution. Each story has a clear reflection: what I learned, what went wrong, or what I would do differently
- ☐ Each story practised out loud at least once, not just outlined in your head
- ☐ Practised holding your answer steady under follow-up pushback, without inventing a "better" version mid-interview

PRODUCT DESIGN / PRODUCT IMPROVEMENT

What is product design?

The most important and widely asked type of question, product design questions aim to test your product sense. They evaluate your creativity, ability to empathize with users, ability to connect the company’s goals with user needs, and prioritization skills, all of which are core to being a good product manager. In this, you are expected to design a new product from scratch by considering users, their needs and finally the features of the product. This is broadly the scope of design questions. You will not be expected to do the actual UI designing of the product as the name might usually suggest.

Examples:

1. Design an intelligent table for restaurants.
2. Build a product for group travel.
3. Design a parking solution for Google Maps.
4. Design a refrigerator for kids
5. Design a chatbot for the banking industry

To answer these types of interview questions, you can (but not limited to) use the following framework:

CIRCLES Framework

Although it is always recommended to fine-tune your framework based on the question and interview dynamics, CIRCLES is the most popular design framework and a good place to start with, in the initial phase of your interview prep. It would also be wise to not memorize & implement this framework word for word, as seasoned product interviewers can very easily detect interviewees sticking to the framework and will most likely pull you out of it via follow-up questions. Regardless, this is how the CIRCLES framework looks like:

- **C - Comprehend the situation:**

This is your chance to clarify the problem and set the stage. A good PM gathers as much information as possible before building anything. Start by asking clarifying questions to understand the **what, who, and why**.

What is the product you're designing? For example, is it a new feature, a standalone product, or an improvement to an existing one?

Who is the user? You'll dive deeper into this in the next step, but it's good to get an initial sense.

Why are we building this? What are the business goals? Are we trying to increase revenue, market share, or user engagement?

Are there any constraints? Think about technical limitations, timelines, or available resources.

By asking these questions, you demonstrate that you're a thoughtful and thorough product thinker.

- **I - Identify the Customer:**

Determining the product's target audience is essential to ensure the product meets the specific needs and preferences of its users. It involves defining who the product is for, and understanding their characteristics, behaviours, and pain points. You don't want to build a product that does everything for everyone; hence, focusing on one customer target segment is essential while answering. Personas can be made across various cuts:

1. Demographic: Age, gender, etc
2. Geography
3. Profession
4. Psychographic

- **R – Report the customer's needs:**

Once you've identified your target user, the next step is to understand their needs. What are their pain points? What problems do they face that your product could solve?

Create a list of their needs. Don't just list features; think about the underlying problems. For instance, instead of saying, "The user needs a notification feature," say, "The user needs to know when their package is arriving so they can be home to receive it." This shows you understand the 'why' behind the 'what.'

- **C – Cut through prioritization:**

This step is all about focusing on what truly matters for product development. In doing so, it involves studying the customer needs you've identified and singling out those that your team must prioritize during the design and development processes. The best way is to balance factors such as revenue, cost of execution, user experience, and feasibility, among others, in order to determine where you must focus energy to deliver the right solution to the target audience. A few prioritisation frameworks are:

1. **MoSCoW:** Categorizes features as Must-have, Should-have, Could-have, and Won't-have.
2. **RICE Scoring:** A quantitative method that scores features based on Reach, Impact, Confidence, and Effort.
 - Reach:** Identify the number of people or events over time, such as transactions per quarter or conversions per month.
 - Impact:** Determine whether an idea achieves business goals or meets customer needs.
 - Confidence:** Measure the team's confidence level in executing ideas with a percentage scale of high (100%), medium (80%), and low (50%).
 - Effort:** Calculate the time it will take the team to execute the idea.

$$\frac{Reach \times Impact \times Confidence}{Effort} = RICE\ Score$$

3. **Impact-Effort Matrix:** A simple 2x2 grid that helps prioritize based on the potential impact and the effort required to build a feature. Choose a framework that makes the most sense for the problem you're solving and use it to justify your decisions.

- **L – List the solution:**

This is where your creativity comes in! Based on your prioritized user needs, you'll now brainstorm solutions. These solutions should be specific features or functions of your product.

Aim for a few core features that address the highest-priority user needs. Be creative, but also pragmatic. Don't be afraid to think outside the box, but make sure your solutions are feasible. For each feature, explain how it directly addresses a user's need.

- **E – Evaluate trade-offs:**

The second last step of the framework is to evaluate the trade-offs of your solutions. You can mention the pros and cons of the solution. For example, suppose you have mentioned a rating system for an accommodation app so that users can look at the reviews from previous guests and know what to expect. In that case, it may also lead to issues where dishonest reviews might hurt the owner's business. By describing the trade-offs, you come across as thoughtful, analytical, and objective. You'll also protect yourself from being defensive. If you've taken the initiative to critique your own solutions, the interviewer has fewer things to criticize

- **S – Summarize your recommendations:**

In this optional step, you can take 20-30 seconds to summarize your answer using the following three steps

1. Which feature do you recommend?
2. Recap on what it is and why it is beneficial for the users and/or the company
3. Why do you prefer this solution over others?

VISTA, a shorter alternative (Framework)

VISTA compresses the same thinking into five moves and can be quicker to hold in your head mid-interview. It is not a substitute for understanding CIRCLES; it is a lighter scaffold once the underlying habits are already there.

- **V, vision.** Define the problem and tie it explicitly to the company's mission or stated goals.
- **I, identify.** Select the target persona, ideally grounded in some behavioural signal rather than a demographic guess.
- **S, structure.** Brainstorm two or three distinct features, not a long list.
- **T, trade-offs.** Prioritize by weighing impact against effort.
- **A, articulate.** Set the success metrics and the indicators you would track.

Either scaffold is acceptable. Pick the one that holds up better under your own pressure, and do not try to use both in the same answer.

Product Improvement: Another slightly different question that's also common in interviews is Product Improvement. Interviewers can ask, "How will you improve Instagram?". You can use CIRCLES here as well, and the framework for both Product Design and Improvement largely remains the same.

Tip: Most students will be following the same framework, which might get very repetitive for the interviewers. To stand out, keep the interview as natural and use the framework only to structure your thoughts. Genuinely show passion and creativity, and bring different perspectives which you can develop by reading more, analysing products more deeply and being more curious about why a product is how it is.

REIMAGINE WITH AI

A product-improvement question with an AI constraint. The test is not whether you can attach a chatbot to the product; it is whether AI creates enough incremental value to justify its quality, cost, latency and operational complexity. Treat the AI capability as one possible mechanism inside the product, not as the objective.

High-level knowledge is sufficient for most PM interviews. You should be able to explain what an LLM is, when it is useful, the basic architecture around it, how models are selected and evaluated, and the major cost and reliability trade-offs. A few companies, particularly technical PM teams, may go deeper (that too only when you come from a technical background; otherwise they don't go deeper) into architecture, model training, inference, retrieval or evaluation methodology.

Where AI belongs

Start with the user problem, then ask whether AI changes the solution space. AI is particularly useful when the input or desired output is difficult to handle with deterministic rules.

- **Strong AI fit:** unstructured inputs, natural-language interaction, generation, multimodal interpretation and context-heavy assistance.
- **Usually not an AI problem:** calculations, policy rules, exact validation, transactional state changes and deterministic workflows.
- If search, rules, a recommender or conventional ML solves the problem more cheaply and predictably, use that instead.

Do not force AI into a product merely because the question contains “AI”. If a rules engine, search system, recommender, SQL query or conventional ML model solves the problem more cheaply and predictably, that can be the better product decision.

How to identify the AI opportunity

1. Map the current journey. Identify where the user spends time interpreting, searching, creating, deciding or repeating work.
2. Find the bottleneck. Ask whether the friction comes from unstructured information, personalization, language, or the need to reason across context.
3. Define the AI job. State precisely what the model is doing: classify, extract, summarize, generate, recommend, answer, predict, or take an action.
4. Compare against the non-AI solution. The AI feature should win on a meaningful user or business metric, not simply feel more futuristic.
5. Check the technical bar. The more consequential the output, the stronger the requirements for grounding, validation, human review, monitoring and fallback.

Basic technical mental model

Think: model + context + tools + guardrails + evals. The model provides the intelligence; the surrounding system determines what information it sees, what it is allowed to do, how its output is constrained, and whether it is good enough to ship.

Component	What it means for a PM
LLM/foundation model	Probabilistic model that generates or interprets tokens; not a database or deterministic rules engine.
Prompt/context	Instructions + relevant information supplied at inference time.
RAG/retrieval	Retrieve private/current information and put it into context when the model alone lacks it.
Tool/function calling	Model selects a structured action; the application executes and validates it.
Guardrails	Permissions, schema checks, safety filters, limits, approval and deterministic validation.
Evals	Repeatable tests of the system against quality and product requirements.

Tokens: the unit behind model usage

LLMs process text as tokens rather than whole words. In English, a rough rule of thumb is about 4 characters or 0.75 words per token, but tokenization varies by language, code and formatting. Both input and output tokens can be billed. Long prompts, retrieved documents, tool definitions and conversation history can therefore become a material part of cost.

- **Input tokens:** everything sent to the model, including instructions and retrieved context.
- **Output tokens:** everything generated by the model. Reasoning-enabled models may also meter internal reasoning tokens depending on the provider.
- **Cached input:** repeated context may be priced lower by some providers, making prompt caching useful for long, repeated system instructions or documents.
- For an interview, think in cost per completed user task, not cost per API call: a task that requires three model calls, retrieval and a tool call is more expensive than one simple completion.

Technical bar by use case

The point is not to memorize architectures. Use the table to calibrate how much technical depth the proposed feature actually requires.

Use case	Typical product improvement	Technical bar
Summarize / classify / extract	Turn long tickets, documents or reviews into structured information for a user or employee.	Small/mid model; structured output; representative evals. No RAG if source text contains the answer.
Personalized discovery	Help a user discover products, content or actions using natural-language preferences and history.	Existing recommender/retrieval + LLM where useful; evaluate relevance and downstream engagement.
Knowledge / support copilot	Answer questions using company policies, product information or user-specific records.	RAG + access controls + grounding + freshness + factuality evals + human escalation for high-impact cases.
Agentic action	Interpret a request and perform actions such as updating a record, creating a campaign or completing a workflow.	Tool calling + permissions + validation + logging + approval + robust evals + deterministic fallback.

A useful distinction: “the model can produce the answer” is a lower technical bar than “the system can safely take the action”. Moving from generation to action introduces permissions, state, tool reliability, reversibility and auditability.

Problems with LLMs

- **Hallucination:** fluent output can be false. Ground, cite, validate and escalate where needed.
- **Non-determinism:** outputs vary. Use structured outputs, constraints and deterministic checks.
- **Context noise:** irrelevant context can reduce quality and increase cost. Retrieve selectively.
- **Prompt injection:** untrusted content can influence model/tool behaviour. Restrict permissions and test adversarial cases.
- **Latency and cost:** use smaller models, caching, shorter context, streaming or escalation when appropriate.
- **Model changes:** rerun evals when models or prompts change.

Choosing an LLM

Do not choose a model from a leaderboard alone. Match the model to the task and then benchmark the candidates on your own workload. A useful decision order is:

1. **Quality bar:** What must the model reliably do? A simple extraction task may need far less capability than open-ended reasoning or tool use.

2. **Modalities and context:** Does the task need text only, images/audio, long documents, or large conversation history?
3. **Latency:** Is this a synchronous consumer interaction, an employee workflow, or an offline batch job?
4. **Cost:** Compare input and output token prices, expected token volume, caching, tool costs and infrastructure rather than looking only at the headline model price.
5. **Reliability and controls:** Check structured outputs, tool calling, deployment options, privacy/data requirements and the ability to pin or version a model.
6. **Evaluate before deciding:** Run the same representative test set against the shortlisted models and choose the cheapest model that clears the required quality bar, not the most powerful model available.

Current pricing: useful numbers, not numbers to memorise

Illustrative standard API list prices checked 30 August 2026; prices change frequently and may vary by tier, context length, caching, batch mode or tools. Quote the order of magnitude in an interview rather than pretending a price is permanent.

Model	Input / 1M tokens	Output / 1M tokens	Positioning
GPT-5.6 Luna	\$0.20	\$1.20	Cost-sensitive, high-volume
GPT-5.6 Terra	\$2.00	\$12.00	Balance of intelligence and cost
GPT-5.6 Sol	\$4.00	\$20.00	Frontier / complex reasoning
Claude Sonnet 5	\$2.00	\$10.00	Strong general-purpose / reasoning
Claude Opus 5	\$5.00	\$25.00	Higher-end reasoning / agentic work

Example: at 2,000 input tokens + 500 output tokens per request, 1,000 requests would cost roughly \$1.00 on GPT-5.6 Luna versus \$20.00 on GPT-5.6 Sol before caching, tools or other charges. The point is the scale of the difference: model choice can materially change unit economics.

Open-source / open-weight models

Open models become interesting when control is worth more than the convenience of a hosted API. “Open source” and “open weight” are not identical licensing categories, so check the specific model licence before assuming unrestricted commercial use.

- **Privacy/sovereignty:** self-hosting can keep sensitive data within a company, cloud account or geography.

- **Cost at scale:** for very high, predictable volumes, owning or reserving inference infrastructure can be attractive compared with paying per token, although GPUs, engineering and operations become your cost.
- **Customization:** weights can enable fine-tuning, quantization and domain-specific optimization where the licence permits it.
- **Latency/edge:** smaller models can be deployed closer to the user or on controlled infrastructure.
- **Trade-off:** self-hosting shifts responsibility to the product/engineering team for serving, scaling, security, monitoring, upgrades and evaluation. A cheap model is not cheap if the infrastructure and engineering burden dominate.

In an interview, the useful answer is usually not “open source is cheaper”. It is “I would consider an open model when data control, deployment control, customization or predictable high-volume economics justify taking on the infrastructure and model-operations burden.”

Cost implications beyond token price

- **Inference:** input/output volume, model choice and number of calls per task.
- **Context:** retrieval, long histories and documents increase token consumption; caching can reduce repeated-context cost.
- **Architecture:** RAG adds retrieval/embedding costs; agents multiply model and tool calls.
- **Operations:** self-hosting adds infrastructure and engineering costs.
- **Failure:** retries, human review, support, refunds and wrong actions are real AI costs.

A simple production cost model is: $\text{volume} \times \text{average calls per task} \times \text{average input/output tokens} \times \text{model rates} + \text{retrieval/tool/infrastructure costs} + \text{human-review or failure costs}$. This is enough to show commercial awareness without doing a full cloud-finance exercise.

Evals: the missing piece in most AI answers

An AI feature cannot be judged by a demo. Build a representative evaluation set and use it to compare prompts, models and system changes. The dataset should contain normal cases, edge cases, ambiguous cases and known failure modes, ideally drawn from real usage or expert-created examples.

- **Task quality:** did the system accomplish the intended task?
- **Correctness/groundedness:** is the answer factually supported by the available evidence?
- **Completeness and relevance:** did it cover what matters without adding irrelevant content?
- **Safety and policy:** does it refuse or escalate appropriately when required?
- **Tool behaviour:** did it call the right tool with the right arguments and respect permissions?
- **Latency and cost:** is the quality achieved fast and cheaply enough for the product?

- **Business outcome:** does the feature move the actual product metric, such as resolution rate, conversion, time saved or retention?

LLM-as-judge can make subjective evaluation scalable, but it should not be treated as ground truth. Calibrate it against human judgement, use deterministic checks where possible, and inspect disagreement cases.

Use AI in the product-improvement decision

The final decision is still product management. AI is one implementation option. A strong improvement decision compares at least three paths: keep the current experience, improve it with conventional software/ML, or introduce generative AI. The AI option should survive the same prioritization criteria as any other feature.

- **Feasibility:** can the product provide data, permissions, integrations, monitoring and fallback?
- **Quality + economics:** what error rate is acceptable, and does incremental value exceed inference, review and failure costs?
- **Incremental advantage:** what can AI do that search, rules, analytics, recommenders or ordinary UX cannot do as well?
- **User value:** does AI solve the pain materially better, faster or more personally?

The recommendation can therefore be “use AI”, “use a smaller AI component”, “use conventional ML/software”, or “do not build this yet”. The ability to reject AI is part of the answer.

What to know for interviews

- Know what an LLM does and does not do; understand tokens, context, RAG, tool calling and guardrails.
- Know why model selection is a workload-specific quality/latency/cost decision rather than a leaderboard decision.
- Know the main failure modes and why evals are necessary before and after launch.
- Know when open models make sense and what self-hosting gives up in exchange for control.
- Know enough economics to explain why model size, token volume, context, call count, and latency affect the product decision.
- Do not over-technicalise the answer unless the interviewer takes you there. For most PM interviews, high-level system understanding plus sound product judgement is sufficient; technical PM or AI-native roles may probe much deeper.

FAVOURITE PRODUCT

One of the most common openers, and frequently a gateway into a design question through the follow-up “how would you improve it?” Prepare answers for one or two products you genuinely like, and prepare a hardware product as well, since interviewers sometimes specify hardware and most candidates only have apps ready.

Keep it to one or two minutes, and cover:

1. **What the product is.**

2. **What problem it solves, in one or two lines.** Pick the single biggest user problem it addresses rather than listing everything it does.
3. **Why you like it, from the user's pain point.** Take two or three features at most and explain how the product solves that pain differently from its competitors or substitutes. This is the part that shows whether you understand user needs and how features map to them, so give it most of the time.

Have two or three products ready, because a common follow-up is simply to ask for another one. Prepare a least favourite product too, which is being asked increasingly often and catches people who have only rehearsed the positive version.

Practise this one out loud with peers. It is standard enough that a rambling answer is conspicuous, and clarity here sets the tone for the rest of the interview.

A typical follow-up question is “How will you improve this product?”. You can use the CIRCLES framework here. You may first clarify on what aspect you should think about improving- would it be acquisition, engagement, retention or monetisation. Based on the response, go back to CIRCLES, draw out user personas, and think about new features that can improve the product. Here, it is important to be more strategic than tactical. Do not say something small like “we should reduce the crash rate” or suggest some minor UI improvement.

***Choosing well:** Interviewers hear the same handful of products constantly. Something less common is easier to make interesting, though the genuinely important thing is that you actually use and care about it. If you do pick a very common product, you need a perspective on it that the interviewer has not already heard several times that week.*

GUESSTIMATE

What is a guesstimate?

It is a process to estimate a number using a rational and structured approach. The **process and rationale** are more important than the final number. It tests how quick and logical you are with numbers.

Key Evaluation Parameters:

- Structured Thought Process
- Logic and Rationale
- Comfort with Basic Math and Numbers (Ratio, %ages)
- Clear Communication of Assumptions

Stepwise Approach:

1. **Define the problem:** Clarify the question as granularly as possible with the interviewer to confirm your understanding of the problem
2. **Choose and name your direction:** Decide between top-down and bottom-up and say which one you are using and why before you start calculating.
 - a. **Top-down** starts from a large, known anchor, usually population, and narrows it through a series of filters. It is the better default for consumer markets, since population and penetration figures are easy to reason about.
 - b. **Bottom-up** starts from a single unit, such as one store, one driver or one restaurant, and scales up. It works better when supply is easier to picture than demand, such as sizing revenue from fuel stations or gyms.
 - c. Naming your choice out loud is itself part of what is being scored, not just a preamble to the real work.
3. **Construct & Deconstruct:** Express the problem as an equation or set of equations. Construct the problem from a larger point of view. Break it down into smaller, manageable sub-components.
4. **State Assumptions & Solve:** Clearly state and justify all assumptions. Use logical justification to substantiate all assumptions/proxies. Plug them into your equation and solve. Perform a sanity check on your final number.

Use of proxies:

Guesstimate questions often require you to estimate a number that isn't directly available. You can use a proxy, which is a related variable that's easier to find or estimate.

Let's take the question, "How many people in Bengaluru use online food delivery apps like Swiggy or Zomato?" It's nearly impossible to find this exact number.

Instead, you could use these proxies:

- Total population of Bengaluru: You can use a round number, like 13 million.
- Percentage of urban population that has a smartphone: A reasonable estimate might be 80-90%. You can justify this by mentioning the high smartphone penetration in major Indian cities.
- Percentage of smartphone users who order food online: This is a more complex proxy. You could break it down by age group or income level. For instance, you could estimate that 70% of young, working professionals use these apps, while a smaller percentage of older or lower-income individuals do.
- Frequency of ordering: You could also factor in the average number of orders per month to get a sense of the market size.

By using these proxies, you can build a logical framework to arrive at a well-reasoned estimate, even without having the exact data.

Tip: Try to remember some key numbers such as Indian population, percentage of rural vs urban, population split based on income etc. It's also important to articulate any assumption you are making. You can do this from general observations, industry knowledge or using proxies. Interviewers are looking for a structured approach and not the exact answer. Your creativity in breaking up the problem would be the key here.

METRICS

Metrics questions test whether you can define measures that actually tell you something about the health of a product or feature. There are always many candidate metrics, and the point is to select the important ones through a defensible process rather than listing everything trackable. Vanity metrics such as total downloads are the standard trap; you want measures that tell you what users are doing and why.

Typical questions:

- What metrics would you use to measure the success of a new feature on LinkedIn?
- How would you measure the health of YouTube?
- How would you measure the success of a new food delivery app?

The GAME structure

1. **Goals.** Agree with the interviewer on the user and business objectives before naming a single metric, because what you measure depends entirely on what the product is trying to achieve. Explain your understanding of the product, the goal you think it should pursue, and the assumptions behind that.
2. **Actions.** List the actions users can take in the product. This keeps you anchored to things that are actually trackable and forces you to be concrete about what engagement means here. Be thorough but do not disappear into detail.
3. **Metrics.** Convert the prioritized actions into measures. If the action is placing an order, the metrics are daily orders, conversion rate, and so on.
4. **Evaluate.** Close by answering the original question with your recommended metrics, then name their trade-offs and limitations. Showing you know where your own measures are weak is most of the value of this step.

Choosing the goal: the AARRR lens

When you are unsure which objective matters, walk the user lifecycle and pick the stage that fits the product's situation. Acquisition is about attracting new users. Activation is about getting them to complete a key first action. Retention is about bringing them back. Referral is about word-of-mouth growth. Revenue is about monetization. A new feature on an established product is usually an activation or retention question, not an acquisition one, and saying that explicitly demonstrates you understand where the product actually is.

Structuring what you name

A strong answer is layered rather than flat, and naming the layers out loud is what separates it from a list:

- **A North Star** that captures delivered value and moves only if users are genuinely better off.
- **Two to four input metrics** that you can actually influence, which are the levers underneath the North Star.
- **Output metrics** such as revenue, retention and margin, which matter but lag.
- **Guardrail metrics** that must not degrade while you optimize for the primary one.
- **Counter-metrics** that name how your primary metric could be gamed. Very few candidates raise these unprompted, and doing so is a strong signal.

Attach targets where you reasonably can. “Seven-day retention, targeting thirty percent by month six” is a metric. “Retention” is a word.

***Why this one pays off twice:** Metrics questions frequently arrive as a follow-up to a design question, and a firm grip on metrics also strengthens your root cause answers, since diagnosing a metric movement requires knowing what the metric is made of. Practising this type improves several others at once.*

RCA (Root Cause Analysis)

Root cause analysis (RCA) is a problem-solving method. It's used to identify the underlying causes of issues or faults in a product or the product management process. The objective of RCA is to discover what caused a particular problem, why it happened, and how to prevent it from happening again. A common format of this question looks like the interviewee asking questions and the interviewer answering them to provide more data to the candidate. A typical RCA question looks like: You are a PM at Flipkart, and orders have gone down by 10%. Figure out the cause and how to fix it.

Step 1: Clarify

Start by asking clarifying questions about the problem statement to go into the granularity. A few clarifying questions can be:

- What is the exact definition of the metric? - Start by defining the metric yourself and confirm if your understanding is right
- How long has this trend persisted
- Is the data reliable across various cuts like geography, iOS/android etc

Step 2: Confirm the drop is real

Before you look for a cause, check whether there is genuinely something to explain. Ask whether anything changed in tracking, logging or the analytics pipeline around the time of the drop, and whether the same drop shows up in more than one data source, such as the

app's own logs against a payments processor's record of the same transactions. A broken measurement produces exactly the same graph as a real problem, and chasing root causes for a metric that only looks broken wastes the rest of the interview. This step is easy to skip because it feels like it is not "real" analysis yet, which is exactly why interviewers notice when a candidate remembers it.

Step 3: Discuss external factors

You already have some context about the situation after step 1. Use this information to think of major external factors that could have influenced the product in any way. An excellent way to test the involvement of external factors in a problem is to ask, "Is this an industry-specific problem or company-specific?" Industry-specific problems can have root causes in factors beyond their line of work. (For example, a roadside vegetable vendor has a bad season because people have started buying packaged food post-COVID-19).

Some common external factors to check for-

1. Any recent natural calamity/Power Shutdown (can be asked when the trend is not gradual or a single-point decline in the graph.)
2. New government regulation/policy change?
3. New product entry in the market/product substitute.
4. Sentiments on social media? (E.g. Controversial tweet by company, fake news around the company, etc.)

Step 4: Discuss internal factors - detailed user journey

After ticking off external factors, if everything seems fine, you move on to internal factors. These are factors within the product which might be causing the metric to go haywire. Reasons can include a product change - both backend and frontend- a product bug - mostly backend, etc. For this, the first step is to build the user journeys or funnel for popular actions in products. Once you have laid down the user journey, your next step would be to ask follow-up questions on the user journey - for example, conversion at each node of the user journey. Most often, this will help you conclude.

Step 5: Conclusion & recommendation

Once you have identified the root cause, you are expected to summarize the entire discussion. Sometimes an interviewer might even want you to discuss solutions to mitigate the problem. It is always recommended to suggest solutions regardless of the interviewer asking you to.

Tip: Make sure to keep your interviewer informed about what approach you're taking towards narrowing down the issue. For example, telling them that you plan to explore government regulations first and then understand competition later, because the business is extremely susceptible to changes in regulation, is a good way to do this. It helps you provide reasoning for your choices and gives the interviewer the chance to prod you in a

certain direction, if they wish to.

GTM (Go-To-Market)

What is Go-To-Market/GTM?

Go-to-market questions are usually not an independent question of their own, but a part of a larger product strategy or product design problem. It is a more 'generalist' question, testing your knowledge of strategy, operations, and marketing, in addition to product sense. Some ways in which it can be asked are:

1. Ok, you want to design XYZ feature. How will you take it to market? (You want to launch Stories on the Blinkit App. How would you take it to market?)
2. What would be the launch strategy for XYZ feature?

Frameworks

You can borrow the 3C, 4P, Segmentation-Targeting-Positioning framework (refer to consulting casebooks) to answer these questions. However, avoid blindly applying a framework, as this question is more about thinking on your feet and being practical about the real-world applications of a problem.

Factors to Consider in a Go-to-Market problem:

1. *Who are the users this feature is being launched for and what is the pain point it is solving?*

Here, briefly explain your understanding of the target segment for this feature. For instance, if the question is 'How will you launch 10-minute food delivery on Zomato', spend a few seconds sharply defining who will be the customer segment to launch this feature to first. For instance, you can say you will launch it for breakfast, for working professionals, as they don't have time to wait for breakfast or make breakfast on their own.

2. *How will you position this product for them?*

What will be the key value proposition for this user? Use your understanding of consumer behaviour and marketing to explain the usefulness of the feature for the user

3. *How will you reach this user?*

Think through what marketing channels are available to reach this user. You should further structure the channels into online/offline, existing users/new users and so on depending on the context. If we are building a feature for an App that already has a lot of users, talk about using push notifications, email, etc to target existing users.

4. How will you price the product?

Only talk about this briefly if pricing is important to the problem. You can talk through the Pricing framework or even discuss from first principles. Here, you can also mention promotions, i.e. how will you incentivise the user to use the product. You can discuss free trials, discounts, etc.

5. What are the operational aspects of taking this product to market?

The launch of some products/features would involve a significant operational aspect. This is especially true of marketplaces where building the supply side is as important as building the demand side. If you are talking about launching a new category on ecommerce, etc, always talk about how you would build the supply side as well. For instance, in the 10-minute delivery question for Zomato, you should think through how you will ensure meals are ready in 10 minutes, prioritising restaurants, the value proposition for restaurants, etc.

All in all, GTM is an extremely broad topic, and you won't have time to go through every aspect. Lay down your framework in the beginning and let the interviewer know which aspects of the GTM you will be discussing in your answer. If the interviewer wants you to focus on only 1 or 2 (which will most likely be the case), they will nudge you in the right direction. However, it is important to demonstrate to the interviewer that you are aware of all aspects.

Tip: The strongest GTM answers are specific about where the users actually are, whether that means particular communities online, events they attend, or moments in their day when the product is relevant. Naming channels generically is what most answers do; naming the exact places is what separates them.

PRODUCT STRATEGY

What is Product Strategy?

These are broad questions about the business as a whole or solving for a new customer segment. The key is to think broadly, not just about a single feature. Always ask clarifying questions to narrow the scope. These interviews are often interviewer-led.

Examples:

- What should Netflix build in the next 5 years?
- How can you build a social experience on an OTT platform?
- How would you solve the language barrier in India?

Frameworks (Use as needed, don't force them):

- **Segmentation:** Segment users to identify white spaces.
- **Ansoff Growth Matrix:** A framework to lay out whether the bet is existing or new product against existing or new market
- **Porter's 5 Forces:** Where industry structure and the threat of substitutes genuinely bear on the answer.

PRICING

Pricing questions are critical and can be standalone or part of a larger case, usually as how you would price a product or how you would raise its revenue.

Examples:

- How would you price a particular product?
- How would you increase the revenue of the product?

Key Clarifying Points:

- **Business Goal:** Is it market share growth (lower price) or profit maximization (higher price)?
- **Market State:** Is the market growing, mature, or declining?
- **Product Differentiation:** Highly differentiated products can command a higher price.
- **Target Segments:** Understand the segment's willingness-to-pay (WTP).

Pricing Models:

- **Cost Plus:** Calculate total costs and add a markup. This often sets the price floor.
- **Value-Based:** Determine the monetary value (e.g., savings, earnings) your product provides to the customer and price based on that.
- **Competitor-Based:** Price relative to competitors, depending on your strategy.

Use at least two frameworks to arrive at a price range, then justify where your final price would fall within that range.

SALARY & OFFER NEGOTIATION

Read this first. Negotiating is a real decision with a real downside, not a free option you exercise because you can. The purpose of this section is to help you work out whether you should negotiate at all, and only then, how to do it without harming yourself.

1. Should You Negotiate at All?

Most of the value in this section is in this question, not in the tactics further down. Work through the following honestly before you decide.

The hard rule: blue-flagged companies

If a company is blue flagged, you **cannot** negotiate. This is not a judgement call or a risk you are choosing to take; it is a rule of the ISB placement process. Check the tag on the offer before you think otherwise. Some offers also carry an explicit field indicating whether negotiation is permitted. Read it.

If you are switching functions, the role is the prize

This is the single most important point in this section. If you are breaking into a new function, moving into product, or strategy, or any role you have not held before, the offer itself is the thing you came for. One candidate who had already worked in the function put it plainly: if you have never done this role before, you might gain a few lakhs by negotiating, but if it goes wrong, you are back to trying to break in from outside placements, which is a far harder and longer road than the money is worth.

If you already have a track record in the function, your downside is different; you can credibly get another such role elsewhere. If you do not, treat the offer as won and leave it alone.

Read the signals from your interviews carefully

Several people said the decision to negotiate started during the interviews themselves, not after the offer. Things they read as genuine interest:

- Rounds that moved quickly and without heavy scrutiny, where the interviewer seemed satisfied early
- Visible engagement when you were speaking, an interviewer leaning into a particular idea rather than testing you on it
- Being asked to wait for the next round rather than being released, or the process being accelerated around you
- Knowing, or reasonably inferring, that the team needed someone specific for a specific piece of work

These are *soft* signals, and they are easy to over-read, particularly when you want a particular answer. A friendly interview is not leverage on its own. Treat these as one input among several, not as permission.

What is your actual fallback?

Be honest with yourself about what happens if the answer for your negotiation is a flat no, or worse:

- More than one soft offer in hand is a genuinely different position from a single offer, and it changes how much you can push
- A single soft offer means you are gambling with the only thing you have by negotiating

- If you have deep expertise the team specifically needs and cannot easily replace, you have real standing
- If you are one of several comparable candidates for the same role, you do not, and you should assume they know that

One person described their own reasoning as a straightforward test: if you have no unique selling point for your profile and they can find your replacement easily, you are on the lower hand and should take the offer and perform your way to a better number later.

The company matters as much as you do

The same ask lands very differently depending on who is on the other side:

- Fast-growing or recently funded companies generally have more room and more willingness to move
- Bootstrapped companies usually do not have the room, irrespective of whatever they think of you as a candidate
- A company approaching a public listing may be reluctant on equity specifically, while still being able to move on cash
- The largest and most sought-after firms, and top-tier consulting, often do not negotiate on campus at all; they have a deep queue of candidates and no reason to
- Some large firms run separate, less flexible terms for campus hires than for lateral hires. That is frustrating, but it is not something you can argue your way out of

When this applies: Assessing a company this way needs real information, not guesswork. If you have not spoken to anyone who knows the company from the inside, you cannot judge how much room they have.

2. Pre-Work: Everything Happens Before the Call

Understand this clearly: once the negotiation conversation begins, you do not get to pause it. The other side can pause and return to you; you cannot count on the same. Every calculation, every fallback, every number has to be settled in your mind before you pick up the phone.

Talk to people inside the company

- Current employees give you the baseline for what a level actually pays
- People who have left are often more candid about compensation and about the company's problems
- Alumni in the same function elsewhere help your sanity-check whether a number is normal for the market or not
- Ask specifically about structure, not just totals, what the split looks like, what is standard at each level, what is negotiable and what is not

Make a good impression before you need it

More than one person made the same point: the negotiation goes better if you have been courteous and easy to deal with through the interview process; you start from a reasonable

base. If you have been difficult, or made a poor impression earlier, that is what you are negotiating against. The more impressed the interviewers are, the better the chances that HR might listen to your ask.

Know how the company is doing right now

Recent funding, hiring appetite, public commentary, and the known risks of joining are all relevant contexts. If a company carries visible risk, that is a legitimate part of the conversation; you are being asked to take on that risk, and it is reasonable for that to be reflected in what you are offered.

***When this applies:** Raising a company's risks is a real lever, but it is a delicate one. Done well, it reads as a candidate who has done their homework and is thinking seriously about joining. Done badly, it reads as criticism of the company you are asking to hire you. If you cannot make the point in a way that sounds like genuine due diligence, do not make it.*

Know why you are valuable, in one sentence

Whatever number you quote, you should be able to say why you are worth it without hesitating. Vague answers get taken apart quickly. The strongest cases in these conversations were narrow and concrete: specific domain depth the team was actively hiring for, direct experience of the exact problem they were trying to solve, or a track record in the precise function they needed.

People also found it useful to think back through what the interviewers seemed to respond to, the points that clearly landed in each round. Those are the things the firm has already told itself it likes about you. That is what you build the case on.

Know your process

- Find out how a negotiation request is routed at ISB during placements
- Find out how long your window is. It can be very short
- Know what the offer already says before you ask for anything

3. Setting Your Target and Doing the Math

Start from your life, not from a number you heard

One person's clearest regret was fixating on a headline figure because it was a large multiple of their previous salary, without ever working out what they actually needed. Their advice, in hindsight, was to build the target from the ground up: the city you will be in, rent, what you send home, monthly costs, any loan repayments, and what you want to be able to save. Then work out what package supports that comfortably.

A number built this way is far easier to defend, because it is real. It also stops you chasing a figure for its own sake.

***Note:** A value derived using this method doesn't define what your skills are worth; it could be more or less. This is just a base calculation that might come in handy.*

Look for pointers in the JD that could give you leverage in the negotiation. Ex: The JD states a single number in pay, without a breakdown (use it to drive your fixed comp up). It states location as PAN India, yet you are forced to take a location (use that in the form of increased living expenses), and so on.

One number, not a range

If you quote a range, expect the conversation to proceed from the bottom of it. Decide on a single figure. Several people suggested quoting slightly above your true target so there is room to bring it down but keep it defensible. A number you cannot justify undermines everything else you have said.

Be ready to explain where the number came from: market benchmarks for the level, what the function typically pays, what you were earning before, what you bring to the table. Explaining the number is what separates a considered ask from a figure pulled out of the air, and experienced HR professionals can tell the difference immediately.

Understand the whole structure, not just the headline

Compensation is made of parts, and the parts have very different flexibility. Know all of them before you start:

- Fixed versus variable split, a higher fixed component is usually worth more to you than a bigger headline number
- Equity or stock, where it applies, and how it vests
- Joining bonus and retention bonus
- Clawback conditions and how long they run
- Notice period
- Relocation, and any cost you are absorbing by moving cities
- Tax-efficient components of the structure

This is why mental arithmetic matters. If someone moves one component, you need to know immediately what it does to the total and whether it is actually an improvement.

Decide what you are negotiating for, and hold that line

Pick one thing: compensation, or level and designation. Do not go in asking for both and hoping to see what happens. If you are unclear on your own priority, that will show, and the conversation will move between the two in a way that ends with you getting neither.

One candidate negotiating for a level rather than a number was explicit about this: they had two or three reasons for the level they were asking for, and they returned to the same reasons every time, across multiple conversations, without adding new ones or drifting into other asks. Consistency was the whole strategy.

When this applies: Negotiating for a level jump is harder than negotiating on cash, and most firms have firm conventions about who sits at what level. This is a realistic ask only when your prior seniority was clearly above the level being offered, or you

have depth the firm is specifically short of. Without one of those, it is very unlikely to move.

4. Running the Conversation

Most people who did this well described the conversation in almost identical terms: calm, professional, and unhurried. Not a contest. One person described it as two people trying to find common ground on what needs to be aligned. That framing matters more than any technique below, because the person across the table has done this many more times than you have, will talk to your placement office afterwards, and may well be a colleague a few months down the line.

It is ideal to keep the negotiation to the last round (HR one). If you try to do it in one of the early rounds, it might backfire.

Tone is the thing that protects you

- Be respectful and straightforward throughout. Aggression is the fastest way to turn a routine conversation into a problem
- Be transparent about what you want and why. A consistent, honest position holds up whether they call you twice or ten times
- Ask about their constraints rather than pushing blindly. Understanding why they cannot move on. This will give you a chance to exactly counter their blockers (if it's about skills); if it's about a specific pay component, you can move to another.

That last point is worth dwelling on. Several people found the conversation shifted once they stopped arguing against a position and started asking what was driving it, what the real constraint was, how the decision was being made, what would need to be true for the answer to change. Approached with genuine curiosity rather than as a manoeuvre, it tends to produce a more useful conversation for both sides.

Go in with more than one ask in your mind

Take three or four things you would value, in priority order, not a single demand. If the company genuinely cannot move on your first ask, because of a policy, a band, or something structural, a second ask gives the conversation somewhere to go rather than ending it.

This is what several people did in practice. When the headline ask ran into a firm policy, they moved to a different component and got a real improvement there instead. If there is a hard pay band, the flexible parts are usually elsewhere: joining or retention bonus, clawback length, notice period, or the fixed-variable split. Though most negotiations usually swing between 2-3 components (fixed, variable, ESOPs, etc).

When this applies: *This works when your fallback asks are genuinely things you want, and when you can move between them without appearing to negotiate at random. Have the ladder decided before the call, in order. Improvising new asks mid-conversation is how a focused negotiation turns into a scattered one.*

Expect pressure, and recognise it for what it is

- Pauses by HR during the negotiation can create stress. Do not read it as rejection, and do not feel obliged to immediately improve your own offer to fill the silence
- Time pressure is common: a short deadline, a decision-maker who is unavailable, an urgent need for your answer. Sometimes this is genuine; sometimes it is applied deliberately. Either way, it is a reason to have decided your position in advance, not a reason to abandon it
- Being asked whether you have other offers is standard. Answer honestly that you are not required to disclose details, and saying so politely is perfectly acceptable

Read the room continuously

This is not a single check at the start; it runs through the whole conversation. Pay attention to tone as much as content. The people who pushed hardest did so because nothing in the conversation suggested hostility; they read it as both sides looking for common ground and pushed accordingly. Had it felt different, the correct response was to stop.

Signals that you should consider stopping negotiation, especially if your risk appetite is low (Not hard rules, depends on the situation):

- A take-it-or-leave-it tone, or a flat statement that this is the final offer
- Repetition of the same answer without any engagement with your reasoning
- Any hint of irritation, or a shift from discussion to formality

None of these means you have done something wrong. They mean the conversation has reached its limit, and continuing past that point is where the genuine risk lies.

5. When It Does Not Go Your Way

If you have conducted yourself well, the most likely outcome of an unsuccessful negotiation is simply that the original offer stands. One person's assessment was that if you have not damaged the relationship in some other way, not been aggressive, not made a poor impression earlier in the process, the realistic, worst case is that they decline and hold the offer where it was.

That is a reasonable read, but it is not a guarantee, and it assumes everything else has gone well. It is also worth saying plainly that this is exactly what someone who succeeded would conclude. Treat it as a likely outcome, not a promise.

Closing gracefully

- When the conversation reaches a limit, accept clearly and warmly. In case it didn't go well, do not let disappointment show in how you close. If it goes well, all good then.
- Thank them for considering it. You are about to work with these people
- Do not reopen the conversation afterwards, and do not relitigate it once you have accepted
- Do not compare your outcome publicly with others in your batch; it helps nobody and can create real problems

The part nobody mentions

Even the negotiations that succeeded were uncomfortable. One person described sitting in limbo for several hours after being told they would get an answer, replaying whether they should have asked at all. That feeling is normal and does not mean you made a mistake. Decide in advance that you can tolerate it, because you will not be able to opt out of it once you have started.

6. Ground Rules

- **Blue-flagged means no.** ISB doesn't allow you to try anyway.
- **If you are switching functions, think very hard before risking the offer.** The role is what you came for.
- **Do the arithmetic before the call.** You cannot step out to think once it has started.
- **One clear ask, with a prepared fallback ladder behind it.** Not a range, not a wishlist.
- **Be able to justify every number you say out loud.**
- **Stay calm and professional throughout, whatever happens.**
- **Know when to stop.** Recognizing the limit is more valuable than pushing past it.
- **Keep it reasonable.** Modest, well-argued asks succeed far more often than aggressive ones, and campus placements are a shared process; how you conduct yourself affects the people coming after you.
- **This is one negotiation in a long career.** As one person put it, it is a bonus. You will have many more opportunities to negotiate, with far more leverage than you have today.

INTERVIEW EXPERIENCES

2026 Interview Experiences

Acko

- **Role:** PM
 - **Received Offer:** No
 - **Case Submission Round:** Yes
 - **R1 (RCA):** Profitability of a Quick Fashion company is hit in the past few months?
- **Role:** PM-1
 - **Received Offer:** No
 - **Case Submission Round:** Yes
 - **R1 (Product Design, Product Improvement):** How can UrbanClap gain share in the on-demand house cleaning market amidst rising competition
 - **R2 (Product Design):** Product for early retirement/financial freedom for young adults
 - **R3 (Behavioural/Personal):** Why Insurance, Why Acko, Do you like Bangalore?
- **Role:** Product Manager
 - **Received Offer:** Yes
 - **Case Submission Round:** Yes
 - **R1 (RCA):**
 - One of your colleagues has come to you stating that she has not been able to meet her deadlines at work. How would you approach this problem and go about advising her?
 - Note: No data was given, so the idea was to see the approach to solving this problem.
 - **R2 (Product Strategy):** You are a PM at WhatsApp. How would you go about increasing WhatsApp Pay's market share?
 - **R3 (HR):**
 - - How do you feel about the whole interview experience?
 - - Why do you want to join Acko?
 - - Why do you want to get into product management?
 - **General Feedback:** Structured problem solving is what they are primarily looking for. Apart from general case prep, an important thing is to focus on researching the company well and their products. Showing genuine interest in the company's products and having a dialogue about their strategy while providing your point of view goes a long way in showing interest in joining their company.

Affinity Global

- **Role:** Associate Product Manager
 - **Received Offer:** Yes
 - **Case Submission Round:** Yes
 - **R1 (Resume, Behavioural/Personal, Product Design, Product Strategy):**
 - 1. How do you use vibe coding tools like Replit/Lovable in your daily life? (Asked because this was mentioned on my resume)
 - 2. Which is your favorite AI product? Why?
 - 3. Why Affinity Global? Why product management? What makes you a better fit vs. others?
 - 4. Some more Behavioural questions.
 - 5. CASE STUDY: You are working in the product strategy team of a large bank. You are to design an ATM kiosk to be set up in an airport. Recommend a strategic location in the airport, and more importantly, talk about how you would design this ATM to have a better value proposition to improve cash usage and do better than competitors (asked to focus on designing a better value proposition vs. current ATMs).
 - (Lengthy round with an extensive case study that covered product strategy, design, market entry, and a little bit on risks and mitigations.)
 - **R2 (Resume, Behavioural/Personal):**
 - 1. What are your long-term aspirations, and how does joining Affinity play a part in that?
 - 2. Explain a project you are proud of
 - 3. Why MBA, how has ISB helped in your product management transition journey?
 - 4. Some more Behavioural questions.

Aionos

- **Role:** APM
 - **Received Offer:** Yes
 - **Case Submission Round:** No
 - **R1 (Resume, Behavioural/Personal):**
 - 1. Explain a product lifecycle.
 - 2. Other work and Behavioural questions.
 - **R2 (Product Design, Fav Product):** What is your favourite product? - Google Maps. Why? Say you had to improve it, how would you? I broke down the personas, identified the pain point, and brainstormed a solution. Asked for metrics and UI wireframe of solution (this was unique). Interviewer did some back and forth to make me change my approach; he was seeing if I was understanding and implementing his feedback. Finally, had a short discussion where I asked him a few questions about the role.

- **R3 (RCA, Technical, Metrics):** Started with PM Behavioural questions. Then I was asked an RCA based on my work-ex, told to identify angles of approach, user journey, and metrics. Finally, asked the pricing strategy. Ended with some more Behavioural questions like what makes a good PM according to you.
- **General Feedback:**
 - 1. Research the company and ask good questions.
 - 2. Try to attend all the rounds of your top-preference company as fast as possible. Interviewers notice reschedules or delays in rounds.

BCGX

- **Role:** Product Associate
 - **Received Offer:** Yes
 - **Case Submission Round:** No
 - **R1:** (Resume, Behavioural/Personal, Product Design)
 - **R2:** (Resume, Behavioural/Personal, Product Design, Product Strategy)
 - **R3:** (Resume, Behavioural/Personal, Product Design, Product Improvement, Product Strategy)
- **Role:** Product Associate
 - **Received Offer:** No
 - **Case Submission Round:** No
 - **R1 (Resume, Behavioural/Personal, Product Design):**
 - 1. Tell me about yourself.
 - 2. What did you do at <workplace name>?
 - 3. Case: BHIM Pay has a stagnant market share. What should it do to expand its market share?
 - **R2:**
 - 1. Tell me about yourself.
 - 2. What did you do at <workplace name>?
 - 3. Case: A CEO of a Li-Ion battery manufacturer (used in two-wheelers) wants to understand how Gen AI could be used on their factory floor. Describe a few initiatives you would recommend to the CEO.
- **Role:** Product Associate
 - **Received Offer:** Yes
 - **Case Submission Round:** No
 - **R1 (Resume, Guesstimate):** Guesstimate the size of the market for M&A target identification AI based tool
 - **R2 (Resume, Behavioural/Personal):**

- **R3 (Product Design, Product Strategy):** How will you help the banking client design a branch that is more digital and AI-friendly, to improve operational cost, worker productivity, and customer delight, for a legacy banking company that already has a decent banking app?
- **Role:** Product Associate
 - **Received Offer:** Yes
 - **Case Submission Round:** No
 - **R1:** Strategy to optimise branch P&L for a private bank.
 - **R2:** Strategy for a real estate/brokerage platform's market entry, with RCA on customer pain points
 - **R3 (Product Strategy):** User pain point RCA for a bank's mobile app and improvement strategy
 - **R4:** Market entry for a healthcare/lifestyle companion app
 - **General Feedback:** Prep for consulting cases and keep in mind basic product frameworks. Always take a user-pain-point lens. Keep solution MECE.
- **Role:** Product Senior
 - **Received Offer:** No
 - **Case Submission Round:** No
 - **R1 (Product Strategy):** Rebuild health experience - linked DPI - govt push, agents - AI push; talked GTM play of preventive rather than curative.
 - **R2 (Product Improvement, Product Strategy):** Your client is a property broker; issue - too many leads and too much time spent on engaging non-valuable leads - spoke about lead consolidation, lead scoring, and engagement in a multi-modal manner.

Browserstack

- **Role:** Sr. Associate Product Strategy
 - **Received Offer:** Yes
 - **Case Submission Round:** Yes
 - **R1 (Resume):** The first round was a basic information and resume-related round. He asked me various resume-based questions and checked my basic understanding of the JD and what I was expected to do. The main questions revolved around what I did at my previous company, what my role was there and how I grew into that role. He also asked me to describe one or two of my projects, etc. So, the key takeaway is to be thorough with your resume. The first round was basically around that only, and it lasted for around 20 to 25 minutes.
 - **R2 (Product Strategy, Guesstimate, Technical):**
 - Then came the second round, which I think was the breakthrough round. The second round was about 1.5 hours, roughly 1 hour 25–30 minutes in total. It revolved entirely around my understanding of B2B SaaS. He initially started with a question like, what do you understand about B2B

SaaS as a concept? Since I was very open with him and mentioned that I hadn't worked in SaaS but had worked on a B2C product, while still having some knowledge of SaaS, he drilled deeper into the basics, such as what metrics you look at while evaluating a SaaS business, etc.

- I had prepared basic SaaS concepts and how B2B SaaS works, so I was able to explain aspects like acquisition, how the sales cycle works, PLG-related growth, service attribution, and related metrics. Once he understood what I knew, he asked me a question related to conversions and reach. Essentially, he was trying to put me into a product strategy role and assess how I structure my thoughts.
 - There was no formally structured case. Instead, we were building the case as we went along. For example, he asked how I would approach a client and pitch BrowserStack's product, what components BrowserStack currently has and whether I was aware of them. First, he asked about my understanding of the products, and I told him that I had researched what products they offer. Then he said, okay, now assume you must pitch one of these products to a client. How will you do it? That was case one.
 - Case two was something along the lines of We have an existing customer; how would you ensure retention? He also asked about what metrics I would look at if the customer was trying to switch away. So, we went step by step through various stages such as customer onboarding, the trial phase of a SaaS product, customer engagement, and the factors we look at not just company-specific factors, but also competition and broader market considerations. He was trying to see whether my structured way of thinking connected company-level decisions with market competition and macroeconomic factors as well.
 - There was also one small guesstimate. For me, it wasn't a full-fledged guesstimate, but more about conversion ratios like how much we would convert and which scheme would be better for targeting. It was more of a mini guesstimate exercise.
- **"R3 (Behavioural/Personal):** A typical HR type discussion. I don't think it was eliminative. In my view, round three felt more like a formality. They asked basic questions like strengths, weaknesses, views on culture, etc., the usual stuff.
- **Role:** Product Marketing
 - **Received Offer:** Yes
 - **Case Submission Round:** Yes
 - **R1 (Behavioural/Personal, RCA, Metrics):** RCA for decline in Flipkart orders in the last quarter.
 - **R2 (Resume, Product Design, Fav Product):** Fav Product and design a competitor to that product
 - **R3:** Resume, Behavioural/Personal

Cashfree

- **Role:** PM II

- **Received Offer:** Yes
 - **Case Submission Round:** No
 - **R1 (Product Design):** You are ISB admin. Improve the current food experience for students.
 - **R2 (Product Strategy):** You are an Uber PM. The World Cup final is happening in one week's time; a huge demand surge is expected post-event. You don't have tech bandwidth to build anything - what would you do?
 - **R3 (Behavioural/Personal):** Behavioural round with CPO - past AI residency experience, trying to assess non-work passion projects, how to measure success.
 - **R4 (HR Round):** HR round - why Cashfree? Strengths? Weaknesses? Conflict in the past?
- **Role:** Product Manager
 - **Received Offer:** No
 - **Case Submission Round:** No
 - **R1 (Product Design):**
 - 1. Introduce yourself.
 - 2. Have you used Google Maps before?
 - 3. How would you design a Google Maps enhancement to solve for parking?

Darwinbox

- **Role:** PM1
 - **Case Submission Round:** No
 - **R1 (Resume, Product Design, Product Strategy):**
 - Suggest a new product line for WhatsApp
 - Design a platform for gig workers
 - Design a performance analytics dashboard for ongoing projects for HRs and senior managers
 - Design an AI screening tool for resumes
- **Role:** PM
 - **R1 (Product Design):**
 - You are a PM at Cult. Cult Fit has internal software; now you have to create a gym management application/system end-to-end and sell it to outside gyms.
 - **R2 (Product Design, Guesstimate):**
 - Instagram: Favourite feature, least favourite feature.

- Design or improve Instagram for old people. For each segment, including old people, estimate the size of their segments and deep dive into each segment.
 - **General Feedback:** CV questions in all rounds.
- **Role:** PMM
 - **Received Offer:** Yes
 - **Case Submission Round:** No
 - **R1 (Resume, Behavioural/Personal, Product Strategy):** Product Launch strategy for US market
 - **R2 (Behavioural/Personal, Positioning + Content):**
 - Design a product pitch in 2-3 sentences for CHRO of a company (company details similar to my past workex)
 - Convert this into an internal pitch
 - Convert this into a 5-6 word Google Ad text
 - **R3 (Resume, Behavioural/Personal, Product Improvement):**
 - Resume deep dive.
 - Gaps on resume - justification.
 - “If we want to impose a 50% price increase on our product (which is an upgraded version with an additional 7 modules), how do we justify it to our existing clients, and also, how do we take the higher-priced product to market?”
 - **R4 (Behavioural/Personal):** Tested on my knowledge and understanding of the company and its product portfolio
 - **General Feedback:** Be as authentic as possible. Don't try to be someone you think they would like, be yourself. If you don't know something and have fuffed on your CV, or try to faff, they will see through it. Even if you have exaggerated here and there on CV, make sure you have a solid foolproof story ready to back it up.
- **Role:** Product Manager
 - **Received Offer:** No
 - **Case Submission Round:** Yes
 - **R1 (Product Design):** They asked me if I used running apps regularly. I mentioned that I didn't. They then asked me about my favourite desktop app and asked me to improve it using agentic AI features.
- **Role:** Product Manager
 - **Received Offer:** No
 - **Case Submission Round:** No
 - **R1 (Product Improvement):**

- Pick any project that you have worked on, and solve it using tech. How would you do it?
- The expectation was to mention the user journey, list down pain points, and suggest what all to have in the MVP (had to be as minimal as possible).
- **R2 (Product Design, Product Strategy):**
 - 1. Meta wants to enter the travel and tourism space - how would you go about it?
 - 2. Build a SaaS product for store management - how would you go about it?
 - The answers to clarifying questions were mostly generic; I had to make my own choices and defend every choice, decide what and why to build, then do product design for it.
- **General Feedback:** Darwinbox interviews are Product Design heavy

Eli Lilly

- **Role:** PM
 - **Received Offer:** Yes
 - **Case Submission Round:** Yes
 - **R1 (Product Design, Technical):** They give you a task to be completed within 30 mins or 1 hr. Mostly pen and paper
 - **R2 (Resume, Product Design, Technical):** They ask you questions around the task, product strategy and give you situations to think about and then answer. They also go through the entire resume and may ask sections of explanations
 - **R3 (Resume, Behavioural/Personal, Technical):** Revolved mostly around technical plus behavioural
- **Role:** PM
 - **Received Offer:** No
 - **Case Submission Round:** Yes
 - **R1 (Resume, Deck):** They had a written exam for a design question before the interview. Later they asked us questions based on the submission. They also had some basic questions about my previous work-ex.
 - **R2 (Resume, Behavioural/Personal):** Asked me some questions on my work-ex. They also later asked me how I would prioritise features. Why Eli Lilly, and why have you made so many switches in the past?
- **Role:** PM
 - **R1 (Product Design, Product Strategy):**
 - For obese people: smart health management. Give them a daily tracker, upload pictures of their food, and one community-sharing feature across

friends. Connect them to professionals like dieticians and gym trainers so they can show them their activity, and integrate with Apple Watches, etc.

- This is a brief about the product.
- The brief vision about the product is to empower people to reduce obesity and lead a healthy life in a positive way. Along with that, consider corner cases such as postpartum and disability, and think from the perspective of a nutritionist as well.
- **R2 (GTM, Team, UI/UX, Technology):**
 - What will be your GTM?
 - What kind of team do you need: UI/UX, backend developers (how many and who)?
- **R3 (Implementation Roadmap, AI):**
 - Implementation roadmap within 6 months: which features will you prioritize, and how will you integrate AI?
- **R4 (Future Plans):**
 - Future plans.

Ethos

- **Role:** Product Manager
 - **Received Offer:** Yes
 - **Case Submission Round:** Yes
 - **R1 (Behavioural/Personal, RCA):** Let's say Spotify's listening minutes are down by 10% over the weekend - what could the reason be? Give me only 4 hypotheses. Assume you have constraints and can investigate only one of them - which one, and why?
 - **R2 (Behavioural/Personal, Product Design):** Spoke in depth about my work and hobbies, I run a cat rescue, so the product design question was around it, design a platform for pet adoption
 - **R3 (Resume, Behavioural/Personal):** Only Behavioural and resume-based questions. Has there been a situation where you had to challenge your manager? Who was the most challenging stakeholder you dealt with, and why? What was the biggest problem you have ever solved?
- **Role:** Product Manager
 - **Received Offer:** Yes
 - **Case Submission Round:** Yes
 - **R1 (Resume, Behavioural/Personal):**
 - Completely based on the resume, where the depth of my understanding of every point was tested. Behavioural questions:
 - 1. Explain a time when you did not build a feature despite planning and deciding on it earlier. What made you do that? How did you communicate it to the stakeholders?

- 2. Give an example of a time you came up with a metric that was not previously being tracked. Why did you track it, and what did it lead to?
 - **R2 (Resume, Behavioural/Personal, RCA):**
 - Again deeper into the resume, this time in the fintech and insurtech space.
 - RCA - You are an auto insurance marketplace website where the user journey is: acquire customers through performance marketing, take inputs on their coverage needs, show all insurers, and basis the click made on a certain insurer, the website earns revenue (classic lead-gen model). Recently, across all insurers, prices have increased by 5% and commission has reduced by 10% for your website. RCA? How will you take mitigation steps to ensure the bottom line is not affected much?
 - **R3 (Behavioural/Personal):**
 - 1. Example of a very simple customer feature built. Why? What did it do? Impact?
 - 2. Example of a time you gave up short-term gains for long-term value.
 - **General Feedback:** Had a case round, but it was only eliminatory - no questions on it. Very specific to Ethos's business, so it won't be used much.
- **Role:** Product Manager
 - **Received Offer:** Yes
 - **Case Submission Round:** Yes
 - **R1 (Resume, Behavioural/Personal, Product Design, Product Strategy, Technical):**
 - Round 1 was mainly about my resume and situational product questions. Discussions were related to one of the projects I did at my previous company; the interviewer dug very deep into the how, why, and what of the project. Follow-up questions were not technical as such - situational product questions like, if you were a product manager on this product, how would you prioritise, how would you present a case to senior leadership as a PM, not a developer.
 - Takeaway - prepare your resume thoroughly, and be prepared to answer situational product-extension questions for your technical projects.
 - **R2 (Resume, Behavioural/Personal, Product Design, Product Improvement, Product Strategy, Technical):** This round was taken by a staff PM. Heavily resume- and product-strategy-focused. Asked to explain any one project from my resume, and explain it from a product perspective - what all I did as a product manager in that project, a situation where conflicts were resolved with multiple stakeholders, explain how you would improve the adoption of your feature as a PM, how you measure the success of the feature; went deep into metrics, guardrails were also asked about. The complete interview was tailored to assess how well-rounded you think as a PM.
 - **R3 (Resume, Behavioural/Personal):** This was a managerial round, taken by the Director of PM. The interview was around 20 minutes, and started off with a question - tell me about the most complex project you have worked on, why it

was that complex, and what you did to handle that. Some questions on trade-offs and handling of conflicts - tell me about a time when you disagreed with your manager, both an example where I was right and one where my manager was right. There was also a trick question about whether you would like to join your previous firm as a product manager. The interviewer mainly wanted to understand how I handle problems in real life.

- **General Feedback:** Be extremely thorough with your resume, and with on-the-spot product thinking.

EverStage

- **Role:** PM / SPM
 - **Received Offer:** No
 - **Case Submission Round:** Yes
 - **R1 (Resume, Behavioural/Personal, Metrics):**
 - Where to use AI; case PPT discussion - focusing on finance admin persona - payouts, JTBD.
 - Metrics that you would prioritise as finance lead at the org.

Flipkart

- **Role:** PM-1
 - **Case Submission Round:** No
 - **R1 (RCA):**
 - Swiggy's CSAT has decreased from 4.7 to 4. What could be the cause?
 - (Everyone had a different answer; mine was a change in delivery workforce.) Focus more on the approach and asking clarifying questions instead of rushing to an answer.
 - **R2 (Product Improvement):**
 - What is one product you use a lot? I said YouTube Music.
 - Why do you like it?
 - As a PM at Spotify, how will you persuade YouTube Music customers to move to Spotify?
 - (They were judging the approach, and how well you could defend your solutions when they cross-questioned.)
 - **R3 (Behavioural/Personal, Product Design):** A mix of behavioural (why PM, why Flipkart, where do you see yourself in 5 years) plus a few product design related questions

Gameberry

- **Role:** PM - 1
 - **Case Submission Round:** Yes
 - **R1 (RCA):** You're a PM @ Swiggy, based out of Mumbai. Your operations head comes to you and informs you that the number of Instamart orders have been down for the last 2 weeks. Identify the root cause and recommend solutions.

- **R2 (Product Improvement):** Let's say we want to add a leaderboard feature to Subway Surfers and are looking at maximising monetisation. How would we go about it?

Google

- **Role:** PM
- **Offer:** No
- **General Feedback:** In-depth reasoning for whatever you speak out.
 - **R1 (Product Design, Product Strategy):**
 - Take one technical product and go through everything: mission statement, value proposition, user segments, their issues, stakeholders, and why you choose this product.
 - How would you improve it? Long-term strategic moat as well.
 - Every question went in depth to get the answer.
 - **R2 (Metrics, GTM, MVP):**
 - You are a PM for an airport freemium Wi-Fi service. What metrics would you track?
 - GTM.
 - MVP.
 - **R3 (Technology Trends, Product Improvement):**
 - What are the top technological trends you are observing?
 - Based on those trends, improve the current smart TV experience.
 - **R4 (Product Design, Product Strategy):**
 - Create a meal planning & management app.
 - For the product you get, you have to come up with a mission statement for the solution or product you build.
 - Answer all risks, metrics, and prioritization.
- **Role:** PM
 - **Offer:** Yes
 - **R1 (Product Vision & Problem Space Understanding):**
 - Tell me about the product in your resume which says you reduced latency by 25%. What? How? Elaborate?
 - We have to build a similar product - how will you go about it? (Why performance over cost -> take numbers, elaborate, hypothesize -> what client-side metrics -> what business-side metrics -> 1-year vision statement -> build roadmap)
 - **R2 (Product Design):**
 - What is your favourite technical product? Why? How? Elaborate on its features. What's the competitive landscape, and why is it better than competitors?

- Ease (Design) - what new features can we add to Google Maps? (What current features vs. other companies -> define markets for Google Maps, choose one -> user segments -> problems faced by users -> goal of each user -> pain points of each user -> new features we can add -> metrics you will measure)
- **R3 (Googliness / Behavioural):**
 - Introduce yourself.
 - Resume-based questions.
 - Situation-based: How will you handle a conflict situation with your colleague? What will you do in a situation where this colleague has received poor customer reviews, and there are certain complaints? What if he says this is none of your business? When will you escalate, and to whom?
 - Incident-based: Share two incidents where you received life-changing feedback and how you implemented it (education/work/school/etc.)
- **R4 (Strategic Insights):**
 - You are the CEO of an airport and have all the required authority - devise a long-term strategic plan to enhance the user experience at an airport. (Which airport? Users? Major current problems? Which one will you prioritize? Pros and cons of each problem after giving due diligence to each. Offered solutions - why for each? What solution to prioritize? What metrics - why for each? Which one will you give more priority to - engagement or adoption?)
 - Behavioural: Ever presented anything to senior management? What, how, when, solution, action?
- **General Feedback:** Keep the frameworks in your mind but not to stick to them adamantly and focus more on the thought process as to why and what for everything we answer

Grab

- **Role:** Sr. Data Scientist
 - **Received Offer:** No
 - **R1 (Product Design):** Stats and Experimentation. In-depth on how to run A/B. Build a feature to help drivers identify the ride.
 - **R2 (Product Strategy):** Biz metrics for Dineout (since I was in Swiggy) L1 and L2. There were a lot more questions on that. There was one RCA
 - **R3 (Resume, Behavioural/Personal):** I was the sole candidate left in R3. It was taken by a CXO. It was a stress test. Much like a B-school interview. Situational-based questions. Asked me about my weaknesses and what I am doing to improve them

- **R4 (Behavioural/Personal, Technical, Metrics):** The hiring manager round. Asked me questions on all touch points. Business sense, technical strengths, how I use AI in day-to-day, leadership skills, evidence of proactiveness

Hexagon

- **Role:** Product Manager- Industry Operations and Maintenance
 - **Case Submission Round:** No
 - **R1 (Resume, Product Design, Technical):** A brief introduction? Have you heard about Hexagon and specially Asset Lifecycle division? What is the main issue in developing any technical product? My experience in handling data of my organisation? AI use cases in day-to-day activities? A use case where you solved the issue, but if AI was implemented, it would have been much better? Preventive vs Predictive Maintenance? Are you aware of prescriptive maintenance?
 - **R2 (Resume, Behavioural/Personal, AI):**
 - Brief introduction; asked to repeat all use cases from round 1, and kept asking detailed questions on implementation plans, AI use, my role, and in-depth knowledge of the same.
 - Asked about location preference, working environment; asked to solve a business case where customer pain points are known, but the solution doesn't exist within the company - what would be your approach to making sure senior management is aligned.
 - Asked if I had ever faced a situation where senior management was not aligned with my solution, and what I did to make sure they were aligned with my approach or solution.
 - **R3 (HR round):** More of a conversational round, culture, role, fitment check

HiLabs

- **Role:** PM 1
 - **Received Offer:** Yes
 - **Case Submission Round:** Yes
 - **R1 (Pre assessment case):**
 - Share screen and explain everything in the deck.
 - I moved step by step. Paid more attention to the problem statement and to the question itself - why now, advantages of doing it, and disadvantages of not doing it. Kept asking if I was going in the right direction, or if he wanted me to go in depth on any topic. Kept talking about the assumptions.
 - User persona: explained all the primary and secondary users, and then explained how their journey would look. Counter question: Why did you prioritise user A and not B?
 - Answer: Higher TAM is B, but A has more unmet needs, and solving for A will start a flywheel and overall improve time and cost savings for everyone downstream, and for the business.
 - I also explained the Lovable prototype and the wireframe. It's better to open the link and explain there as well. I had some extra wireframes made

which I hadn't added earlier in the deck; I explained those as well to show synergy. I kept talking about the risks and mitigations for whatever I said. I had asked ChatGPT to create more questions based on my deck. They like stats and data science, so I gave a confidence score (>98%) and spoke about clustering for outliers with values greater than 3 SD. Spoke about NLP and the models, and about my research paper (transformers), and linked it to the case. It went on for 1 hour. At the end, he praised it, and the round was concluded.

- **R2 (Product Design, Technical):**

- Very technical round.
- Understanding of SDLC, high-level design, ML (logistic regression, random forest, linear regression, learning rate, working of neural networks).
- Designing of tables and entities; normalisations; joins. He said: I want the user to open the app and search for the department and book a doctor, based on distance and availability.
- My solution: The hospital example is Max Hospital. It has many branches. Each branch is a separate hospital. Each hospital has many departments. Each department has many doctors, and they have their own timings.
- Design what the metadata will look like for each database. What all information will you store.
- I was then asked to design entities for this, and how I would store data. Then, how would I store all the PDFs and handwritten documents. I explained S3 and the working of a pre-signed URL by drawing the system architecture, and included CDN, caching, Kafka, and Elasticsearch.
- Write SQL code to fetch the top 10 (ranked) based on claims filed. Two-level nesting is a must.
- Stats: what is the significance of the p-value and F-score, null hypothesis, etc.

- **R3 (Behavioural/Personal):**

- Didn't ask a lot of questions - more conversational.
- I used the opportunity to explain my journey and how everything makes me the best candidate for HiLabs.
- Why PM? Why now? ISB learnings?
- What is PM in one word? (He was looking for the word: prioritization.)
- I felt it was more of a personality test.
- Show genuine interest - I had researched the company well.
- Location preference was also discussed in this round.

- **General Feedback:**

- My interview started at 11, and all rounds were 1 hour each. I was done by 2. I was not allowed to leave the Zoom call at all - no breaks. Mentioning it because this matters.
- They negotiate as well - make good use of it.

Incedo

- **Role:** PM
 - **Received Offer:** Yes
 - **Case Submission Round:** Yes
 - **R1:** Resume-based completely
 - **R2 (Product Design, Product Strategy):** Design a stage-based insurance portal for different user personas using agentic AI
 - **R3 (Product Strategy):** How can we improve WAU for IRCTC?
 - **Other info:** The case study was given in person. We were supposed to do product design on a sheet of paper and submit it before the interviews began.

Inmobi

- **Role:** PM
 - **Received Offer:** Yes
 - **Case Submission Round:** Yes
 - **R1 (Resume, Behavioural/Personal):**
 - They asked me to explain the projects that I have done.
 - Later, I was asked how I would work with the engineering team, any issues I had faced while working with engineering before, and how I would scale an MVP and fix issues that might come up with it.
 - **R2 (Product Design):** Design FB Travel. Pretty standard design interview, which went on for about 35 minutes.
 - **R3 (Misc):**
 - This was a very different kind of interview, in that it didn't fit any format of the ones we typically prepare for. It started with why InMobi, then moved to my motivations for joining adtech.
 - This was an extremely conversational interview, and the interviewer repeatedly told me that he was not interested in the answer or the structure, but wanted to know my thought process. Overall, a very chill interview.
 - **R4 (HR):**
 - Why InMobi?
 - Why should InMobi hire you?
- **Role:** Product Manager
 - **Received Offer:** Yes
 - **Case Submission Round:** Yes
 - **R1 (Everything):**
 - It started with the resume (informally) and then dived deeper into my work experience. They weren't behavioural questions. The interview then moved to the case discussion and dissected it inside out. It started off with

a product design-esque discussion, but no circles. We touched on ideation, feasibility (tech and business), tradeoffs, GTM, metrics, improvements, privacy constraints, and more. Went on for 1.5 hours to cover everything there was. Need to know adtech and your case very well.

- It was taken by the Director of PM.
- **R2 (Reverse Interview):**
 - I was supposed to drive the interview, where the interviewer was going to judge how I drive the conversation, and what level of depth we could go into. For this, I went into ad-tech domain-level things - for example, gaming vs. e-commerce, and why InMobi is focusing more on the latter.
 - Reading about the shady stuff shared by employees (Blind/Reddit) helped, because this helped identify what wasn't working, and I drove it to the point that InMobi's DSP isn't doing too well.
- **R3 (Technical):** The interview was a behavioural/technical round of sorts. It was more about working with tech and engineering as a PM, rather than how you would build something. Tip: Read about leadership topics.

Mastercard

- **Role:** PM
 - **Case Submission Round:** Yes
 - **R1 (Resume, Technical):**
 - Resume deep dive, and what are data products, and how would you improve an existing data product?
 - Explain 2-3 features from the deck and how they connect with Mastercard's vision of a data-based product.
- **Role:** Product Manager Specialist, Pune
 - **Received Offer:** Yes
 - **Case Submission Round:** Yes
 - **R1 (Resume, Behavioural/Personal, Fav Product):** This was a stress-test interview, with detailed questions asked on my resume and detailed grilling on each and every point of the resume. After that, I was asked a question about my favourite data product (since it was a data team); when I answered, he said okay, give me your second favourite data product (when I answered this, he said okay, third favourite data product) - we finally agreed on the product Datadog, after which it was a typical favourite-product question format. After this, I was asked some questions about my case submission. After that, I was asked to tell him about a product that is not present in my case submission, what the product would look like, and who its users would be. After which I was asked questions on estimating this product's TAM, as well as risks involved. The interview ended later on a friendly note.
 - **R2 (Resume, Behavioural/Personal, Product Design):** In this round, I was again asked questions on my resume (since I came from a team at JPMorgan that did similar work to the team I was interviewing for). He then took a point from my

resume, essentially one of the products I had worked on during my time at JPMorgan (he then asked detailed questions about it - who were the personas, their pain points, what were the solutions (what other solution could you come up with), metrics as well). He then made a lot of if/else scenarios and asked me what the metrics would be in each case. Basically, it was more or less a product design question morphed into a product improvement one. After this, he asked me about challenges dealing with data, and considering these challenges, how should Mastercard build a product around this, and what would that product look like. After this, he asked me questions about why Mastercard, why ISB, why product. This interview also ended on a very positive note.

- **R3 (HR):** This was an HR round, where we discussed questions around my ISB journey, and why Mastercard. This round seemed like a formality; I got a soft offer in this round from HR.
- **General Feedback:** Put a lot of effort into the deck - after the deck round for my role, only 6 people were left for the interview. Also, before the interview, read up on your deck submission in detail and be ready to answer a lot of detailed questions on it. The team I was interviewing for was a data team, so it is generally recommended to read about data products as well. Be very well versed with your resume, and be prepared to answer a lot of cross-questions on it. Other than that, the typical product prep should suffice.

- **Role:** Product specialist

- **Received Offer:** Yes
- **Case Submission Round:** Yes
- **R1 (Resume, Ppt submission made):** Most of the questions were on the case submission - assumptions made in the case, why a certain strategy was chosen over the alternatives, and understanding of their product offerings.
- **R2 (Product Strategy, Technical):**
- **R3 (Behavioural/Personal):**
- **R4 (Resume, Behavioural/Personal):**

Media Net

- **Role:** Product Manager

- **Received Offer:** No
- **Case Submission Round:** Yes
- **R1 (RCA, Metrics, Deck):**
 - They asked us to submit a deck; basic questions on the deck.
 - Later asked: if I were at BLR airport, there are 500 customers and 100 drivers - how would I choose to assign which driver to which customer?
 - Then they asked me an RCA on Amazon orders decreasing.
 - Couldn't complete the RCA, as the interviewer asked me to stop. He was grilling a lot on whatever I was saying.

- **Role:** Product Manager
 - **Received Offer:** No
 - **Case Submission Round:** Yes
 - **R1 (Behavioural/Personal, Product Design, Guesstimate):**
 - Round 1 - 10-15 minutes - Questions about work-ex, why Media.net, why do you want to join ad-tech, questions on understanding of ad-tech, what is the biggest threat to ads now with AI in the scene.
 - Then a question on guesstimate - estimate Airbnb's annual revenue.
 - Another product sense question - design a dashboard for Swiggy's CEO.
 - Interviewer was mainly trying to check product design and understanding of ad-tech.
- **Role:** Product Manager
 - **Received Offer:** No
 - **Case Submission Round:** Yes
 - **R1 (Fav Product, Metrics, Case Submission):**
 - 1. My case submission was about a content creation support tool for SMBs. Question: What are the limitations and risks of using AI for content creation?
 - 2. What is your favourite product, and how will you improve it?
 - 3. What is the NSM of the WhatsApp Voice Call feature?
 - 4. You are a PM at Uber, and you have 500 customers at Hyderabad airport and only 100 cabs - what parameters will you consider to map the drivers to customers?
 - **General Feedback:** In Media.net interviews, try to move beyond generic answers. Try to showcase originality of thought. Also, be well-prepared with PM cases so you don't take too much time to think during the interview. Most of all, come across as a confident person.

Myntra

- **Role:** Product Manager 2
 - **Received Offer:** Yes
 - **R1 (Product Design):** You are a PM at Instagram - how will you improve it?
 - **R2 (Resume, Behavioural/Personal, Product Design, Product Improvement, Product Strategy):**
 - 1) Since you are an avid user of Myntra, what do you like about it, and what improvements can you suggest?
 - 2) You are a PM at Myntra, and you have to scale the M-Now service across India. How will you go about it? How will you measure success? What success metrics matter here?

- **R3 (Resume, Behavioural/Personal, Product Design):** You are a PM at Myntra, and you have to design/improve the seller-side portal for Myntra. (Strong focus on AI features.)
- **R4 (HR Round):** Typical HR round. I don't think this round was eliminative.
- **Role:** Product Manager 2
 - **Received Offer:** Yes
 - **Case Submission Round:** Yes
 - **R1 (Fav product):** Fav product - I said G Maps. I was asked to build a feature for a specific cohort for a specific use case
 - **R2 (Product Strategy):** Pick a product. How will you monetise it? Went in very depth.
 - **R3 (Resume, Product Design):** VP took this round. A lot from the resume. Grilled on trade offs on various cases. To name a few, what would you choose? A few large darkstores or many small darkstores.
 - **R4 (HR Round):** HR Round. Questions on values and expectations. It was chill afair
- **Role:** PM
 - **R1 (RCA):**
 - Myntra sales fell. RCA: Myntra doesn't have inventory that is in trend right now.
 - CV.
 - **R2 (Metrics, MyntraNow):**
 - You are launching in 2 cities.
 - City 1: 4 dark stores, each 2,000 sq ft; estimated delivery time is 60–80 minutes.
 - City 2: 16 dark stores, each 500 sq ft; estimated delivery time is 10–15 minutes.
 - Which model would you go ahead with?
 - How would you increase app rating in the Google Play Store? Mostly about UX and usability.
 - Why Myntra?
 - **R3 (Product Growth):**
 - How would you grow LinkedIn?

Navi

- **Role:** APM
 - **Received Offer:** No
 - **Case Submission Round:** No

- **R1 (GTM):** Navi has decided to launch an ads platform, and they want to find and target the most appropriate segment of brands for the same. Suggest a GTM strategy and a scale-up plan for the next 2 years.
- **Role: APM II**
 - **Received Offer:** No
 - **Case Submission Round:** No
 - **R1 (Product Strategy):** Given you have healthcare experience, design the GTM of a healthcare company.
 - **R2 (Product Design, Guesstimate):** You have a hobby of 3D printing; design a 3D printing marketplace, and find the TAM as well.
- **Role: APM2**
 - **Received Offer:** Yes
 - **Case Submission Round:** No
 - **R1 (Resume, Behavioural/Personal, RCA):** Resume-based questions. RCA case on cart additions on Zepto having declined. Follow-up questions - what is your hypothesis on why this happened? What is the revenue loss from this issue?
 - **R2 (Resume, Behavioural/Personal, Product Design):** Case on improving Google Maps. Behavioural question - what is your expectation from the role and company?
 - **R3 (Behavioural/Personal):** Stress-based interview. Asked me questions about my journey. Some situation-based questions. Asked what my criteria would be while deciding which company to join.
- **Role: PM**
 - **Received Offer:** Yes
 - **Case Submission Round:** No
 - **R1 (Resume, Fav Product, RCA):** Explanation of two projects - focus on AI and personalization.
 - **R2 (Resume, Behavioural/Personal, Product Design)**
 - **R3 (Resume, Behavioural/Personal)**

Nagarro

- **Role: PM**
 - **R1 (Product Strategy, AI):**
 - FMCG (background based).
 - Enterprise-level AI to be implemented: how will you go ahead with this?
 - Ask clarification questions, etc.
 - Their goal was top-line efficiency and bottom-line optimization.

- In different verticals, prioritize. Sales & marketing: how will you give AI solutions?

Okta

- **Role:** PM
 - **Received Offer:** No
 - **Case Submission Round:** No
 - **R1 (Product Improvement):** Given OIN usage is not very high; discovery for IT admins is broken - as a PM, how will you fix it?
 - **R2 (Engineering Manager):** Engineering round - what is SDLC; waterfall vs. agile; Big Billion Days sale - a new API vulnerability is found, what will you do?
 - **R3 (Design Manager):** Design round - choose one of Okta's major products; product adoption is low and has high user-adoption friction - what would you design to fix it?
 - **R4 (Behavioural/Personal):** VP Product round - given 9 features with different effort levels and a separate company strategy, prioritise bandwidth for 5 engineers for the next 3 months.

Paytm

- **Role:** PM
 - **Case Submission Round:** Yes
 - **R1 (Resume, Case study):** Questions based on the case study, strengths, and one quality you would hate seeing in your teammates.
 - **R2 (RCA):** Postpaid payments conversion rate has gone down - what might be the possible reasons?

Razorpay

- **Role:** PM
 - **Case Submission Round:** Yes
 - **R1 (Product Design):**
 - Asked based on my ex-hotel experience from my resume.
 - Design a loyalty program for a hotel chain to improve retention.
- **Role:** PM
 - **Case Submission Round:** Yes
 - **R1 (Product Design):** We want to improve IMDb as a product. How would we go about it? The objective is to maximise monetisation.
 - **R2 (Behavioural/Personal):** Intro, plus why product after such deeply technical SDE roles, plus a verbal psychometric question linking to the agilities framework (mental/people/change/results) - wanted to understand how I ranked these with respect to being able to achieve my goal (in this case, Director of PM @Swiggy in 5 years) and why. Very brief interview, <15 minutes.

- **Role:** PM 2
 - **Received Offer:** Yes
 - **Case Submission Round:** Yes
 - **R1 (Resume, Behavioural/Personal, Product Strategy):** 1.5-hour discussion, with 20 minutes on the case. Majority of it was Behavioural/leadership questions. I was from a non-tech background, so questions around why PM and not consulting. Case was on: Instagram wants to monetize by building a native commerce flow in the app - whether Instagram should do it or not, and what the product flow and journey would be. Questions were asked on how and who would price, who would manage the catalogues, and how logistics would be managed. What would be the tradeoffs and risks?
 - **R2:** 10-minute HR round on expectations and CTC.
- **Role:** PM II
 - **Received Offer:** No
 - **Case Submission Round:** Yes
 - **R1 (Product Design, Product Improvement, Product Strategy):** You are an e-commerce PM - how will you improve the search experience in the app?

Sirion

- **Role:** Product Manager
 - **Case Submission Round:** Yes
 - **R1 (Resume, Behavioural/Personal):**
 - 1. Walk me through the work you have done, in one line for each role.
 - 2. Why move from e-commerce to fintech?
 - 3. What is your most important skill? Talk about why you think you possess this skill.
 - 4. Detailed deep-dive into a project where you showcased that skill-set:
 - 4a. Business case for the project (strategic importance for the org?)
 - 4b. What component were you responsible for?
 - 4c. How did you make it work?
 - 5. Questions for the interviewer?

Target

- **Role:** Product Manager
 - **Received Offer:** Yes
 - **Case Submission Round:** No
 - **R1 (Resume, Behavioural/Personal, Product Strategy):**
 - Based on your learnings at ISB, what would you improve about the existing product that you worked on? How will you improve your contributions?

- What are some of the biggest challenges you have faced during the product work?
- What about Target attracts you?
- **R2 (Behavioural/Personal, Product scoping):**
 - When you faced workplace conflict, how did you resolve it?
 - What was the most impactful project you worked on? Can you frame it like a PM problem statement? What would be the OKRs? Who are the personas and stakeholders involved?

Teradata

- **Role:** Product Manager
 - **Received Offer:** Yes
 - **Case Submission Round:** No
 - **R1 (Resume, Behavioural/Personal):**
 - First few questions were based on the resume - what, why, how, results.
 - The panel (2 members) later moved on to situational PM questions. For example: there was a requirement from a client for a new feature in one of Teradata's products, but the engineering team is caught up in other important deliverables - how would you handle the situation?
 - There were many such questions back to back. Interviewers were very punctual. It was a 1-hour interview.
 - **R2 (Behavioural/Personal, Product Strategy, Technical):**
 - This round was a mix of technical and situational.
 - Interviewer asked about cloud, data engineering concepts, and how I would explain the concepts to a layman in a very simple way. Then there were a lot of situational/product-strategy questions. For example: how would I introduce a new Teradata product to market? How do I identify the opportunities? How will I prioritize between 2 important clients? This was also a 1-hour interview.
 - **R3 (Resume, Behavioural/Personal, Product Strategy):**
 - This interview was with the Director of Product Management.
 - It revolved around projects from the resume. Then a lot of high-level situational questions (product strategy, product vision).
 - **General Feedback:** All the interviewers were based out of the US, so expect all interviews at around 8-11pm. These interviews took place a week before Day 1.1 and 1.2.

Uber

- **Role:** PM
 - **Received Offer:** No
 - **Case Submission Round:** Yes

- **R1 (Resume):** Pick a project where you identified the problem and solved it using some product improvement.
- **R2 (Fav Product):** What is your 3rd-favourite product?
- **Role: PM - 2**
 - **Received Offer:** Yes
 - **Case Submission Round:** Yes
 - **R1 (Resume, Behavioural/Personal, Product Strategy):** Intro and some questions on the resume. Asked me for my favourite app; I had mentioned MMT, so he asked me why I like MMT. One point I mentioned was clean UX, so he made me compare the UX of Cleartrip and MMT. Next, a case on: if you were CEO of MMT, what would be your strategy for next year?
 - **R2 (Resume, Behavioural/Personal, RCA):**
 - Resume - Which is your favourite project so far, and why?
 - RCA - We have just launched Uber in Brazil and are facing major fare review tickets. What is the reason for this, and how would you fix it?
 - **R3 (Technical):** System design for Facebook notifications.
 - **R4 (Product Strategy):**
 - The round should have been behavioural, but they gave product strategy and vision. Uber wants to launch intercity cabs - should they do it, and if yes, then how? Uber wants to launch bus rides with a third party such as Redbus - how should the payments be managed? Should the payment experience be with Uber or with Redbus? What are the pros and cons of your method?
 - Some things to keep in mind:
 - 1. Be structured, and practice product strategy.
 - 2. In RCA, only ask valid questions, and not based on a framework.
 - 3. Stick to first-principles thinking.
 - I was not from a tech background and could not do proper system design, but from first-principles thinking, I explained which DBs should exist and how the DBs should be designed, and they were ok with it.
- **Role: PM 2**
 - **Received Offer:** Yes
 - **Case Submission Round:** Yes
 - **R1 (Product Design, Product Improvement, Fav Product):** What's your favourite product, and how would you improve it? Now suppose you are the PM of X - would you incorporate this feature into the existing product? Why? Why now? Features and metrics to measure success.
 - **R2 (Resume, Product Design, Product Improvement, Product Strategy):** What are your passions/interests? Based on that, should we create product X? How would the whole thing work, and how will you market it?

- **R3 (Resume, Technical):** System design, with some edge cases too.
 - **R4 (Resume, Behavioural/Personal, Product Design, Product Strategy):** Lots of grilling about previous work experience. Questions on how I would handle a particular situation. And another product strategy/design question specific to Uber.
 - **General Feedback:** Be extremely thorough - don't blindly rely on AI, your brain will come up with some great ideas. Always think of answering all product questions from a Why, Who, What, How approach. And always make sure to give reasons for what you're saying.
- **Role:** Product Manager
 - **Received Offer:** No
 - **Case Submission Round:** Yes
 - **R1 (Resume, Product Improvement, Product Strategy, Fav Product):**
 - Pick a favourite product -
 - How would you improve it, grow its market share, and shape its pricing strategy?
 - **R2 (Resume, Behavioural/Personal, Product Design):**
 - If you were designing a labelling system for Uber Eats, how would you approach it?
 - Which attributes or fields would you capture, and how would you structure the labelling logic?
 - For example, if McDonald's offers a Vegan Burger, labels might include 'Vegan' and 'Burger'.
 - Walk me through the taxonomy, rules, and design considerations.
 - **R3 (Behavioural/Personal, Technical, Wanted to test collaboration with Engineering Management team):** How does auto-suggestion work for Gmail/Outlook?
 - **R4 (Behavioural/Personal):**
- **Role:** Product Manager
 - **Received Offer:** Yes
 - **Case Submission Round:** Yes
 - **R1 (Behavioural/Personal, Product Design, Fav Product):** First asked me about my favourite product - what I liked about it in the user journey, and what could be improved. Then, asked me to design a product improvement for the weak link. We discussed user segments, solutions, metrics and risks for the same.
 - **R2 (Behavioural/Personal, Product Strategy, Metrics):** A very detailed problem statement around Swiggy customer complaints and customer disputes. A new feature is introduced that asks users to upload evidence (a picture) of their dispute. That image is then sent to the merchants as proof when they are charged back for the issued refund. I was then asked to design metrics for this

specific feature and design a launch strategy. Behavioural question: "Explain an instance when you had to give up on perfection to achieve something better."

- **R3 (Behavioural/Personal, Technical):** Some discussion on the product I used to work on at my previous org. Then, asked a bunch of questions on file chunking, APIs, and how they are stored in the database - pros and cons of storing certain values in certain tables, etc. Extremely detailed conversation around databases, and some discussion on vector databases and embeddings.
- **R4 (Behavioural/Personal, Fav Product):** Favourite product - 2 things I like, 2 things that can be improved. Behavioural questions on previous role - things I learnt, plus a product where I created max impact and how I realised it. Biggest learning from the experience, and questions around that.

2025 Interview Experiences

Providence

- **Role:** Cyber security program manager
 - **R1 (Product Metrics; Product Strategy; Product Design; Behavioural / Resume;):** 40 mins
 - How would you do the GTM of security services?
 - How did you price your product?
 - What did learn in finance?
 - What was the metrics for the product you worked on?
 - How did you know it's the right metric?
 - Talk about healthcare
 - Design cybersecurity plan
 - Design business continuity plan
 - **R2 (Behavioural / Resume;Company Related;):** 45 mins
 - Random questions
 - Healthcare and cyber attacks
 - Attack intentions
 - What is strategy
 - What is marketing
 - Asked 3-4 numbers written in resume
 - Then behavioral questions around strength, weakness , what excites you, tell me about a situation (4-5) questions
 - **R3 (Behavioural / Resume;):** This was an HR round.
 - **General Feedback:** Be thorough with product concepts, product cases, cybersecurity concepts, healthcare and read recent news related to cyber attacks on healthcare

Okta

- **Role:** Product Manager

- **Pre-Interview Case Submission:** An optional case competition for ISB earlier in the year was submitted, but the candidate did not make it to the finals.
 - **R1 (Product Design;Company Related;Behavioural / Resume;):** This is for PM round - It was very conversational. Started with an intro and tell me about your work or any project. Went into some details around it. Then gave me a problem around 'Increase Conversion Rate of Free to paid Users for Workflow connectors for Okta'. It was like a design question but what mattered more was getting to the actual reasons behind why the conversion was low. Had to make the full funnel from awareness to conversion and realised issue was in 'Free trial Usage' itself. Interviewer was very helpful throughout and articulating your thought process mattered most
 - **R2 (Product Design;Product Strategy;):** This is for Engg round - It was mostly behavioural for me in the sense that I was a software engineer before so the interviewer gave me situations around prioritisation, stakeholder management and wanted to understand how I'd handle scenarios if I was a PM. Good to research and know about APIs and API Contracts for this company
 - **Round 3:** This is for UX round - Gave me a RCA based situation where we had to come up with solutions and prioritise in 15min. Interviewer wanted me to write on screen-share and show my thought process. I was only able to clarify the problem and give possible rootcauses and time ended. Wasn't able to get to design/solutions but I don;t think it mattered. Thought process and approach mattered. Also was asked situational questions around how would you work with engg and designers around this problems
 - **Round 4-** This was technically R2 - It was a 'Prioritisation' Question with Senior Director of Product. Gave me a situation regarding a hypothetical company and it's possible 4 features. Was asked to stack rank them. Approach mattered a lot and interviewer was very helpful and conversational. Asking the right questions matter. Understand the why of everything, state your assumptions and ask about company strategy. We had one more round after this - Meet with CPO which was non-eliminative for us.
 - **General Feedback:** The interviewers were very clear that they will not ask impractical design questions like 'alarm clock for blind', the whole process was very tailored to your profile and real life scenarios. Asking the right questions mattered and showing your thought process was an important thing. Prepare good questions to ask interviewers in each round and know about the industry Okta is in and it's products.
- **Role:** Product Manager
 - **R1 (Product Strategy;):**With an engineering manager: What did you find difficult about being a PM? What did working with Engineers as a PM look like for you? How would you define a feature as done - basically was looking for

Agile "definition of done." I would recommend reviewing Agile principles for this one, my answer was a bit rough. What would you do if Microsoft suddenly told you there was a change and you had to migrate an API to a new version. How would you prioritize the changes? What would you do if your customers had to make a change on their end? There are standard best-practice answers to some parts of these questions (like customer migration). I think a good strategy would have been to take some time to review software development best practices in general.

- **R2 (Behavioural / Resume;):** With a PM: First question: Tell me about a product you worked on, and the value it added. Next, sort of product design case. She showed me her product on her laptop and said there was low adoption in terms of users upgrading their subscription. I asked a lot of questions about specific numbers as if it was an RCA. After that, she guided me to a user journey/adoption funnel structure to find more problems. I was able suggest some features that she said she actually had on her roadmap. Understanding Okta's wider product offerings and the customer needs was extremely helpful here in getting to user problems and solutions. It was also just really fun because I was getting real-world answers to questions from the PM instead of hypothetical because it was her product.
- **R3 (Product Design;):** With a designer: Given a problem statement - admins are being overwhelmed with suspicious login notifications, how will you fix this? I asked a lot of clarifying questions and then gave honestly very basic solutions. Followup questions were how to verify the solution and how to prioritize solutions.
- **R4 (Behavioural / Resume;Product Metrics;):**After last 3 rounds, half the group was eliminated and other half had a round with product director. Deep-dive into my experience. Asking even about specific resume lines and why I made certain choices. What was a feature you shipped, what was the process for that, why did you choose it, what metric did it move, what tradeoffs did you have to make, what would you do differently. What stakeholders did you work with? Why Okta? Why PM? How do you define a PM? Would you want to work frontend or backend? And a lot more, basically really questioned every answer I gave in a lot of depth and from a product perspective. We also discussed what the role looks like in general.
- **General Feedback:** For the first three rounds, research into the company/IAM space will get you ahead by a lot since the cases are based on their products. For the last round, just know your resume and any other stories you might want to tell centered around feature discovery and execution.

- **Role:** Product Manager

- **Pre-Interview Case Submission:** The company had an optional case competition where the candidate submitted a solution but did not make it to the finals.
 - **R1 (Behavioural / Resume;):** This was with a Senior PM. He started with some basic introduction. Next question was - Microsoft has mandated MFA, what will you do. At first, I did not really understand question well, so scoped it further - Microsoft has mandated all Office 365 products to have MFA (this MFA may or may not be from Microsoft Authenticator or any other Authenticator), so how can Okta use this as an opportunity to provide MFA to it's customers
 - **R2 (Product Design;Behavioural / Resume;RCA;):** The second round was with an Engineering Lead. He wanted to understand how I work with the Engineering team. Questions from my past work ex. Then in-depth questions on prioritisation, t-shirt sizing, stack ranking etc as part of the implementation process
 - **R3 (Behavioural / Resume;Product Design;):** This round was with a Senior Designer. How will you help IT Admins overcome notifications pile-up. She had a fig jam board open and wanted me to identify pain points and the prioritise and come up with solutions and prioritise again. She asked me how I would go about with the implementation
 - **R4 (Behavioural / Resume;):** This was with a Director of Engineering.
 - He dissected my resume and asked very pointed questions asking me to explain in-depth.He dug into one particular project, asked me about the metrics we had set, if we met the metrics, whether it was successful, why/why not. Questions on B2B enterprise products, what were my learnings, what would I do differently
 - **General Feedback:** Be thorough with your resume. First Principle thinking - no frameworks or anything. Understand how as a PM you would need to work with engineering, design and other teams - this is extremely important
- **Role:** Product Manager
 - **Pre-Interview Case Submission:** The candidate was shortlisted based on a case about expanding the company's ISV network.
 - **R1 (Engineering;):** The round was about 30 mins long. It tested your engineering expertise. Questions were around your knowledge of how APIs work, acumen to prioritize and personal experience dealing conflicts with the engineering team. A case was also asked. Case: let's say Microsoft who is in the Okta Integration Network wants change a bunch of their codebase, frameworks & APIs and destroy their previous set up. How would you deal with it? The answer should consider all the engineering & business

dependencies of the problem statement & arrive at an "yes migrate" or "no don't migrate" answer.

- **R2 (Product Design;RCA;):** This round was also about 30 mins long. The question was how will you improve free to paid conversion in Okta's custom no node workflow connector builder tool. The questions starts of with RCA. You should find why the free to paid conversion is below the industry standards and after finding the root cause, give suggestions to improve it. The root cause in my case was lack of knowledge on how to build workflows for enterprise customers & undesirability of pre-built workflow templates.
- **R3 (Product Design;):** The round was about 30 mins long. The question was how will you make our customers realize the value of single sign on better? Follow the typical design question flow - start with vision, pick user personas, find their pain points, offer solutions. You will be using Figjam in this interview to paint your thought process.
- **R4 (Product Strategy;):** This round was about 45 minutes long. The senior director of product management gave a strategy question for an insurance tech company. He gave 4 features (Application level monitoring to improve latency, cloud migration, an UI feature & WebApp UX feature) & asked me to stackrank it keeping in mind business goals. I had to consider all factors - Impact on various user personas, impact on business goals & engineering effort required - to stackrank it. The better your scoping questions are, the better your answer will be.
- **General Feedback:** Okta has one of the most technical interview process that ISB has to offer (no system design questions tho). You will have to have thorough knowledge about their offering, most questions will be based on Identity & access management industry. You will rarely find a "design a ceiling fan" question here.

- **Role:** Product Manager

- **Pre-Interview Case Submission:** The candidate was selected through a PPI of an Okta Case competition.
- **R1 (Engineering;):** '- Previous exposure to Software Dev and tech concepts
 - - How APIs work
 - - What are types of API
 - - How do you handle engineering team as PM
- **R2 (Product Design;):** Specific Design case with respect to Okta
 - - How will you reduce drop-offs while using Okta workflows
- Followed general product design framework. Was asked few follow-up and scenario questions on the case.
 - - What is your favorite product
- Follow framework

- **R3 (Product Strategy;):** Specific strategy case on Okta Integration network
- - How will you enable a HRMS company to use Okta Integration Network more. I kind of skipped the framework as I knew the answer which worked against me. Always follow framework and preferably state your approach before you start answering.
- **General Feedback:** Showcasing framework and structured thinking is best. Should show comfort while encountering tech questions. Just stick to fundamentals

Microsoft

- **Role:** Product Manager
 - **Pre-Interview Case Submission:** The candidate was given a live case on how to improve the market share of the Microsoft Authenticator application. The candidate focused on problems and success, and connected metrics to the feature.
 - **R1 (Product Design;Company Related;):** Case round.
 - We were given a problem statement in a group call and then 45 minutes to work on the case and submit. The case was fairly open-ended: how to improve the market share of the Microsoft Authenticator application.
 - They gave us a structure (Assumptions/Problems/Success/Risks/Challenges) but I mostly focused on Problems and Success sections. I listed out a number of potential pain points and needs, and then focused in on the first one where I could see a potential feature the app didn't have yet. (Secret sharing) I went into the sub-features of that feature and addressed most of the risks as part of those. I also connected metrics to that feature and tried to stay tightly aligned to the goal of market share in terms of enterprise adoption.
 - After submission, panelists went from student to student asking about their solution. There's potentially a good bit of waiting time for you there where you can prep a verbal answer (I didn't really, I was tired.) They basically asked me to go over my solution and what it would look like and how it would drive value. Then they asked me what value the Authenticator app has in general.
 - I was able to give pretty good answers because I had done a lot of research on these topics for other interviews.
 - **R2 (Product Design;RCA;):** Very standard product interview, 45 minutes? Nothing personal. Apparently some of the other applicants had a different experience.
 - First question: Favorite product. (I picked Miro.) What does it solve? If you were a PM there, what would you fix? (For this part, I was guided a few times to keep focusing on a user persona structure.) How would you prioritize the features? How would you measure success?
 - Second question: RCA - You are a PM at Uber and cancellations are up 20%. After usual questions I found that they had increased the commission. After

more questions I got close to the answer suggesting that drivers were switching apps, and the interviewer did prompt me a bit to think of other things that could be happening and it was negotiating with riders directly.

- **R3 (Behavioural / Resume;Product Design;Company Related;):** Started with tell me about yourself and why Microsoft.
- After why Microsoft, because I basically said I wanted a to be at like a cutting-edge tech company, she asked me what was interesting tech I learned about recently. I said something about different design patterns for collaborative work (I was thinking of CRDTs and alternatives to them but gun to my head I wouldn't have remembered the actual algorithms. That wasn't a problem). Based on that, she asked me to design/MVP a collaborative text-editing app. Prompted me to keep to the usual structure - user personas, their problems, potential solutions, prioritize, measure success.
- Since we had more time after that, she asked me 2 more questions. Why PM and not coding? and What are 3 products you've learned about and liked in the past year/5 years and what would you improve about them? For the second question, she said she asked past year because she didn't want to hear something standard like Whatsapp.
- **R4 (Behavioural / Resume;Product Design;Product Strategy;Company Related;):** Went more in-depth in the tell me about yourself section for this one. Because I studied AI in my last degree, he asked me how I applied AI on products I worked on.
- The rest of the conversation was very related to the work his own team was doing.
- He asked me to design a dashboard for managers at Walmart to monitor the store. Same deal, personas, problems, prioritization. He really pushed me to think of AI features specifically.
- Finally, asked about my philosophy regarding AI and UX (because I had done UX design as a developer.)
- Talked a lot about his team's direction and I was able to connect it to things I had worked on
- **General Feedback:** BTwo things I think I stood out for:
- Being able to talk about diverse technical topics (esp during R1 case and R3).
- Sounding genuinely very excited and passionate about PM/tech and being very candid in my answers.
- Microsoft AI hype is real - do some reading about what's new in that area and think about how it can be applied to different scenarios.
- Being conversational and honest is good, I didn't hesitate to say when I was unsure about something and tried to be fun to talk to in general.

Myntra

- **Role:** Product Manager 2

- **R1 (Product Strategy;RCA;):** Started with intro, why myntra, why PM, then my work. Asked about Myntra fav feature and what user segment might it target and what pain points would it solve. Asked to create that feature from scratch how would I start and where on app would I implement (I had chosen recommendations). Asked about how I would write a Functional spec for Engg for it and went into details about type of data needed to build the feature. Then asked about metrics I'd track for success scenario. Next case was about E-commerce - how do you reduce 'Fake Products' on the platform. Tip - consider whole supply chain - supplier, delivery partner, customer and that each one can be the issue.
- **Role: Product Manager-2**
 - **R1 (Behavioural / Resume;Product Metrics;):** My RCA question was "You are a PM for Myntra and the customer support team has complained that the reviews and ratings (UGC) on the products page are broken?"
 - Started with clarifying the problem: we are only talking about apparels and broken here means that the reviews are (1) Not trustworthy (2) Not enough of them (3) Not easy to use.
 - Made 2 user journeys - one for users who write reviews and one for customers who consume reviews.
 - The interviewer wanted to start with confirming if this is even a problem or not using metrics
 - Extremely metrics heavy interview.
- **Role: Product Manager-2**
 - **R1 (Behavioural / Resume;Product Metrics;):** A case related to Product Improvement was given where the interviewer asked how to reduce the return rate on Myntra. What he was looking at was the structure and how can the interviewee break the problem statement into reasons for return. I broke it into 3 segments and was asked to focus on the quality/fit of the clothing articles. Gave 2 solutions appreciated by the interviewer.
 - Next I was asked about the metrics to be tracked in this case and why I want to dive into product management.
 - **R2:** Some questions related to the FinTech industry was asked since I belonged to that industry pre-ISB. Questions around Myntra was asked. Improvements to Myntra platform, a case related to Myntra's utility by Tier 2 citizens.
 - **R3:** I was told that Myntra wanted to explore quick fashion e-commerce and was given to design features focusing on the sellers to Improve Myntra's revenue.
 - It was a classic platform design case where I needed to decide how to subsidise sellers.

- Gave 4 features- Inventory Management, Pricing and Reviews analysis, Settlement features & Credit management products.
 - The case was about 20 minutes with the interviewer praising the solutions.
 - The interviewer asked the metrics to be tracked, both L1 and north star.
 - The round ended with some resume based questions and my past experience.
 - **R4:** This was the HR round where the HR asked a lot of behavioural questions- Ambiguous situations, conflicts, strengths, situation based questions. Next, surprisingly I was asked about the changes I want to do on the App's homepage. The interview went for 30 minutes.
 - I recommend to be prepared with 3-4 great stories from past work experiences and adjust them accordingly to the questions asked. If you have stories prepared, you can answer any kind of cross questioning.
 - A couple of questions related to the values of my past firm was asked since the HR was well aware of it.
- **Role:** Product Manager-2
 - **R1 (Behavioural / Resume;Product Metrics;):** (20-25 minutes)
 - Very conversational round, we talked about my work, then about Q-commerce and some metrics that can be used to gauge Q-comm success.
 - Next question was about how Myntra can enter q-comm, this was from a very business and operational perspective.
 - Next question was about 3 improvements that I will bring about in the Myntra app.
 - I was surprised to not get a call back for Round 2. General advice is to be well-versed with Myntra's business and app before the interview.

BCGx

- **Role:** Product Manager
 - **R1 (Guesstimates;):** This was not like a typical PM interview; it was about strategy. The interviewer went straight into the case. The client is a mid-size Indian bank that wants to reduce costs and improve the quality of its customer service; how will you approach this?
 - Any classic PM or consulting frameworks will not fit these cases; they need to bring first-principle thinking. They were looking for a journey approach to solve this problem. Identify why the complaints are arising first and try to solve them at source rather than just building chatbots, etc.
 - They just give you 30 minutes, so you need to think and solve the problem a bit faster.
 - The BCG process was a bit jittery, with some confusion and running around early in the morning. Try to stay calm and be full of energy when you deliver

the case. To practice, make sure you connect enough with your buddy and try to get some frameworks from them.

- **Role:** Product Manager

- **R1 (Guesstimates;):** No. of flights flying over Mumbai at the time - took the supply side approach
- **R2:** Your client is a retail bank - you need to optimise their service costs and ensure smooth customer experience.
- Went through each vertical (Saving accounts, Loans, Credit cards), talking through the customer service related needs and then thought about solutions
- **R3:** Resume related questions
- How would you design a payments product? What factors would you keep in mind?
- Trust/Reliability, Speed, Convenience (3rd party app integrations, auto debit, etc)
- **R4:** Design a personal loans product for a fintech company, while differentiating it from competitors.
- Used CIRCLES to solve.

Darwinbox

- **Role:** PM2

- **R1 (Product Design;):** 1. Design a meditation app for someone who feels anxious
- Followed the CIRCLES approach with some modifications. Chose the elderly as a segment to solve and focused a lot on why a problem is arising and how anxiety for the elderly is different than anxiety for us (e.g. we feel more anxious in social settings while they might be anxious due to loneliness)
- Solutions - voice + vernacular support, devotional content, meditate with friends
- 2. If you are a business owner with 10 cabs that you have put on Uber, what metrics will have on your dashboard?
- Started from top goals and key inputs to achieve the goals, then put KPIs against these inputs and defined metrics for them.
- **R2 (Product Design;Behavioural / Resume;):** 1. Asked me questions about my past projects mentioned on my resume
- 2. You are the PM of a fitness app like Adidas Running; the app sends notifications to drive adoption; can you think of all the edge cases on when the notifications will not work or can backfire?
- Broke down the problem into dimensions - time, place, activity e.g. time, wise someone might be sleeping, working, traveling

- I suggested how these parameters will be different for everyone, so real-time decision mechanisms and personalisation at the user level are needed. I missed the whole angle of wearable devices but later covered that when interviewer probed.
- 3. Samsung want to monetise by bundling pre-loaded apps with its smartphones, how should you approach this?
- I answered 5 questions in order
- 1. Should it do this?
- 2. where? (Geo and smartphone range)
- 3. Which apps?
- 4. bundling structure (bloatware vs simple install)
- 5. partnership/monetisation structure
- Was grilled fairly on the monetisation structure part
- **R3 (Behavioural / Resume);** This round was a senior Product Leader and was focused more on resume and way of working.
- 1. If you are the PM of Teams (O365), what is the one metric that you will track everyday?
- I have engagement (hours per day) as a metric, gave me 2-3 risks and said how will I modify my metric to include those (scenarios like people sharing meme etc. instead of productive work and different work groups in orgs with different activity levels)
- 2. In a 3x3 grid where Talent is High/Med/Low and hard work is High/Med/Low, in which bucket will you place yourself?
- **General Feedback:** The process was long and well-aligned with core PM prep, so confidence and first-principle thinking are important.

- **Role:** PM2

- **R1 (Product Design);** ~40 minutes
- 1st half: Grilling about resume, going to great lengths about business metrics and motivations behind my projects.
- 2nd half: Improve engagement for Google Maps.
- Personally, I found the interviewer a little unprofessional, so just be mentally ready for that.

Zomato

- **Role:** Generalist

- **Pre-Interview Case Submission:** The candidate was asked to submit a 1-minute video on a specific problem statement. The focus was on explaining the problem context and breaking it down using first principles.

- **R1 (Behavioural / Resume;Product Strategy;):** Round 1 | Director, Restaurants at Zomato | 45 mins:
 - 1. Introduction
 - 2. Work experience details
 - 3. Why Zomato as your next job
 - 4. Case: Zomato has a 60% market share in Delhi, we need to grow it to 70%
 - 5. Deep dived into the restaurants piece within the case and wanted to understand what will you do if for a certain pincode both Dominos and Pizza Hut are not serving and your user is searching for pizza - what will you do?
 - 6. Some metrics and what will you look at to understand which problem to prioritize first - customers not enough at a pincode, restaurants not enough or delivery fleet not enough
- **R2 (Behavioural / Resume;Product Strategy;):**Round 2 | Director at Blinkit | 45 mins:
 - 1. Introduction
 - 2. Case: 20% of the delivery personnels are going home on the occasion of diwali. How would you go about handling the situation (he wanted me to think of very basic things like 1. Try to negotiate and stop them, 2. Non monetary incentives to stop them, 3. Hire new folks, 4. Get the remaining 80% to work extra hours)
 - 3. We gave monetary incentives in Diwali to the delivery folks and now when we reduced the incentive, they have gone on a strike asking for more money. How will you deal with this both from an immediate execution standpoint and structural change.
 - I made a 2 pager doc and took it in the interview and tried showing it to the interviewer but he was not super interested since I made it on hyperpure and he was from blinkit
 - **General Feedback:** First-principles thinking and a good understanding of the company and its various stakeholders are key.

Sirionlabs

- **Role:** Associate Product Manager
 - **Pre-Interview Case Submission:** The candidate was asked to submit a PR/FAQ, which was not discussed in the interview.
 - **R1 (Product Strategy;Product Design;Company Related;System design;):** It was mostly a free-flowing discussion. Used my introduction to strongly position myself for the role. What was important was knowing the CLM space and the legal tech space in general. The interviewer asked questions relevant to my undergrad and workex, such as possible tech solutions for lawyers.
 - He asked a case: we are L&T and we wanted to build Hyderabad metro phase 3 pre-pandemic. Now, post-pandemic, the rates are 40-50% higher. Explain everything that would be involved in the contract lifecycle.

- How can L&T negotiate with the government? What should have gone into the drafting process?
- Then he slightly altered the fact situation, made it about system design and made it about L&T's contractual relationships with its vendors - what should Sirion do to help manage the contract lifecycle with them? How do we plan out the SKUs given variability in cost and the contractual obligation to the government for the project? I explained the whole thing and included how integration with an ERP would help.
- Then he quizzed me to verify if I understood logistic and linear regressions and had me come up with a relevant use case.
- Then there was a discussion prompted by the question I asked about how features get made at Sirion. The whole thing was highly interactive and an enjoyable conversation.
- R2: Only I asked questions; the CPO was taking the round and did not see the need to take a round. I had gotten through R1 for both the product and marketing roles at Sirion; preparing for both had helped me get a better understanding of the company.
- **General Feedback:** Do as much research about the company and CLM as possible.

Practo

- **Role:** CEO's Office
 - **R1 (Behavioural / Resume;Product Metrics;):** Round 1 | CEOs Office Associate (ISB Co21) | 20 mins: I plant 2-3 curiosity cues in my introduction such that the interviewee is interested asks further details. Had a detailed conversation around work experience where I explained a project. Counter questions asked were:
 - 1. Introduce yourself
 - 2. Funnel conversion: How do you convert users better?
 - 3. Setting up a customer support team: What metrics did you track for this project?
 - Things that worked in favour:
 - 1. LinkedIn research of the interviewer - Gave common talking points right from the start of the interview
 - 2. Company and role understanding - Changed my intro to align with the company philosophies, mission and vision, changed my work ex in a way that it aligns with the role
 - **R2 (Behavioural / Resume;Math and Profitability;):** Round 2 | Co-Founder (India Business Head) | 45 mins: Went straight into work ex without asking for introduction. Once I gave the brief about my work which involved certain level of user acquisition, the question asked was "What was the CAC" - I did not have an exact number to this question and I did not want to randomly say a

number since he could mathematically prove that what I am saying does not make sense. I was genuine and informed that I do not remember the exact CAC but I do know that it was not good enough for us to continue the method of user acquisition and hence we shut it down. This was followed by a math problem solving session. The interviewer asked me to join an excel sheet and we went through the math of a company looking to start a calling center and hiring agents. There were fixed costs, variable costs and I went through the case route where I understood the problem, asked certain clarifying questions and understood the whole ecosystem. I allocated number of productive hours per calling agent and did the math to help the interviewer understand in how much time can we break even and what is the CAC. This made him clear that I can handle the P&L if needed and I had structured problem solving. After this, I showed them a short document I had prepared on the company (to show intent, they did not ask for any such thing) - I listed the user segments and their pain points and how would I go about solving it, what do I like and dislike about the product and a wireframe for the prioritized user persona. The interviewer asked me to send the doc to him for future reference.

- Questions:
- 1. Explain about your last work experience? How did you do what you have written in your resume?
- 2. What was the CAC in your acquisition project?
- 3. Math Problem solving on an excel sheet with assumed numbers
- Things that worked in favour:
- 1. I was honest about not knowing the exact CAC number and the interviewer was accepting of that fact and gave me a case to check if I am comfortable with numbers.
- 2. I prepared a doc which had my company research and what I like and dislike about the product and it was received extremely well.
- **R3 (Behavioural / Resume; Company Related):** Round 3 | Chief of Staff (Reporting Manager to CEOs Office) | 25 mins: More of an informational round telling me details about the role and what would it mean to work in this role. Informed of the company level details and just wanted to understand my journey.
- **R4 (Behavioural / Resume;):**
- Round 4 | HR (Behavioural) | 25 mins: Asked Why Practo in different shape and form
- 1. Why Practo?
- 2. Why Healthcare industry?
- 3. How do you deal with folks disagreeing with you?
- **General Feedback:** Read the annual report to understand the company's vision and mission.

- **Role:** Product manager

- **Pre-Interview Case Submission:** The candidate had two days to complete a 6-page concept note on cross-border payments, following a detailed template.
- **R1 (Product Design;):** Adoption of Google maps is low amongst senior citizens. How can we increase adoption?
- I approached this like a product design question with clarifications, persona listing, pain point analysis, solutions and prioritization. They also asked about monitoring success metrics at all stages.
- **R2 (Product Strategy;):** Should amazon enter good delivery business?
- It was majorly a stress test. The interviewer asked me to show calculations on Excel. I approached the question like a market entry case and was able to give solutions. They asked me for a GTM strategy that did not involve promotions/ coupons/ freebies but could still ensure market share capture. That was a tough one but I said we could have a loyalty program along with the prime membership. All in all, it was a stressful but good interview.
- **R3 (Product Strategy;Product Design;):** The question was that a US based trading analytics company wants to enter india. You are a PM for the company and you need to decide what will you still in India and how will you design and GTM the product? I did the market sizing, user needs analysis and suggested a solution for Indian market. Also gave some ideas to GTM the product to our chosen user base.
- **General Feedback:** Focus on strategy and GTM questions, as they will be grilled on these topics.

- **Role:** Product manager

- **Pre-Interview Case Submission:** The candidate had two days to complete a 6-page concept note on cross-border payments, following a detailed template.
- **R1 (Product Design;):** Asked 1 product sense question about improving Cred's conversion rate from 25%. Took 1 hours for the whole thing. CIRCLES->MVP->METRICS->GTM. I did not do this very well as I was working with a matrix of 3 customer segments and 3 products simultaneously - the interviewer kept on ignoring my comments wrt prioritization when I wanted to prioritize 1 user segment - 1 product. At the end I did a lot of solutioning and GTM but fell short on the metrics part.
- **R2 (Product Strategy;):** Asked me to do a GTM for B2B steel sheet maker looking to enter B2C market. Very chill interview. Interviewer focussed on multiple approaches to segmentation before asking me to proceed with one.
- **R3 (Product Strategy;Product Design;):** How can you help WIX beat shopify in India? Very chill interviewer, chatted away about things and life at ISB

while doing the case. I took more time on solutions so I was not able to spend a lot of time on 2 of the Ps (promotion and channel/place).

- **R4** Very casual HR interview. Asked why razorpay and why bangalore and about number of family members.
- Have clear and structured approach. Be good at creative solutioning and choosing relevant metrics. Be confident in following the approach. I think having a pragmatic check to see if it can be done in real life can also help.

ThoughtSpot

- **Role:** Product Manager

- **Pre-Interview Case Submission:** A case was submitted on integrating AI into MMT. The candidate took an unconventional route of focusing on MMT for businesses.
- **R1 (Product Design; Guesstimates):** Round 1 | with a PM (2.5 years experienced) | 50 mins:
 - 1. Asked if I knew the subscribe and save feature on amazon - I did not and hence he changed the question
 - 2. Product Design: Design a product to engage children: Focused on understanding the problem in depth, explained how buyer and user would be different and segmented the users into individuals and businesses (Thoughtspot is a B2B company), focused on businesses such as daycares and how they and the parents both are stressed when the child is dropped to play at a daycare. Ended up building a watch that helps communicate the child's emotions to both the parties and hence allows them to engage them in a personalized way. Got a lot of counter questions around how will you go about selling it, who is the buyer, how are parent's anxiety levels reducing, etc.
 - 3. Guesstimate: Estimate the number of Tata Nexon EV sold in 2023 - Took a simple structured approach after asking the clarifying questions; Missed out that the EV infrastructure is not very well made in the rural areas and could have simplified my calculation but communicated my thoughts clearly.
- **R2 (Product Design; Behavioural / Resume):** Round 2 | Principal Product Manager | 50 mins:
 - 1. Introduction
 - 2. Some work ex
 - 3. Design an alarm clock for the deaf: Clarified, stakeholders (Deaf and the caregiver), User journey, Segmentation, Pain points, Prioritization, Solution, Prioritization, Success Metrics
 - 4. How do you confirm that there is a market for this product (Assume pricing is not an issue): Took a real example of when do we buy a new product: Pain

Threshold and easy access to alternative; Deep dived into the pain and the alternatives and how much it impacts the deaf person's life

- **R3 (Behavioural / Resume;Company Related;):** Round 3 | Head of Product | 15 mins:
 - 1. Work ex
 - 2. Why B2B
 - 3. Have you worked with Tech
 - 4. Have you worked with Design
- **General Feedback:** Tech and B2B heavy prep would have helped further, as the company is looking for people who understand tech and can execute.

- **Role:** Product Manager

- **Pre-Interview Case Submission:** A case was submitted on integrating AI into MMT. The candidate took an unconventional route of focusing on MMT for businesses.
- **R1 (Product Design;Guesstimates;):** 50 minutes:
 - Q1. Design a washing machine for a leading Indian electronics company.
 - Q2. Estimate the number of washing machines sold in India in a year.
- **General Feedback:** TNot sure what went wrong with my interview. Maybe be more careful with segments and just be on your A-game wrt Product Design questions.

- **Role:** Product Manager

- **Pre-Interview Case Submission:** A case was submitted on integrating AI into MMT. The candidate took an unconventional route of focusing on MMT for businesses.
- **R1 (Product Design;Guesstimates;):** 2 questions were asked. Very conversational and relaxed interview. Prodded into 1-2 directions to think deeper.
 - Q1- Product Design- Create an antiques marketplace, for the suppliers. How will you work on authentication, marketing etc.
 - - Time taken was around 25-30 mins. Used CIRCLES method, different ways to work on authentication, how to look at offline methods, app for buyers etc
- Q2- Guesstimate- How many EV vehicles were sold in Bangalore in the past year
 - - Clarified if it is for personal or commercial use. Then focused on Urbal & Rural population and then broke it into age brackets and kept breaking it further down from there.
- **R2 (Product Design;Behavioural / Resume;):** The interviewer asked about the various ways I have worked on building/ developing products. How did I

measure the impact? Why did I focus on analytics and improve the results? What product suggestions did I have for the Product team and how did that impact the firm? Why do I want to join ThoughtSpot (kept iterating that the product is boring since it mainly caters to businesses)? How will I work with teams outside India, remotely?

- **General Feedback:** It helped that I tried to understand their various products since I could ask questions based on this (shows intent).

- **Role:** Product Manager

- **Pre-Interview Case Submission:** A case was submitted on integrating AI into MMT. The candidate took an unconventional route of focusing on MMT for businesses.
- **R1 (Product Design;Guesstimates;):** I worked in a startup. Question was if you go back to startup, how different would you have designed the product.
- My product was an IoT based solution to improve fuel efficiency of vehicles. I followed design framework and answered.
- **R2 (Product Design;Behavioural / Resume;):** How will you improve bangalore traffic situation?
- - Expected answer was to solve the problem from Corporate companies / IT Park as persona. I solved from government and a working professional's perspective. Followed framework but finally interviewer expected some creative solutions on the Corporate company personal.
- **General Feedback:** Stick to framework. Showing creativity in solutioning is very important.

Salesforce

- **Role:** Product Manager Senior Specialist

- **Pre-Interview Case Submission:** Salesforce had a case submission for shortlisting, and the candidate spent a lot of time on research, originality, and AI tools for wireframes.
- **R1 (Behavioural / Resume;Product Design;):** Time taken: 30 minutes
- Questions asked:
- 1. They took the first project from my resume (catalog management system) and asked me what I would want to change about it if I were to go back.
- 2. How would you improve this product (catalog management system)
- Approach: I told about the users for this product - suppliers and ops team and then I listed the pain points for each user and then one solution for each pain point.

- They asked me what seems to be the biggest pain point that I would like to solve along with justification.
- Follow up: If you have to convince your founder to prioritise this solution, how would you go about it (They gave a hint initially: Use porter's 5 forces and talk from high level business pov)
- 2nd follow up: Now, you have to convince your CFO to give money for it and probably you can prioritise another solution, how would you approach.
- I used my domain knowledge and answered using porter's 5 forces as the base. I didn't change my answer for CFO follow up as I still thought the same reasoning was relevant.
- 3rd follow up: If barriers of entry are low, and you can not beat your competitors for sure, how would you strategize?
- I proposed a counter-positioning strategy by focussing on creating unique differentiation value prop that our competitors can't take by focussing on premiumisation.
- 3. General questions on why Salesforce. Any questions for the company?
- I did some research about Salesforce and asked a couple of questions from that and couple of general questions
- **R2 (Product Strategy;Product Design;Behavioural / Resume;):** Time taken: 45-50 minutes
- Questions:
- 1. How would you increase adoption of X by 50% in next 6 months (X is the B2C product I worked on in my last company). How would I approach this?
- I first talked about how would I approach it if I were responsible for this. I talked about certain measures I will take to identify the root cause (product funnel analysis, user complaints, interviews etc)
- Then I talked about potential reasons for low adoption and stated my assumptions about what seems to be the primary reasons in these based on my domain knowledge. Finally, I gave some high-level solutions to solve those gaps.
- Advice: I focused on first-principle thinking and also kept on checking with the interviewer to see if we were aligned on my approach.
- 2. How would you implement the above solutions in 6 months?
- I am not sure what he was expecting, but I told him what I would actually do as a PM and stated my assumptions. He asked me to ignore marketing and other GTM things. I gave a month-wise plan of action on how I would go about distributing work in devs, handling integration, internal testing and GTM from a product pov.
- Feedback I received: Overall good, but think of bolder ideas.
- **General Feedback:** It is crucial to be thorough with the industry and product you've worked on. Rely on first-principles thinking and keep checking with the interviewer for alignment.

Eli Lilly

- **Role:** Product Owner - Senior Manager Level
 - **Pre-Interview Case Submission:** A pen-and-paper case was given on a health app, with questions on team composition, roadmap, wireframes, and GTM.
 - **R1 (Product Strategy;Company Related;Related to the Case;Technical;):** Two interviewers were present.
 - In-depth technical questions on Tech stack, DB architecture etc - based on my past projects/ resume
 - In-depth questions on Sprint Planning, Release and Deployment plan, Technical debt prioritisation
 - **R2 (Company Related;Product Strategy;Product Design;Related to the Case;):** Two interviewers were present.
 - Asked me to design the architecture for the Case questions - in-depth
 - Number and skills of engineering I will need. Next, they gave me resource constraints and asked me to decide how I will build
 - Added situations to convince leadership on this case and how to take it to market
 - **R3 (Behavioural / Resume;):** This was an interview with HR Head. 2 interviewers were present.
 - They asked me grilling behavioural questions. Around 20 questions in 45 minutes and were very specific to understand my contribution/ my role in each of them.
 - This was to decide if they can give me one level up Senior Manager instead of Manager
 - **R4 (Salary negotiation;):** After the HR round, they decided to offer me Senior Manager role.
 - Offer negotiation - they were not very open
 - Explained the perks and culture
 - **General Feedback:** Thoroughly review your resume and case submission.
- **Role:** Product Owner - Senior Manager Level
 - **Pre-Interview Case Submission:** A pen-and-paper case was given on a health app, with questions on team composition, roadmap, wireframes, and GTM.
 - **R1 (Product Strategy;Company Related;Related to the Case;Technical;):** Discussed technical related to the case.
 - Asked to suggest any 3 apps to improve ISB life.
 - Discussed technical from resume
 - **R2 (Company Related;Product Strategy;Product Design;Related to the Case;):** How will you manage an app crash.
 - How will u monitor the usage of AWS services
 - **R3 (Behavioural / Resume;):** What's not on your resume.

- What did you learn at ISB and other resume related

Zynga

- **Role:** Product Manager 1

- **R1 (RCA;Product Metrics;):** Asked about RCA for 20% revenue decrease in zomato.
- Answered with breaking down sources of revenue into commissions, platform fees and subscription fees. and then into further metric breakdowns to finally arrive at that average orders per week per customer is the metric that is root cause, then started finding reasons for it through the external reasons and internal reasons framework.
- The interviewer would stop me in middle of different questions and would ask, "if this was the hypothesis, how would you validate it. Here i would have to tell him the funnel metric or any other metric which i would watch to validate the hypothesis.
- Overall, pretty straightforward RCA but focus on metrics.
- **R2 (Product Design;Product Metrics;Related to the Case;):** I was asked if i was comfortable with doing a video game case or a normal swiggy/zomato case. I asked for gaming cause i did play a lot of games.
- Q. How would you improve engagement of Farmville 3(my pre assessment's game).
- Went about it a normal product design questions. Asked the interviewer in between for suggestions which helped take the final answer towards a newer thing than the same old solutions.
- **R3 (Related to the Case;Product Design;Retention, Monetization and Pricing;):** Q1. What would you do to increase D-7 retention in Farmville 3.
- Product design question only
- Q.2 Asked if a feature that i had not prioritized in my assignment was to be monetized, how would i go about it? and how I would do the pricing for the same.
- **General Feedback:** Be metric-oriented. If you play a lot of mobile games, use the features in those games to give final solutions. And if you are not comfortable with mobile games, ask the interviewers for a change in the question, they would be more than happy to help you out.

- **Role:** Product Manager 1

- **R1 (RCA;Product Metrics;):**Interviewer asked me if I was a gamer. He wanted me to choose an app that I used on a daily basis - I chose Instagram.
- The question was "Instagram has seen 15% decline in revenue." He just wanted to see breadth in thinking and multiple ideas.
- Try to break down the RCA problem in metrics format.

- **R2 (Product Design;Product Metrics;Related to the Case;):** Interviewer wanted me to choose a gaming app that I play regularly. Or any other app. I chose Ludo King.
- "What are some pain points that you have faced while playing the game. How will you improve them. What are the success metrics." Then we discussed monetization strategies and how to increase revenue by 2X in the next one year.
- **General Feedback:** Do prepare 1 gaming app for product improvement question. Also, RCA questions are revenue based most of the times.

Winzo

- **Role:** Product, Strategy and Growth
 - **Pre-Interview Case Submission:** A 3-page presentation was required on the next big game concept for Winzo.
 - **R1 (Behavioural / Resume;Company Related;RCA;):**30 min interview overall
 - 1. Introduction
 - 2. Why Winzo
 - Discussed growth trajectory, preference for B2C apps and Gaming industry. Discussed how role aligned with career.
 - 3. RCA (10% drop in Retention on Ludo after launch of a feature)
 - Discussed scoping questions, followed by identified how the feature affected the gameplay. Interviewer was interested in understanding motivations of users and how feature can affect their considerations.
 - 4. Observations on Winzo app
 - Discussed the unintuitive flow of external apk download, app size being too large for Indian users, etc.
 - **R2 (Behavioural / Resume;Product Strategy;):** 30 min interview overall
 - 1. Introduction
 - 2. Why MBA?
 - 3. Market Entry (How should Winzo enter Germany?)
 - Followed the GTM framework, to discuss users and preferences, games mix (football and fantasy focus) for product changes, promotion through sports sponsorships and pricing changes to move away from microtransactions model.
 - 4. Profitability (How would you address lower than expected profits for a game you launch?)
 - Described the revenue and cost models for gaming and listed the levers that can affect revenue. Discussed each to say how they can be tweaked to increase revenue.
 - **R3 (Behavioural / Resume;):**Founder Round for 20 min
 - 1. General chat about family and MBA
 - 2. What are your strengths/weaknesses?

- 3. What is your superpower?
- 4. How much would you rate yourself on Hard Work
- **General Feedback:** Understand Gaming metrics and Monetization levers for Winzo. RCA and Market Entry questions were asked. Use the app in advance to give suggestions on improvement.

Grab

- **Role:** product analytics
 - **R1 (Product Design;Product Strategy;):** A 1-hour interview to design a food aggregator app and measure its success.
 - **R2 (RCA;):** 40% MAU in November for Grab food, mart, and rides. RCA
 - asked a lot of resume related questions.
 - the biggest thing at ISB, what did u do
 - Life before and during ISB, what changed
 - **General Feedback:** Be thorough with everything Grab does.

Pine Labs

- **Role:** Product Manager
 - **Pre-Interview Case Submission:** The candidate was given three options for a case study with a high slide limit.
 - **R1 (Behavioural / Resume;):** 25-30 minutes:
 - Very conversational round. Mainly based on the case assessment, my resume, and how AI can be leveraged for the solutions I provided.
 - **R2 (Product Design;Behavioural / Resume;):** More formal round, a mix of my resume and a small product design/improvement question. The question was to solve for the high turnaround time in fixing POS machine connections for merchants. Suggested in-app and automated phone line solutions.
 - **R3 (CPO Round - Technical;):** 15-20 mins:
 - This was surprisingly a very technical round and I was caught a little off guard, I was asked about OOP, API calls and their response codes, REST API. Another question was how would you write a program which can summarise WhatsApp messages through GPT and schedule it at a particular time every day. Just wanted some basic structure about how I will design the program.
 - **R4 (HR;):** General questions about Pine Labs, why the industry, why the company, where is Pine in your preference. Biggest learnings at ISB and biggest changes.
 - **General Feedback:** Do the case assessment properly and be prepared for technical questions, as interviews are on a rolling basis.

Mastercard

- **Role:** PM

- **Pre-Interview Case Submission:** The candidate had 48 hours to solve a case and submit a video presentation with a deck.
- **R1 (Behavioural / Resume;Related to the Case;):** I was asked to explain the points I had written on my resume. From work experience in my previous role to how we came up with a solution during a case comp.
- I was asked questions on my case submission, why I prioritized certain features, how did I calculate TAM
- **R2 (Behavioural / Resume;Company Related;):** I was asked in-depth questions about my work experience, why I want to pursue a Product Manager role, what product I would build for Mastercard, and how I would determine its TAM. Each answer required detailed explanations and proper reasoning
- **R3 (Behavioural / Resume;):** Questions on why Mastercard and how would I navigate through challenges as a PM.
- **General Feedback:** Thoroughly review your resume and case submission to ensure you can explain every point in detail. Research the company extensively, including its operations, revenue model, and product offerings, before the interview

- **Role: PM**

- **Pre-Interview Case Submission:** The candidate had 48 hours to solve a case and submit a video presentation with a deck.
- **R1 (Behavioural / Resume;Related to the Case;):** Firstly it was intro, then asked few points from my resume. Tell what was the product you worked on, tell a specific feature workflow, how it was started and executed. Then the interviewer asked about the case submission(Not to present) but asked how would you sell this to a potential client. I have a pharma background so the interviewer asked how would you sell this to a pharma sales rep manager. Explained about the pain points it would solve in terms of costs and revenues. In terms of increasing sales of drugs, having good data analytics and others. Then a bit on why Mastercard.
- **R2 (Behavioural / Resume;Company Related;):**It was mainly random questioning. It started off with intro, then he took one point in my resume dug deeper on product development and others. I also had a startup experience, when mentioned he asked, If you were to reject all offers from ISB and start again what would you do. I mentioned market research, demand estimation, whitespace, problem I am trying to solve and others. He wasn't very impressed with my answer. The interview ended over there.
- **R3 (Behavioural / Resume;):** Intro, Then was asked what is your favorite data product, then asked random questions such as is Flipkart a data product, what is a data product, how would you define it. Why do you want to become a

"B2B" "Data" "Product" "Payments" manager .Why is data everywhere. Then was asked why Mastercard.

- **General Feedback:** It was mainly about data products and how data is used to build companies and products. A bit of randomness in questions but it would be better to know about B2B data products space.

Fresh Prints / Acube

- **Role:** Product Manager

- **Pre-Interview Case Submission:** The company gave three problem statements about their company for which the candidate had to provide recommendations.
- **R1 (Behavioural / Resume;):** 15 minute discussion around - why PM, what do you think a PM does, what do you want to do after ISB. General conversation only.
- **R2 (Behavioural / Resume;):** 1 hour interview. Resume based interview. Talked about previous work experience in detail. Why do you want to be a PM. Transferable skills. ISB projects. What all I have learnt at ISB that will help in becoming a PM.
- Behavioral questions like what was your most difficult project, how do you handle stress, difficulty working with PMs in past etc.
- Had to convince about my intent to become a PM as I did not have PM experience before.

- **Role:** Product Manager

- **Pre-Interview Case Submission:** The company gave three problem statements about their company for which the candidate had to provide recommendations.
- **R1 (Behavioural / Resume;):** R1 was all about me. Asked tell me about your work experience. From their the interviewer asked questions on my workex and asked behavioural questions.
- **R2 (Behavioural / Resume;):** It's again behavioural. Asked questions on my resume and a few behavioural questions like why are u the best fit for Product manager role.
- Tips: See the company website and about the company well. Be strong with your workex and resume part.

HiLabs

- **Role:** Associate Product Manager

- **Pre-Interview Case Submission:** The candidate was given three healthcare industry problems and had to choose one for their submission. Knowledge about the US Healthcare sector was needed.
 - **R1 (Product Strategy;RCA;):** Total time - 45 minutes
 - Product Design - Design a landing rover for Mars
 - They were testing if I can solve a very open ended and unconventional case.
 - Began by asking the objective: exploration of possibility of life on Mars. Who are we? : NASA
 - Identified the key stakeholders - researchers, engineers, govt, etc. I broke it down into design features required in the pre, during, post landing phase. Metrics are important. Talked about metrics related to communication and data collection (link back to the objective)
 - Guesstimate - # orders on Swiggy in Hyderabad in a day
 - **R2:** Discussed the deck in great detail. Focused on a lot of data science concepts as I come from that background. Asked about different NLP algorithms.
 - Asked about favourite product. I chose Rapido. Then gave an RCA based on it - ride cancellations have declined by 20%. After we got to the root cause, I was asked what should I have done to ensure such a drop didn't happen => Talked about how the feature should have been A/B tested before full scale launch.
 - **R3:** A very open ended interview on all things product. What are the 3 words that come to your mind when you think about product management? Given a list of 10 features, how would you prioritise them? Lot of behavioural questions.
 - **General Feedback:** They prefer people with data science backgrounds. Interviews are very very technical. They ask everything in one or the other round - guesstimate, RCA, deck, design/ improvement. Be conversational and thorough.
- **Role:** Associate Product Manager
 - **Pre-Interview Case Submission:** The candidate was given three healthcare industry problems and had to choose one for their submission. Knowledge about the US Healthcare sector was needed.
 - **R1 (Product Strategy;RCA;):** Started with Intro, First was a product strategy question "Should uber enter kids ride hailing space?". In between was asked to estimate the kids market size of ride hailing space. Tried to use financial viability and operational viability but missed the competition aspect of it. The interviewer guided me there and then concluded the answer. Could have applied 5C framework and arrived at a better manner. Then was asked an RCA on "Uber is facing a decline in a specific metric which is No of confirmed

rides/No of requested rides has reduced find out why?". Followed the general framework and came till the user journey. The answer was Ola and others reduced their commission rates causing drivers to not accept our rides.

- **General Feedback:** It is going to be mainly on product prep. Do it thoroughly. Try to look at all frameworks, product strategy too.

- **Role:** Associate Product Manager

- **Pre-Interview Case Submission:** The candidate was given three healthcare industry problems and had to choose one for their submission. Knowledge about the US Healthcare sector was needed.
- **R1 (Product Strategy;RCA;):** Completely on case. Showcase industry knowledge. I was questioned on metrics and personas. I had made a mistake in persona - B2B products have different buyer and user persona which i didn't explicitly mention.
- **General Feedback:** Validate your deck with other people preferably alums from Hilabs. You can correct the mistakes even after submission shouldn't be a problem.

DevRev

- **Role:** Strategy Ops

- **Pre-Interview Case Submission:** A strategy case was given five days before the interview.
- **R1 (Related to the Case;Behavioural / Resume;):** My interviewer didn't give much importance to deck (later they told they were satisfied with the deck). Grilled lot on why DevRev / why Strategy why not PM. Scenario based questions and instances from previous work-ex
- **General Feedback:** Prepare your resume well. As it is a founder's office role, more structured and prepared responses (STAR) will be helpful in initial rounds. Prepare strong story points from previous work-ex that would entail key skills enlisted in JD like stakeholder management, strategy implementation, team leading capabilities, managing complexities and uncertainties etc.

Browserstack

- **Role:** Associate Product Manager

- **Pre-Interview Case Submission:** The problem statement was the same as previous years. The candidate emphasized that focus on structure and metrics is very important to get a shortlist.
- **R1 (Related to the Case;Product Strategy;):** Grilled in depth on the case submission. Deep understanding of your metrics is important.

- Asked scenario questions based on the case - What if Google chrome develops a similar JIRA plug-in? Should browserstack chase and compete with the chrome plug-in or no?
- Ans: Company vision -> Product/Feature vision -> What if it competes and doesn't compete -> Conclusion
- **R2 (Product Metrics;Product Strategy;Behavioural / Resume;):** ' - How to determine success of WhatsApp calls?
- Took tree based approach to deconstruct whatsapp call feature from NSM - L0 - L1. Added AARRR and quality metrics.
- - What is your favourite developer tool
- Github. Couldn't follow structure properly as Github had lots of products
- It was a stress interview and interviewer kept on cornering on my previous software experience (I am a mechanical engineer worked as PM in and IoT startup).
- **General Feedback:** Show strong developer empathy. Researching about the company and its product is beneficial. Case submission is the most important. Company respects analytical approach to problem solving - so showing strength in metrics is a plus

AuxoAI

- **Role:** AI Strategist
 - **Pre-Interview Case Submission:** An assessment on stats and probability.
 - **R1 (Consulting case;):** Asked a case on Mergers and Acquisitions - Should a pharma company acquire a Biotech company?
 - Follow framework, Display analytical strength while doing discounted cash flows and company valuation.
 - **R2 (RCA;):** Your client is an Ed-Tech company. Teacher attrition is high compared to industry standards. How will you solve?
 - - Analysed potential reasons from Teacher's perspective, student's perspective and Company's perspective
 - - Proposed to analyse which factor dominates through Neural network / Regression. Prioritised regression as its explainable
 - Some scenario questions, why AuxoAI
 - Follow-up questions and discussions are very important to showcase interest in the work and company.
 - **General Feedback:** Knowing frameworks for Consulting cases is necessary. Do a research on the company's product and case studies. Displaying comfort with superficial AI ML concepts and its applications in business problems during the interview answers is a plus.

Amadeus Labs

- **Role:** Product Manager

- **R1 (Behavioural / Resume;Product Strategy;Product Metrics;):** Was a 40 min long interview with few small cases in between
- - What factors to consider if Netflix is launching in a new geography
- Use product growth framework. Covered product requirements, tech requirements and Content requirements.
- Why PM, Why Amadeus
- **R2 (Company Related;Behavioural / Resume;Product Strategy;RCA;):** 1hr 40min interview. Taken by Chief of product
- - Went into detail on every single line of resume.
- - Asked scenario based questions - Willingness to learn, Challenging situations, Owned and delivered a project, Stakeholder management.
- - Explain how Amazon's review system works (Posting review, how is it captured, what details are captured, where is it stored, how will the merchant see it). I drew a flowchart to explain.
- - How will you launch a startup
- Drilled down on each line of my answer. Tested the confidence in my answer
- - As a PM how will you handle a new request from business development team
- Drilled down on each line of my answer. Gave some scenarios in each step.
- - RCA question "Uber's no of rides have reduced by 20%"
- Followed framework. Wanted my approach rather than arriving at the answer.
- - Asked about my understanding of Amadeus and why Amadeus
- **General Feedback:** Research about the company and industry. Strong prep of resume is required. Senior people will be interviewing, so more practical comprehensive answers rather than a framework approach is expected.

2024 Interview Experiences

ADP

- **Role:** Business Analyst -3
 - **R1:** Product Strategy questions. "ADP being a payroll handling solution provider, partnered with Visa to launch a card. Is this is a good move or a bad move?" The candidate guessed the problem, did a market analysis (TAM, SAM, SOM) and evaluated if it added value to the company's offerings before making a decision.
 - **R2:** Abstract questions. A VP round with questions about the candidate's resume, "Why ADP?", and strengths and weaknesses.
 - **R3:** Abstract questions. A "Culture fit and HR round" with more behavioral questions.

- **Overall feedback:** "Do thorough research on the company. Go to their website, their engineering blogs. Most of the interviews will be on these. The more you talk about these, the better".
- **Role:** Product Manager
 - **R1:** Resume/Behavioural/Work Ex questions. "I had implemented a project as a Research Assistant. I was asked to rethink how I'd approach the problem as a Product manager and how the solution could be sold and to whom".
 - **Overall feedback:** "Product Sense is truly checked. Whatever you've done previously, look at it as: 'How can this be sold to the customer?' Or 'How else can this be sold to the customer?'".
- **Role:** Senior Product Manager
 - **R1:** Resume/Behavioural/Work Ex/Strategy questions. "Tell me about yourself followed by resume based questions, why PM? Why ADP? They were very keen on understanding one of my case comp wins for which the problem statement is in HR Tech".
 - **R2:** Resume/Behavioural/Work Ex/Strategy questions. "Round 2 went for over an hour with many questions related to my work experience particularly trends/threats in banking & financial services because of my work ex. Also asked me a question on long term winner between youtube vs netflix - pros and cons, tradeoffs". The candidate was also asked how they would solve the issue of remote work leading to employee foul plays. The round consisted of many short conversations on work ex domains and product strategy related questions.
 - **Overall feedback:** "Go through the ADP Pre placement talk as it helped me with understanding the company's gamut of offerings and what stands out in ADP's culture of PMing".

Airtel

- **Role:** Product Manager
 - **R1:** Metrics/RCA; Product Strategy questions. The candidate was asked about themselves, why PM, and why they would be a good fit at Airtel. A PM skills question was asked: "You are trying to log into Airtel App but are unable to - diagnose". The candidate clarified the problem and identified the cause as OTP not being successfully sent for non-Airtel networks. The second question was "How will you decide to build a product? - AI chatbot to resolve queries".
 - **R2:** Product Strategy questions. This was a round with the Product Leader and HR. The candidate was asked the usual "why ISB, why PM etc". A strategy question was given where the HR role-played as the Product Leader, and the candidate was supposed to convince her not to build a particular product. The candidate was told in the feedback that it was important to "keep a key metric, for example CLV, and then guiding the entire discussion around how building something will or will not contribute towards it".

- **Overall feedback:** "Know well about the industry trends, where the company is headed, how you fit into the role and company. Be honest and genuinely curious about any questions you have".
- **Role:** Product Manager
 - **R1:** Product Design ("Design x for y") questions. The candidate was asked to "Design KYC product which involves no use of facial biometrics". Major discussions were regarding industry knowledge in the Fintech domain.
 - **R2:** Product Strategy questions. The candidate was asked: "How would you launch KYC product in a new market. Let's choose Malaysia, explain how to launch" and "How to improve the KYC process of Airtel today?".
 - **R3:** Product Strategy; Metrics/RCA questions. The candidate was asked: "How do you measure the success of KYC? Define metrics to track performance?" and "Is API better than SDK? Explain the pros and cons".
 - **Overall feedback:** "It's a little luck based. Have your interviews scheduled early in the day. Strong intent on joining Airtel needs to be there to convert the interview. Prepare answers on why Airtel and what impact you want to prepare beforehand".
- **Role:** Product Manager
 - **R1:** Product Design ("Design x for y") questions. The candidate was asked to "Design the landing page of an ecommerce app". The candidate was advised to "follow the basic frameworks and always have a rationale for your choices/prioritization" and to "check in with the interviewer from time to time as you walk them through your process and adapt your answers/strategy accordingly".
 - **R2:** Product Design ("Design x for y") questions. The candidate was asked to "Design uber for blind people". The candidate followed a standard approach, noting that for a senior person, it's important to have a "zoomed out strategy".
 - **R3:** Resume/Behavioural/WorkEx questions. This was an "HR based round, pretty conversational and just final negotiation".
 - **Overall feedback:** "Process was extremely smooth, interviewers were great throughout. Had the best time interviewing. Standard PM prep is sufficient".
- **Role:** Product Manager
 - **R1:** Resume/Behavioural/WorkEx; Product Design ("Design x for y") questions. The round revolved around the candidate's previous work experience and a question on designing a product roadmap for a past activity. The candidate approached it like a product design question, dissecting customer segments, identifying pain points, and tracking metrics and trade-offs. A key takeaway was to be "thorough in your preparation for past work experiences, as interview questions can be unpredictable".
 - **R2:** Metrics/RCA; Go To Market ("How will you launch X"); Resume/Behavioural/WorkEx questions. The candidate was given hypothetical scenarios to solve for, such as prioritizing responses to low

metrics and handling clashing product deadlines. They were also asked for a 10-second elevator pitch for the Chief Product Officer and about their data product experience. The interview was "highly intense, testing my prioritization skills, analytical abilities (metrics), and capability to handle stressful situations".

- **R3:** Resume/Behavioural/WorkEx questions. This was an HR round focusing on salary, location, and offer confirmation.
- **Overall feedback:** The candidate advised to be "yourself, be prepared because a lot of my questions were tailored to product management to test your product mindset and my work experience, and enjoy the process irrespective of the result". They also read about Airtel's industry trends and used these facts in their answers.
- **Role:** Product Manager
 - **R1:** Go To Market ("How will you launch X"); Resume/Behavioural/WorkEx questions. The round focused on the candidate's resume and a GTM question on envisioning a partnership between Airtel and a real-money game. The candidate explained the benefits, products, and a GTM framework.
 - **R2:** Resume/Behavioural/WorkEx questions. This round was "entirely behavioural" with questions about past experience in product, involvement in product charters, prioritization of tasks, and communication with the engineering team.
 - **Overall feedback:** The candidate "had prepared to talk about high points in my resume and general frameworks and behavioural questions".

Arcesium

- **Role:** Sr Product Specialist
 - **R1:** Resume/Behavioural/Work Ex questions. The candidate was asked to "Walk me through your resume" and probed on why they chose a Product role coming from data science. The line of questioning became "very analysis heavy - 'say you have a platform and something is off, what is the line of questions you would ask of the data team to find answers' (an unstructured RCA question)".
 - **R2:** Resume/Behavioural/Work Ex questions. This round was on the candidate's working style and philosophy, focusing on why B2B over B2C, strengths and weaknesses, and specific project deep-dives.
 - **R3:** Product Design ("Design x for y") questions. This was a "data-science specific round" where the candidate was "grilled on some ML concepts and was asked to design an azure pipeline for setting up a churn propensity model on product telemetry data".
 - **R4:** Resume/Behavioural/Work Ex questions. This was an online, "interactive and unstructured" HR round.

- **Overall feedback:** "Arcesium isn't too heavy on the fintech side when it comes to questioning; what they are looking for is preciseness, structure, and general culture compatibility".
- **Role:** Sr Product Specialist
 - **R1:** Resume/Behavioural/WorkEx questions. The candidate was asked for an introduction, "why" questions on career switches, and why an MBA for a PM role. The round also included "some general metrics and quick design questions".
 - **R2:** Go To Market ("How will you launch X"); Resume/Behavioural/WorkEx; Metrics/RCA questions. This was an "in-depth round around WorkEx" and very conversational. The candidate was asked about a favorite product, how to improve it, and how to solve a problem where the biggest client wants a resource-intensive feature.
 - **R3:** HR round. This round had a design question on designing new features for Zomato and Swiggy, and other general questions including "how will you convince your fellow candidates that you should be given the offer above them".
 - **Overall feedback:** "Be confident about your resume and the work that you have done". The candidate also noted that since it's a B2B company, the focus on end-users is different.

Blenheim Chalcot

- **Role:** Product Owner
 - **R1:** Resume/Behavioural/WorkEx questions. The interviewer "deep-dived into Resume points" and looked for past experience in responsibilities typically expected from a product owner.
 - **R2:** Resume/Behavioural/WorkEx questions. This was a resume-based, past experience, and culture fit round.
 - **R3:** HR questions. The interviewer asked, "What you would get out of Blenheim and what would you bring to the table".
 - **R4:** Metrics/RCA; Resume/Behavioural/WorkEx questions. The candidate was given a case: "You're a PM for an ecommerce application and you see that your users are adding items to the cart but not checking out. Help us fix this".
- **Role:** Product Owner
 - **R1:** Product Design ("Design x for y"); Resume/Behavioural/Work Ex questions. The candidate was asked about a favorite app/website and had to design a new feature for it.
 - **R2:** Metrics/RCA questions. The question was "Drop in checkout orders for a e-commerce website. Why is it happening?".

BlinkX JM Financial

- **Role:** Product Manager

- **Overall feedback:** "Pre-assessments are a bit weird with puzzles and talk about a phrase or word kind of questions. Also pre-assessments were also done for select students only. Be mindful of the appetite of the company(get it from CBD) & look at their interview formats before giving them as preference".

BrowserStack

- **Role:** Product Manager
 - **Overall feedback:** "Focus on case deck submission -all my technical rounds were based on the case submission which helped because I had put tremendous amount of effort into it".
- **Role:** Product Manager
 - **R1:** Product Strategy; Go To Market ("How will you launch X"); Abstract questions. The candidate had to present their deck and answer questions around the proposed solution.
 - **R2:** Metrics/RCA questions. Metrics-based questions were asked from the deck.
 - **R3:** Abstract questions. The Hiring Manager asked about marketing-related questions based on an extracurricular point from the resume.
 - **Overall feedback:** "Prepare your case deck thoroughly and be ready for Product strategy questions + metric questions".
- **Role:** APM
 - **Overall feedback:** "Before and after submission, talk to people who're currently at BStack or have been in the company in the past and don't just restrict yourself to reaching out to alums to understand about company or case. Get case study reviewed from 2-3 people to take their views and identify gaps in submission (had prepared a slide-by-slide improvement doc for interview discussion). Also be prepared to cite examples from past experience and be thorough with resume".
- **Role:** APM
 - **R1:** Abstract questions. The round involved a discussion of the case ppt at length, with questions about the chosen metrics and rationale.
 - **R2:** Metrics/RCA; Product Design ("Design x for y") questions. The candidate was asked about product improvement for a parking system and an RCA question on a significant drop in DAU for a Live product.
 - **R3:** Abstract questions. The round included questions like "Introduce yourself," "Why PM," "Why MBA," "Why BrowserStack," and explaining the candidate's previous job in easy words.
 - **Overall feedback:** "Standard product prep, emphasis on good case submission deck".
- **Role:** APM
 - **R1:** Product Design ("Design x for y"); Metrics/RCA; Product Strategy questions. This round, with the head of product, focused on the PRD prepared by the candidate. A "significant chunk of time was focused on the metrics".

- **R2:** Product Design ("Design x for y"); Metrics/RCA; Go To Market ("How will you launch X") questions. The candidate was asked to "Design a laundry service for ISB" and design a launch strategy for the chosen solution. The interviewer posed hypothetical situations to test how the candidate would tackle them.
- **R3:** Resume/Behavioural/WorkEx questions. This was a "company fit round" with executives, focusing on work experience and reasons for joining the company.
- **Overall feedback:** "Be thorough with the case and be ready to answer any question on the solution that you submit. For interviews - develop presence of mind, be patient, and be thorough with interview prep on traditional case question types".
- **Role:** APM
 - **R1:** Resume/Behavioural/WorkEx questions. The interviewer asked the candidate to explain their deck and went into "complete detail on how I thought of each and every feature". The focus was a lot on metrics.
 - **R2:** Product Design ("Design x for y") questions. The candidate was asked to "Design a parking app for a mall" and followed the CIRCLES framework.
 - **R3:** Resume/Behavioural/WorkEx questions. The interviewer asked the candidate to explain their resume and hobbies.
 - **Overall feedback:** "Do thorough research before making the deck. Make sure that you can validate your findings".
- **Role:** APM
 - **R1:** Product Design ("Design x for y"); Resume/Behavioural/WorkEx; Metrics/RCA questions. The round started with questions on work experience, then moved to case questions about features, prioritization, and metrics. The interviewer spent a lot of time on metrics, asking why a specific metric wouldn't work and identifying flaws.
 - **R2:** Product Design ("Design x for y") questions. The candidate was asked to "Design Alexa for housewives". The interviewer wanted to understand the candidate's thinking process and pushed for "something crazy for moonshot" solutions.
 - **R3:** Resume/Behavioural/WorkEx questions. This was a "Standard resume questionnaire".
 - **Overall feedback:** "Research a LOT about the product, actually use the products when making the deck. Focus on metrics".

Contlo

- **Role:** TPM - Technical Program Manager
 - **R1:** Resume/Behavioural/WorkEx; Metrics/RCA questions. This was a "Standard workex related questionnaire".

- **R2:** Resume/Behavioural/WorkEx questions. The round focused on "Risk Mitigation and Prioritization of Roll Out".
- **R3:** Resume/Behavioural/WorkEx questions. The interviewer asked a "technical question based on parallel processing and threads, load balancing".
- **Overall feedback:** "Brush up on technical concepts and scrum master responsibilities".

DevRev

- **Role:** Member of Product Management
 - **R1:** Product Design ("Design x for y"); Product Strategy; Go To Market ("How will you launch X") questions. The candidate was asked to explain their deck, how they would launch features, and how to measure success post-launch.
 - **R2:** Abstract; Product Strategy questions. The round included resume-based questions, "Why product management," and "What is important to you in life".
 - **R3:** Product Strategy; Abstract questions. The interviewer asked resume-based questions, "Why DevRev," and about products the candidate had worked on.
 - **Overall feedback:** "Be thorough on your resume. What ever you speak, have a solid reasoning to back it up. Read about DevRev".
- **Role:** Member of product management
 - **R1:** Abstract questions. The first round was "completely about the deck submitted".
 - **R2:** Resume/Behavioural/WorkEx questions. This round with the Director of Product was "mostly behavioral and grilled on my past work experience".
 - **R3:** Resume/Behavioural/WorkEx questions. This round was "Mostly on workex, why PM, and why devrev".
 - **Overall feedback:** "Make sure to begin the case preparation early on... Be prepared to backup every sentence in your resume. Preparing for personal interview questions is equally important".
- **Role:** Member of Product Management
 - **R1:** Product Strategy; Product Design ("Design x for y") questions. This round was an "in-depth discussion on the case which I submitted". The interviewers used product design and strategy questions while cross-questioning on the ppt.
 - **R2:** Resume/Behavioural/WorkEx questions. The second round was with the Head of Product (US) and was more conversational, asking about past work experience, proud projects, and technical discussions on new tech. The interviewer surprisingly asked about "Precision, recall, confidence".
 - **R3:** Resume/Behavioural/WorkEx questions. The third round was a "fittment round" with a Senior member of the Product Team (India), focusing on why the candidate moved from a big tech company to a startup and why they wanted to join DevRev.

- **Overall feedback:** "Keep the basics clear - Product Design, RCA, Improvement, Strategy, GTM... While you are making the presentation (pre-assessment) - Go in depth of each feature you are proposing... Check about the company, and attend the pre-placement talk".
- **Role:** Member of Product Management
 - **R1:** Product Strategy; Product Design ("Design x for y"); Go To Market ("How will you launch X"); Metrics/RCA questions. This round was a deep dive into the candidate's case submission on Spotify, with questions on product strategy, implementation challenges, and how the strategy would change for different geographies and company sizes.
 - **R2:** Resume/Behavioural/WorkEx questions. This was a 15-minute interview with the head of product, focusing on goals, career aspirations, and challenges faced during cross-functional work.
 - **Overall feedback:** "Do a lot of product sense exercises - build on fundamentals of how a product is being built... Have a startup mindset when sitting for interview... Say 'I don't know' when you don't know".
- **Role:** Product Manager
 - **R1:** Resume/Behavioural/WorkEx questions. The round involved explaining the submitted deck, discussing the cons of the solutions, and talking about metrics.
 - **R2:** Resume/Behavioural/WorkEx questions. This was a round with the VP of product, asking about the candidate's resume and motivations to stay in product.
 - **R3:** Resume/Behavioural/WorkEx questions. This was a resume-based round with questions about roadmap and prioritization, given the candidate's prior PM experience.
 - **Overall feedback:** "Research about the company, check the website and what new initiatives they are working on. Spend good time on the deck".

eGovernment Foundations

- **Role:** Associate Product Manager
 - **R1:** Guesstimates; Abstract questions. The candidate was asked to "Estimate how much a Swiggy delivery agent must be paid for him to break even on his costs" and solve a puzzle about a machine to kill malaria mosquitoes. The round also included personal questions about problems the candidate wants to solve.

Games 24*7

- **Role:** PM-2
 - **R1:** Product Design ("Design x for y") questions. The candidate was asked about their favorite "physical" product (Apple Watch) and how to extrapolate its features to the IRCTC app.

- **R2:** Product Strategy; Go To Market ("How will you launch X"); Metrics/RCA; Resume/Behavioural/WorkEx questions. The candidate was asked to analyze WhatsApp's "channels" feature and its strategy. An RCA and a behavioral question on conflict management were also asked.
- **R3:** Resume/Behavioural/WorkEx questions. General questions about background and preparation for the PM role.
- **Overall feedback:** "Overall, very conversational questions were asked. Focus on the case should be on making sure it is analytical with lots of nos, data and beautifully crafted decks".

Gemini Intergalactic

- **Role:** Product Manager
 - **Overall feedback:** "Interviews were more towards judging how you would fit in a product manager role based on your situational analysis and work experience".
- **Role:** Product Manager
 - **R1:** Resume/Behavioural/WorkEx questions. Primarily behavioral questions were asked about dealing with stakeholders, handling conflict, and navigating ambiguity.
 - **R2:** Resume/Behavioural/WorkEx questions. The candidate was asked to rate their case submission and then grilled on its features, north star metric, and rationale. The candidate received feedback that they gave a "20ft view" and should have been more detailed.
 - **R3:** Product Design ("Design x for y"); Resume/Behavioural/WorkEx questions. The candidate was asked a product design question on an alarm clock for the blind and elderly, and about their favorite product.
 - **R4:** Resume/Behavioural/WorkEx; Go To Market ("How will you launch X") questions. The candidate was asked how to launch Gemini Exchange in India and for their opinion on the long-term viability of cryptocurrency.
 - **Overall feedback:** "Have some understanding of underlying technologies used (cryptocurrency etc)".

HCL Software

- **Role:** Product Manager
 - **R1:** Product Design ("Design x for y"); Metrics/RCA; Product Strategy; Resume/Behavioural/WorkEx questions. The round focused on the candidate's work experience at ICICI Bank, asking for issues and improvements on the iMobilePay app. The candidate was also asked about the North Star metric for YouTube and a recommendation engine comparison between YouTube and Netflix.

- **R2:** Resume/Behavioural/WorkEx; Product Design ("Design x for y") questions. Questions were on work experience, favorite product, and two guesstimate questions.
- **R3:** Resume/Behavioural/WorkEx questions. This was a quick discussion on the role and CTC.

HiLabs

- **Role:** Product Manager
 - **Overall feedback:** "Be very thorough with the case assessment solution and trade offs. Behavioural questions were asked in every round. My guesstimate answer was a bit off but the approach mattered. As the company had data science products, they preferred people with hands-on tech experience and Healthcare industry experience. There's scope for salary negotiation with this company - leverage it".
- **Role:** Product Manager
 - **R1:** Case presentation. The candidate had to present their case and answer questions on solution pitfalls, edge cases, drawbacks, and feasibility.
 - **R2:** Guesstimate; RCA questions. The round started with an introduction, "Why PM?", a favorite app question, a guesstimate on the north star metric, and an RCA on sign-ups falling on naukri.com.
 - **R3:** Behavioural questions. A round with the VP of Product and HR.
 - **Overall feedback:** "Case submission seems to be key".
- **Role:** Product Manager
 - **R1:** Metrics/RCA questions. The candidate gave a rundown of their pre-assessment ppt, with emphasis on the problem, users, buyers, implementation, and metrics.
 - **R2:** Product Strategy; Product Design ("Design x for y"); Abstract; Metrics/RCA questions. This round was a mix of everything, starting with a guesstimate on healthcare providers, then an RCA on dropping Instagram users, and questions on the pre-assessment presentation.
 - **R3:** Abstract questions. A VP round with questions on the candidate's resume, "Why HiLabs," and career goals.
 - **R4:** Abstract questions. An HR round with questions on strengths, weaknesses, and leadership style.
 - **Overall feedback:** "Need to be tight with the responses and link those responses to your resume point. Delve deep into product design and RCA because your case assessment will be picked on these points".
- **Role:** Product Manager
 - **R1:** Product Design ("Design x for y"); Metrics/RCA; Resume/Behavioural/WorkEx questions. The candidate was asked about implementing a web scraper for a project, questions on their case submission,

and to price the suggested feature. Questions on system design and an algorithm (SVM) were also asked.

- **R2:** Product Design ("Design x for y"); Metrics/RCA; Resume/Behavioural/WorkEx questions. An RCA question on a drop in Instagram users and a product design question on an app for people scared of animals were asked.
- **R3:** Product Strategy; Resume/Behavioural/WorkEx questions. The candidate was asked to elaborate on their diverse educational background, explain phases of software product management, and list methods for gathering customer requirements.
- **R4:** Resume/Behavioural/WorkEx questions. An HR interview with questions on personal and professional examples of HiLabs' core values.
- **Overall feedback:** "In your preparation for product design questions, go beyond prioritizing solutions. Address guesstimates (user segment sizes), product strategy (4Ps), and metrics. Familiarize yourself thoroughly with the company's product offerings. Delve into the technologies mentioned in your resume and those used by the company".
- **Role:** Product Manager
 - **R1:** Product Strategy; Metrics/RCA questions. This was a debrief of a case study with a focus on implementing proposed ML/AI solutions. The round ended with situational RCA questions.
 - **R2:** Product Design ("Design x for y"); Product Strategy questions. The candidate was asked to design an app for pet parents and a guesstimate on the number of pet owners in India.
 - **R3:** Resume/Behavioural/WorkEx questions. An interview with the head of product, focusing on company culture and behavioral questions to test for fit.
 - **R4:** Resume/Behavioural/WorkEx questions. A standard HR round.
 - **Overall feedback:** "Definitely build a strong foundation for data, and PMing in the B2B space. Do reach out to alums for guidance during pre-assessment cases. Be innovative but grounded in your response. Standard product prep will help during the interview rounds".

Incedo

- **Role:** Associate Project Manager
 - **R1:** Abstract questions. This round was based on a case assessment regarding resource allocation and the rationale behind choices.
 - **R2:** Abstract questions. The round revolved around previous work experience in the security sector, role, and understanding of risk and compliance.
 - **R3:** Abstract questions. A conversational interview with behavioral questions about the organization, career path, and future goals.

Media net

- **Role:** Product Manager

- **R1:** Abstract questions. The round included a guesstimate on the number of marriages in India, a design question on a dashboard for the Grammarly CEO, and an RCA on a dip in Amazon smartphone sales.
- **R2:** Abstract questions. Questions included whether Spotify should enter the audiobook market, designing an audiobook for Spotify, and how to rank search ads for Google Search.
- **R3:** RCA, Metrics, Abstract questions. An RCA on a drop in Swiggy's ARPDAU, a question on how a conversion rate graph looks over time, and a question on how to reduce conversion time. The round also included a question on a "Skip Button" for YouTube.

- **Role:** Product Manager

- **R1:** Metrics/RCA questions. The candidate was given an RCA on YouTube video views going down and an improvement question for Uber.
- **R2:** Resume/Behavioural/WorkEx; Metrics/RCA questions. The round included behavioral questions, a favorite product question (Google Maps, then Strava), a guesstimate on Strava's active users, and designing a metrics dashboard for the CEO of Strava.
- **R3:** Product Strategy questions. This was a "technical High Level Design interview" where the candidate was told to act as a PM for a company that makes browsers.
- **Overall feedback:** "Good interviews. The company tests your PM interview prep. Focus on first principles".

- **Role:** Associate Product Manager.

- **R1:** Metrics/RCA; Resume/Behavioural/WorkEx questions. A resume run-through, a guesstimate on iPhones in Chennai, and an RCA on a drop in Uber revenue.
- **R2:** Product Design ("Design x for y"); Product Strategy questions. This was a stress interview with a question on how to monetize private parks and a design question on an accessible spice rack for blind people.
- **R3:** Resume/Behavioural/WorkEx; Product Design ("Design x for y") questions. A round with a senior member to understand empathy and culture fit. The candidate was asked to design a product for a layman to plan their financial freedom after retirement.
- **Overall feedback:** "Standard PM prep, behavioral and resume mock interviews, basic guesstimate prep".

- **Role:** APM

- **R1:** Product Design ("Design x for y"); Metrics/RCA; Product Strategy questions. The round included an RCA on a decrease in Amazon orders, a guesstimate on a toll plaza's revenue, and designing a dashboard for the Uber CEO.

- **R2:** Product Design ("Design x for y"); Metrics/RCA questions. The candidate was asked to design an e-newsletter and a product for people to learn musical instruments.
- **Overall feedback:** "Media net asks all types of questions - Product design, guesstimates, product improvement, RCA, GTM/pricing. You need to be well practised with all types of questions".

Microsoft

● **Role:** Product Manager.

- **R1:** Product Design ("Design x for y") questions. The candidate was asked to "design a fridge for the blind". The candidate used a simplified CIRCLES framework, revisited their pain points when prompted, and performed a value/effort analysis on solutions. The candidate was honest about not having worked with hardware products and was appreciated for their candidness.
- **R2:** Product Strategy questions. The candidate was asked about how to launch "reactions" on Facebook 5-6 years ago. The candidate proposed understanding the market, running a pilot, and using A/B testing. They focused on metrics like engagement and "Stickiness (DAU/MAU)".
- **R3:** Resume/Behavioural/WorkEx questions. A general run-through of the candidate's work experience and resume. The candidate was asked how they would move a web-based EdTech platform to mobile, and presented a plan with stakeholder assessment, usage patterns, and a phased roll-out.
- **Overall feedback:** "Practice your Product Design questions well... Know metrics inside and out".

● **Role:** Product Manager

- **R1:** Metrics/RCA; Resume/Behavioural/WorkEx; Product Strategy questions. The interviewer drilled down on the candidate's basics, starting with the resume and a favorite product question (LinkedIn).
- **R2:** Product Design ("Design x for y"); Metrics/RCA; Resume/Behavioural/WorkEx questions. This round was over an hour long. It started with a work ex discussion and drawing a system architecture. The main question was a product design on a travel company.
- **R3:** Metrics/RCA; Product Strategy; Product Design ("Design x for y"); Resume/Behavioural questions. This was a final round with a Senior Director of Product, asking about work experience and improving the LinkedIn People Recommendation Engine.
- **Overall feedback:** "You should be thorough with your resume. Each and every word can be picked and asked. The interviewers have a knack of giving very unorthodox problem statements. It's necessary to not panic and think wrt first principles".

Navi

- **Role:** Associate Manager - Analytics

- **R1:** Metrics/RCA questions. A case-based round on an RCA for a drop in new customers for Swiggy. The candidate identified value drivers and proposed solutions.
- **R2:** Abstract questions. A guesstimate on the number of Uber rides in Hyderabad.
- **R3:** Abstract questions. A personal interview round with questions on the resume, "why analytics," and short/long term goals.
- **R4:** Abstract; Metrics/RCA questions. A case-based round, similar to the first round on Swiggy.
- **Overall feedback:** "There is no particular format of prep for this company. The process is a little too abstract. But from overall experience, be prepared to do basic RCAs and be thorough with your resume".

- **Role:** Product

- **R1:** Abstract questions. The candidate was given a hypothetical situation: "Imagine you are the business head at Cadbury. The company wants to launch Gulab Jamun and Jalebi as a new category" and asked to identify the opportunity and provide a decision with reasons.
- **R2:** Metrics/RCA; Product Strategy questions. The candidate was asked to define success metrics for Booking.com, perform an RCA on a drop in bookings, and suggest solutions to improve property ratings.
- **R3:** Abstract questions. An in-person interview on previous work ex, "why Navi," "why Product," and situation-based questions.
- **Overall feedback:** "Basic Product Prep, Read about FinTech industry and the company, try to showcase that you are fine with working in a high pressure environment".

- **Role:** Product manager

- **R1:** Product Design ("Design x for y") questions. The candidate was asked to "Design a product to improve the experience of blind people in an amusement park".
- **R2:** Metrics/RCA questions. The candidate was asked how to track the performance of the Airbnb app and missed the company's vision, leading to a wrong answer.
- **Overall feedback:** "Navi is interested in people who are good with numbers and have good product sense. Try to use lot of apps and understand their business goal and the relevant NSM".

- **Role:** Product

- **R1:** Product Strategy; Resume/Behavioural/WorkEx questions. The candidate was asked a question about a teleportation machine developed by Amazon and how they would use it.
- **R2:** Resume/Behavioural/WorkEx; Product Design ("Design x for y") questions. The candidate was asked to "Create a sports app for Tier 2, 3 cities".

- **R3:** Resume/Behavioural/WorkEx questions. The candidate was asked about their perception of the product vertical in Navi and "Why Navi?".
- **Overall feedback:** The interviewer expected "radical candour" rather than generic answers.
- **Role:** Associate Manager, Analytics
 - **R1:** Metrics/RCA questions. The candidate was asked to guesstimate Uber rides in Hyderabad and do an RCA on a drop in rides during prime time.
 - **R2:** Metrics/RCA questions. The candidate was given an RCA case about a drop in first-time users returning to Swiggy.
 - **R3:** Resume/Behavioural/WorkEx questions. The round was a grilling of the candidate's resume, asking "why analytics," "why navi," and day-in-the-life questions.
 - **R4:** Resume/Behavioural/WorkEx questions. The candidate was asked to write SQL queries and come up with a business problem for the query.
- **Role:** Product
 - **Overall feedback:** "Throughout, I was not asked core product questions that could use frameworks but other candidates were. So while you prepare for product in gen, practise some puzzles as well. Study system architecture a bit (try gaurav sen beginner series). Prepare your resume well and stories around best projects. If you reach the last round, expect a lot of behavioural questions".

Nykaa

- **Role:** Retention Marketing
 - **R1:** Abstract questions. Questions revolved around retention pointers on the candidate's resume, using the STAR framework.
 - **R2:** Abstract questions. Questions on retention strategies from previous work, segmenting the Nykaa audience, and strategies to increase engagement for "pink Friday" sales.
 - **Overall feedback:** "Be thorough with all the resume pointers mentioned. Understand how to use marketing automation tools like clevertap, moengage etc. to increase engagement and retention".

Ola

- **Role:** Program manager
 - **R1:** Resume/Behavioural/WorkEx questions. The company's CHRO interviewed the candidate with behavioral questions.
 - **R2:** Product Strategy questions. The candidate was asked a strategy question on how to approach a coffee shop owner who wants to expand their business.
 - **R3:** Resume/Behavioural/WorkEx questions. Questions were on work experience, the most challenging thing faced at work, and why the candidate was a good fit for the role.

- **Overall feedback:** "Understand the company and prep well to answer all the things u write on resume. Try to link ur work with the things at ola. If its founders office or prog manager role be ready to answer strategy kind of questions aswell".

Paytm

- **Role:** Product Manager
 - **R1:** The round started with an intro and a deep dive into the candidate's case submission. The interviewer focused on understanding the thought process behind the solutions and metrics.
 - **R2:** The candidate was asked about their favorite product (Myntra) and given a product strategy question about Myntra's return fee. The interviewer also questioned how to identify people with genuine returns versus those who abuse the policy, and asked about the candidate's understanding of APIs.
 - **Overall feedback:** "Be thorough with your case submission. Practice all kinds of product questions. Portray your".
- **Role:** Product Manager
 - **R1:** Metrics/RCA; Resume/Behavioural/WorkEx questions. The round started with resume and behavioral questions. The candidate was asked to speak about a feature they had worked on and explain its north star metric and other monitoring metrics.
 - **R2:** Product Design ("Design x for y"); Resume/Behavioural/WorkEx questions. The candidate was asked for their favorite product, followed by the second and third favorite, and then questions on the third favorite.
 - **Overall feedback:** "They do have some emphasis on metrics internally".
- **Role:** APM
 - **R1:** Metrics/RCA;Product Design ("Design x for y");Go To Market ("How will you launch X");Resume/Behavioural/WorkEx questions. The round involved explaining the case submission, with questions on research, customer journey, and understanding of metrics like CTR and conversion. A main question was "As a PM who interfaces between engineers and customers, how would you decide what features to build?".
 - **R2:** Product Design ("Design x for y");Metrics/RCA questions. The candidate was asked to "Design a washing machine for blind people". The interviewer wanted to see the candidate's thought process, personas, and anticipated pain points.
 - **Overall feedback:** "Be comfortable with breaking the frameworks. Research a lot about the org and current projects to be able to hold conversation. Do good numberwork in case submission - it will be scrutinized".
- **Role:** Product Manager
 - **R1:** Product Strategy;Product Design ("Design x for y") questions. This was a presentation of the pre-assessment case submission. The interviewer

"assessed the assumptions, chain of thoughts, width and depth of analysis and quality of solutions, and cross-questioned on the same".

- **R2:** Product Strategy;Resume/Behavioural/WorkEx questions. The round started with a favorite product question, with follow-ups on improvements. The interviewer also asked behavioral questions on why the candidate wanted to pursue PM.
- **Overall feedback:** "Explore the app as a user and think of competitors for all features... This on top of the basic product improvement questions should sail your ship".

Pine Labs

- **Role:** PM

- **R1:** Abstract questions. The interviewer asked the candidate to rate themselves on 5 parameters (user story, SQL, etc.) and then asked questions around those, such as "what are non-functional requirements, optimisation through SQL etc".
- **Overall feedback:** "There was only one interview conducted which was about 20 mins long".

- **Role:** PM - Product Manager

- **R1:** Resume/Behavioural/WorkEx;Metrics/RCA;Product Design ("Design x for y") questions. The candidate was asked about user stories and non-functional requirements for a payment platform.
- **R2:** Product Design ("Design x for y");Metrics/RCA;Go To Market ("How will you launch X") questions. The candidate was given a case: "You have 1 million dollars and 12 months runway, and you have to design a offline payment device for small to medium merchants in India".

Providence

- **Role:** Sr. Program Manager

- **R1:** Product Design ("Design x for y");Product Strategy;Go To Market ("How will you launch X") questions. The candidate was asked to design an app to find hospital beds in an emergency, followed by questions on market research, JIRA, and Agile methodologies.
- **R2:** Product Design ("Design x for y");Metrics/RCA questions. The candidate was asked to introduce themselves, talk about their interest in the healthcare industry, and design an announcement system for a hospital.
- **R3:** Abstract questions. This was an HR round.

Razorpay

- **Role:** Product Manager

- **R1:** Product Design questions. The candidate was asked to design an e-commerce app for blind people.

- **R2:** Guesstimate; Product Strategy; Abstract questions. The round included a guesstimate on Uber rides in Bangalore and a strategy question on Uber competing with BluSmart.
- **R3:** Abstract questions. The candidate was asked how to improve delivery efficiency for Swiggy.
- **Overall feedback:** "Do the usual product prep (design, RCA, metrics, GTM) Be strong with metrics and get started with a metrics-first approach".
- **Role:** Product Manager
 - **R1:** Product Design questions. The candidate was asked to design a solution for improving customer satisfaction at an amusement park. The candidate was advised to be "very particular about metrics" and "thorough and detailed in your approach".
 - **R2:** Guesstimate; Product Strategy; Abstract questions. A long interview on whether Google should develop a Netflix competitor. The discussion was brainstorming-oriented, covering moats, barriers to entry, and guesstimates.
 - **R3:** Product Design; Product Strategy questions. The candidate was asked how to solve for WhatsApp spams. The candidate noted in hindsight that they did not validate their assumptions with the interviewer, which may have been a mistake.

Searce

- **Role:** Associate Project Manager - Client Engagement
 - **R1:** Resume/Behavioural/WorkEx questions. The round was a "general behaviour/work ex round to understand my background". The candidate spoke about how their previous job was similar to the work at Searce.
 - **R2:** Resume/Behavioural/WorkEx questions. The interviewer asked for more details about the candidate's previous work, reasons for an MBA, and a deep dive into the resume.
 - **R3:** Resume/Behavioural/WorkEx questions. A "Purely behavioural session with CEO" with questions on fears, strengths/weaknesses, and what others think of the candidate.
 - **Overall feedback:** "know your resume inside and out, have a solid, impenetrable reason for wanting to work at Searce, have a decent understanding about data science and th".

Sirion Labs

- **Role:** APM
 - **R1:** Abstract questions. A "Detailed discussion on PR and the discussion revolved around GPT, LLMs etc".
 - **R2:** Product Design ("Design x for y") questions. The candidate was asked about their favorite product and improvements to it.
- **Role:** APM

- **R1:** Resume/Behavioural/WorkEx questions. The round started with basic template questions on the resume and behaviorals, followed by an explanation of the case submission.
- **R2:** Product Design ("Design x for y");Metrics/RCA questions. This round was with the co-founder and VP of Product, testing "almost every concept". Questions were on a favorite product (Canva), monetization, and key metrics.
- **Overall feedback:** "The interviewers will sometimes try to test you but it is important that you maintain your cool".
- **Role:** Product Manager
 - **R1:** Resume/Behavioural/WorkEx questions. The candidate was asked to explain their deck and about "Gen AI and about AI in general".
 - **Overall feedback:** "Lots of research, try to understand their product by looking it up on Youtube and try to see the use cases".
- **Role:** Product Manager
 - **Overall feedback:** "They released the case 2 days before 0.1, when you are busy with pre-assessments. Try to understand the company's business and market beforehand since the shortlists were released a few days before that".

Target

- **Role:** Assistant Product Manager
 - **R1:** Resume/Behavioural/WorkEx;Product Design ("Design x for y") questions. A "very conversational interview" with questions on work experience, situation-based behaviorals, and applications of personalization.
 - **Overall feedback:** "Be thorough with your resume. Practice behavioural questions. You can lead the conversation in the direction you want".
- **Role:** Product Manager
 - **R1:** Resume/Behavioural/WorkEx questions. Questions were on dealing with competing stakeholder requirements and tough/rude stakeholders.
 - **R2:** Product Strategy questions. A case was presented about shipping packages with a finite budget and three delivery options of varying reliability. The interviewer pushed the candidate to find ways to reduce costs in the value chain to use the most reliable option.
 - **Overall feedback:** "Good to have some understanding about the retail industry".

TBO.com

- **Role:** Product Manager
 - **R1:** Product Design ("Design x for y");Abstract questions. The candidate was asked to design a B2B SaaS platform for teachers, considering various stakeholders. The candidate used the CIRCLES framework and prioritized a target segment. The interviewer was happy with the approach and solutions.

- **R2:** Abstract;Product Strategy questions. The round was based on the candidate's resume and how PMs act in certain situations, with a heavy focus on stakeholder management.
- **R3:** Product Strategy;Abstract questions. Similar to round 2, but more focused on the candidate's personality. The interviewer asked abstract questions like "what makes me happy, or what makes me sad at work" and followed up on everything said.

Tesco

- **Role:** Associate Product Manager.
 - **R1:** Metrics/RCA;Resume/Behavioural/WorkEx questions. An RCA case on a rapid grocery delivery company where "Not getting all the Items I ordered" issues have increased. The round also included a role-play scenario where the candidate had to convince an engineer to take on a project.

ThoughtSpot

- **Role:** Product Manager
 - **Overall feedback:** "Experience varied a lot among candidates. In gen, when I prepared I noticed that they stress a lot on product strat questions and mention B2B PM V/s B2C PM in interviews as well as pre-plac talks. Typical PM questions only but prepare strategy and guesstimates for sure. They take common companies only - Swiggy, zomato, amazon, urbanclap etc".
- **Role:** PM
 - **R1:** Product Design ("Design x for y") questions. The candidate was asked to design "touch-screen devices for each table" for a restaurant chain. The candidate "made some critical errors early on by not thinking of the entire customer journey at a restaurant" and the interviewer noticed a lack of confidence.
 - **Overall feedback:** "Try to create a different 'About Me' section for each company that you interview at. You should clearly articulate why your life story connects with what the company is doing so that you stand out from the crowd".
- **Role:** Associate Product Manager
 - **R1:** Product Design ("Design x for y") questions. The candidate was asked to "Design any device to assist the visually impaired" for Samsung.
 - **R2:** Product Design ("Design x for y"); Product Strategy questions. The candidate was asked to "Create an innovative ceiling fan for home usage". The interviewer wanted "really crazy answers to test creative thinking and response under pressure".
- **Role:** Product Manager

- **R1:** Product Design ("Design x for y"); Product Strategy questions. The candidate was asked to "Design Youtube for Kids" and "Give new monetization strategies for Netflix".
- **R2:** Product Strategy; Product Design ("Design x for y") questions. The candidate was given a case that Urban Company was facing a decline in topline and asked for reasons and growth strategies. They were also asked to "Design a unique ceiling fan".
- **R3:** Abstract questions. Questions were on a favorite product, previous work ex, and why PM and ThoughtSpot.
- **R4:** Abstract questions. Questions on previous work ex and why PM and ThoughtSpot.
- **Role:** Product manager
 - **R1:** Product Design ("Design x for y") questions. The candidate was asked to "Design a product for blind person in home incase there is fire".
 - **R2:** Product Strategy questions. The candidate was asked to "Define the monetization strategy for smart table in a 5 star restaurant". The candidate chose not to include social media, but the interviewer wanted it included.
 - **Overall feedback:** "Thoughtspot is a well structured product company where interviews were held on time. They had good questions. Focus more on design questions - have a structure set in place. They prefer both business and tech folks for PM role/".
- **Role:** Product manager
 - **R1:** Product Design ("Design x for y") questions. The candidate was asked to "Design a driverless electric vehicle and safety system for the vehicle (Location - India)". The interviewer, a VP with 15+ years of experience, was extremely focused on fundamental thinking.
 - **R2:** Metrics/RCA questions. The candidate was asked what one metric they would ask their CFO for a D2C fashion e-commerce brand to see if the business was doing well.
 - **Overall feedback:** "focus on fundamental thinking / dhandha mentality over & above the frameworks we learn. cultural fitment - they will check for humility, your career goals & if thoughtspot is the right place for your career growth. key questions to prepare - design & product improvement".

TVS motors

- **Role:** Senior Manager - Lead Digital Owner
 - **R1:** Resume/Behavioural/WorkEx questions. The candidate had a combined HR and product interview and was advised to know their resume "inside out" and explain the "why" behind things.
 - **Overall feedback:** "Research the company, what they are doing, and their plans. Since the role was for the integration of AI in TVS dealership software, I went to a TVS motors dealership and asked them to show me the product

they were using. This way I learned more about the company and had an idea of what product I would be".

Vassar Labs

- **Role:** PM
 - **R1:** Abstract questions. The candidate was asked about their understanding of the user journey, metrics to assess a PM's performance, and the role of a PM.
 - **R2:** Abstract questions. The interviewer asked about prioritizing features, key KPIs for a PM, and low-hanging fruits.

Walmart

- **Role:** Associate Product Manager
 - **R1:** Metrics/RCA;Product Strategy;Go To Market ("How will you launch X") questions. The round was a sequence of RCA, product analytics, and strategy questions centered around an issue with the inventory movement of a store. The candidate had to zero in on possible causes and metrics to optimize. The second set of questions was about formulating an equation for omnichannel demand forecasting.
 - **R2:** Resume/Behavioural/WorkEx questions. This round covered the resume in detail, a relevant e-commerce case competition, and behavioral questions.
 - **Overall feedback:** "Overall, round 1 was metrics and analytics heavy. I used a lot of the theory concepts from the course LSCMA to answer the questions... Be sure to practice behavioral questions with someone who has taken real behavioral interviews in your batch, it honestly makes a world of difference".
- **Role:** Associate Product Manager
 - **R1:** Resume/Behavioural/Work Ex questions. This round was "purely based on past work ex and CV".
 - **R2:** Product Strategy questions. The candidate was given an Excel sheet and asked to come up with an approach to price a couple of products.
 - **Overall feedback:** "Be prepared with everything mentioned on your CV. Structured thinking and clear articulation is a must. Know about what Walmart does".

Winzo

- **Role:** Product + Growth + Strategy
 - **R1:** Resume/Behavioura questions. The interview happened on a phone call and was about the candidate's introduction and observations on the app.
 - **R2:** Metrics/RCA; Resume/Behavioural/WorkEx questions. Another phone call with an RCA question on Ludo's retention being lower than average.
 - **R3:** Resume/Behavioura questions. A "fun casual conversation" with the founder, asking about the candidate's "superpower" and observations on the app. The founder also asked about the new GST rules for online gaming.

- **Overall feedback:** "Not a very good interview experience. Very unprofessional behaviour by the first two interviewers. The founder call was well conducted".

Zynga

- **Role:** Product Manager
 - **R1:** Metrics/RCA questions. The candidate was asked to identify the reason for a 20% decline in revenue for their favorite gaming app.
- **Role:** PM 1
 - **R1:** Metrics/RCA questions. The candidate was asked to conduct an RCA on a 20% drop in revenue for the Harry Potter app. The candidate broke down revenue into metrics and applied an external/internal approach, but noted they should have stuck to metrics more.
 - **Overall feedback:** "For clearing the case pre-assessment, follow the CIRCLES approach with GTM... For PI, the rounds will be split across RCA, Metrics, Design/Improve and Game related insights. So be very sharp on Metrics-that is extremely important for Zynga".
- **Role:** Product Manager
 - **R1:** Product Design ("Design x for y");Metrics/RCA;Resume/Behavioural/WorkEx questions. The candidate was asked how their day would look like at Cashify and an RCA on a drop in Facebook Messenger usage.
 - **R2:** Product Design ("Design x for y");Resume/Behavioural/WorkEx questions. The round was on past work, designing a reverse logistics app for a marketplace, and a customized framework for design questions.
 - **R3:** Resume/Behavioural/WorkEx;Product Design ("Design x for y") questions. Questions on "Why Zynga?", "Why Gaming?", and a favorite gaming app (LudoKing). The candidate had prepared to improve LudoKing beforehand.
 - **Overall feedback:** The candidate advised to "prepare extensively for gaming related questions to show my inclination" and noted that "Generic PM prep won't help for Zynga".
- **Role:** Product Manager
 - **R1:** Metrics/RCA questions. Based on a case submission on Zynga's Harry Potter App, the candidate was asked to conduct an RCA on a 20% revenue decrease. The candidate used a breakdown approach, asking metrics-driven questions at each stage.
 - **Overall feedback:** "Be focused on RCA and metrics, that will go a long way in converting the initial rounds. For the case, make sure to follow a structured approach, can go through previous decks, decks on PM school and other resources".
- **Role:** Product Manager 1
 - **R1:** RCA questions. A typical RCA question: "You enter the office and revenues of your fav game fell by 10%. How will you find the issue?". The

candidate was advised to "start with external factors... Then move to internal factors and make a user journey. Always ask questions in terms of metrics".

- **R2: Product Design** ("Design x for y") questions. The candidate was asked what game they play offline and how they would design an app for it (Badminton). The interviewer gave further instructions and focused on the candidate's thought process.
 - **R3: Behavioural questions.** Behavioral questions on "why product," "best project," and handling conflicts were asked.
 - **Overall feedback:** "Zynga sends a prep doc 24 hours before the interview and mostly focus on RCA around revenue drops and design feature questions. Play a couple of games before interviews to get a sense of the gaming ecosystem, in-app purchase types and what strategies are used in this industry".
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2023 Interview Experiences

Absolute

- **Role:** Senior Product Manager
 - **R1 (Behavioural):** "Why my startup failed, Important skills for a product manager."
 - **R2 (Behavioural):** "Agri-tech supply chain related questions; SQL query"
 - **General Feedback:** The candidate was comfortable with the Agri-tech questions but told the interviewer they couldn't write the SQL query but could find it, which the interviewer was happy with.

Adani Digital

- **Role:** Product Manager
 - **R1 (Behavioural):** "Describe your startup". "your role as a pm in it".
 - **R2 (Behavioural, Product Strategy, Product Design):** "how did you decide your startup's product roadmap". "How would you improve ola".
 - **R3 (HR Round):** "Nothing specific. Company culture and fit".
 - **Overall Feedback:** "Be well versed with your role and collate to the role you're applying to". Be well versed with product improvement cases. Be yourself. Keep it human, candid and build a rapport.
- **Role:** Associate Product Manager
 - **R1 (Behavioural, Guesstimate, Product Strategy, Metrics, Root Cause Analysis):** "How many umbrellas are sold in India". "What are the pain points of booking an Uber?". "What is the first thing you do after you land at an airport?". "Tell me something that is not in your resume?".
 - **R2 (Metrics):** "Questions on Adani digital Labs, the arm they were interviewing for.". "What is Agile, sprint, ceremonies in Agile".

ADP

- **Role:** Product Manager
 - **R1 (Behavioural, Product Strategy, Product Design):** "Youtube Vs Netflix, Analyze Business Model, Long term sustainability". "What did you do in your last role". "Favourite Product & Improvements".
 - **R2 (Behavioural, Situational, Product Strategy):** "What was your most challenging project and what did you gain from it.". "Future of HR tech".
 - **Overall Feedback:** "Build an understanding of the business models of all common products and platforms."

Airtel

- **Role:** Product Manager
 - **R1 (Behavioural, Product Strategy):** "Tell me about yourself briefly?". "We are in 2050, and the concept of the driverless car has reached perfection in this world. What future problems for Uber will be and how to improve it."
 - **General Feedback:** "Airtel typically has only one round (post CV shortlisting) on day 0, which is made or broken. Try to keep this interview as earliest as possible so that you are done with at least one interview of the day."
- **Role:** Product Manager
 - **R1 (Product Design ("Design x for y")):** "Design KYC product which involves no use of facial biometrics."
 - **R2 (Product Strategy):** "How would you launch KYC product in a new market. Let's choose Malaysia, explain how to launch.". "How to improve the KYC process of Airtel today?"
 - **R3 (Product Strategy, Metrics/RCA):** "How do you measure the success of KYC ?". "Is API better than SDK? Explain the pros and cons".
 - **Overall Feedback:** "It's a little luck based. Have your interviews scheduled early in the day. Strong intent on joining Airtel needs to be there to convert the interview. Prepare answers on why Airtel and what impact you want to prepare beforehand."
- **Role:** Product Manager
 - **R1 (Product Design ("Design x for y")):** "Design the landing page of an ecommerce app.". The candidate was told to follow basic frameworks, have a rationale, and adapt answers based on interviewer feedback.
 - **R2 (Product Design ("Design x for y")):** "Design uber for blind people.". The candidate followed a standard approach, noting it's important to have a "zoomed out strategy" with a senior interviewer.
 - **R3 (Resume/Behavioural/WorkEx):** "HR based round, pretty conversational and just final negotiation."
 - **Overall Feedback:** "Process was extremely smooth, interviewers were great throughout. ...Standard PM prep is sufficient."
- **Role:** Product Manager

- **R1 (Resume/Behavioural/WorkEx;Product Design ("Design x for y")):** The round revolved around the candidate's previous work experience and designing a product roadmap.
- **R2 (Metrics/RCA;Go To Market ("How will you launch X");Resume/Behavioural/WorkEx):** Multiple hypothetical scenarios were given to solve. The round was highly intense, testing prioritization, analytical abilities, and handling stressful situations.
- **R3 (Resume/Behavioural/WorkEx):** An HR round.
- **Overall Feedback:** The candidate advised to be yourself, be prepared, and enjoy the process. Reading about Airtel and its transformation plans helped in answering questions.
- **Role:** Product Manager
 - **R1 (Go To Market ("How will you launch X");Resume/Behavioural/WorkEx):** Focused on the candidate's resume and a GTM question about a partnership between Airtel and a real-money game.
 - **R2 (Resume/Behavioural/WorkEx):** "This round was entirely behavioural."
 - **Overall Feedback:** The candidate had prepared high points from their resume and general frameworks and behavioral questions.

Atlassian

- **Role:** Product Manager
 - **R1 (Go To Market, Product Strategy):** The round was a discussion about the pre-submitted case, a metaverse solution for office collaboration.
 - **R2 (Behavioural, Situational, Product Design):** "Questions Regarding Case submission - basically explain this feature, if you have to pick one feature, one metric what will it be?". "What is your Favourite Product? Improvements? How will these improvements move the metrics (by what scale)".
 - **General Feedback:** The interviewer for R2 liked the answers but felt the improvement percentage was a calculated guess that "didn't land well".

BCG-X

- **Role:** Product Manager
 - **R1 (Go To Market):** "Design a product for ICICI Bank which caters to the NRI audience".
 - **R2 (Go To Market):** "Design a digital platform/offering for a stationary company like Classmate".
 - **R3 (Go To Market):** "Design a solution to cater to home rental needs for the youth in Delhi and Mumbai".
 - **Overall Feedback:** "BCGx follows a standard structure which they themselves discussed during the BCG dinner. Buddy mocks and following the structure was the key to all rounds of BCG".
- **Role:** Senior Product Manager

- **R1 (Product Design):** "Q: Design something for psychological needs of blind.". The interviewer tested the candidate's PM knowledge and execution knowledge.
- **R2 (Product Strategy):** "This was a real case of BCGx. Our client is an OEM who has a lot of physical garages to revamp and sell second hand cars. They are currently a completely physical model. Digitise their business but differentiate the client from existing players like Cars24 etc.".
- **Overall Feedback:** "Practice a lot of product strategy. Not just BCGx but almost every other top product company will ask product strategy questions.".

Beato

- **Role:** Product Manager
 - **R1 (Situational, Guesstimate, Favourite Product):** Basic discussion on the candidate's favourite product (Reddit), applying ISB learnings to a past engineering job, and a guesstimate on the number of steps taken yesterday.
 - **R2 (Behavioural, Problem Solving):** "Puzzle: How many points are there on the earth where you could travel one mile south, then one mile east, then one mile north and end up in the same spot you started?". A bunch of behavioral questions were also asked.
 - **General Feedback:** The CEO and COO conducted a conversational interview and offered the job at the end.

Brane Enterprises

- **Role:** Solution Leader SaaS
 - **R1 (Behavioural, Metrics, Product Design):** "Very conversational interview. The interviewer shared her experience with the firm, explained about its product & how it works. Then the interviewer asked about my professional journey & work experience.". A product design question was asked to design a solution for students looking to apply to universities.
 - **R2 (Behavioural, Product Design):** Questions around prior work experience and a design question for an app for football enthusiasts.
 - **R3 (Behavioural):** The round was with a senior advisor trying to gauge fit to the company.
- **Role:** Product Manager
 - **R1 (Situational, Go To Market, Product Strategy, Metrics, Product Design):** "How will you design a product to improve performance of a casual Badminton player".

BrowserStack

- **Role:** Associate Product Manager
 - **R1 (Metrics):** "The interview was majorly around the case submitted and the features suggested and metrics used to measure.".

- **General Feedback:** "Be thorough on your case submission and get it reviewed from alums if possible to understand any loopholes and address them during the interviews".
- **Role:** Associate Product Manager
 - **R1 (Case Discussion):** Questions about problem identification were asked. The candidate had to explain what problems they identified and why they chose to solve them.
 - **R2 (Metrics, Product Design, Behavioural):** "Choose an application of your choice and suggest improvements along with metrics that you would use to measure success.". The candidate chose Instagram.
 - **R3 (Root Cause Analysis):** "Suppose DAU for WhatsApp is decreasing. If you were a PM, how would you approach a RCA around this?".
 - **General Feedback:** "Have an in-depth understanding of BrowserStack products and how they actually work in the backend.".

Chargebee

- **Role:** Product Manager
 - **R1 (Behavioural, Product Strategy):** The candidate was asked what options Chargebee could explore for subscription management services for OTTs, based on their case submission.
 - **R2 (Behavioural):** "Why product management", "Why mba", and "What do I look for in a company".
 - **General Feedback:** "Just be yourself. Cultural fit is about knowing if you will fit in the company or not. Do a bit of research about the company and tailor your answers accordingly.".

Cisco

- **Role:** Product Manager
 - **R1 (Guesstimate):** "Revenue of Gmail". "Difficult Situation at work".
 - **R2 (Behavioural):** "Explain something from your resume".
 - **R3 (HR Round):** "Why Cisco". "Competitors of Cisco".
 - **Overall Feedback:** "Look up basic company info".

Cogoport

- **Role:** Product Manager
 - **R1 (Behavioural):** Questions were asked about a Big Data project on the candidate's resume.
 - **R2 (Behavioural):** HR questions, such as "Why would you choose a startup and not some famous MNCs?".
- **Role:** Product Manager
 - **R1 (Product Strategy, Case Discussion):** Discussion on the business problem given prior to the pre-assessment round.

- **R2 (Behavioural, Behavioural):** "What is product management and why do you fit in this role?". The interviewer also asked a peculiar question: "Are you single/married? Do you think monogamists are compliant people and hence not adventurous?".

DevRev

- **Role:** Strategic Business Operations
 - **R1 (Behavioural, Situational):** Resume grilling, specifically on a previous experience at Flipkart.
 - **R2 (Behavioural, Go To Market):** "How would you launch DevRev in Japan".
 - **R3 (Behavioural):** A "Culture-fit round."
 - **General Feedback:** "Be very thorough with your resume".
- **Role:** Product Manager
 - **R1 (Product Design, Case Discussion):** The candidate was asked to present a deck on improving a favorite product.
 - **R2 (Behavioural):** "What has been your journey till now" and "Why Devrev?".
 - **R3 (CEO Round):** The candidate had to ask all the questions they had about DevRev to the founder.
 - **General Feedback:** "Be prepared to backup every sentence in your resume".

EXL

- **Role:** Program Manager
 - **R1 (Behavioural, Situational, Go To Market, Product Strategy):** Guesstimate about "number of users on instagram".
 - **R2 (Product Strategy):** "How to make people on Facebook move to instagram as well".

Games24x7

- **Role:** Product Manager
 - **R1 (Behavioural, Product Strategy, Metrics, Root Cause Analysis, Product Design):** "What is your favourite product?" (Zerodha was chosen). "If you were to destroy Zerodha, how would you do it?".
 - **R2 (Behavioural, Situational, Product Strategy, Product Design):** Behavioural questions and "What features would you introduce to Netflix?".
 - **General Feedback:** "Nothing specific, just be honest and genuine - they can see through lies".
- **Role:** Product Manager 2
 - **R1 (Go To Market, Go To Market):** Pre-Assessment Case: "Feasibility analysis of second-hand marketplace with charity proceeds".
 - **R2 (Product Strategy, Product Design):** "Why has Whatsapp Payments not taken off in a similar fashion as Gpay, PhonePe, other payments." and "Suggest OTT improvements for a social experience".

- **R3 (Behavioural, Go To Market, Product Strategy):** The candidate was given a budget and asked to distribute it between customer acquisition and retention.
- **R4 (Behavioural):** An HR round with questions about what excites and worries the candidate about the role.
- **General Feedback:** "Overall, very conversational questions were asked. Focus on the case should be on making sure it is analytical with lots of nos, data and beautifully crafted decks."

Head Digital Works

- **Role:** Senior Product Manager

- **R1 (Behavioural, Product Strategy):** A conversational discussion on credit, P2P, and BNPL. Questions were also asked about matching algorithms and monetization strategies.
- **R2 (Behavioural, Situational, Root Cause Analysis):** RCA question: "Imagine you are the PM at Amazon Prime and you notice the viewership dropping by 10% in India."
- **R3 (Go To Market, Metrics, Root Cause Analysis):** Metrics: "How would you measure the success of a new game you launched?" and RCA: "The number of .apk file downloads from the HD works website has reduced remarkably. What could be the reason for the same?"
- **General Feedback:** "Make sure to absorb knowledge about the various industries and their functioning. ...Prepare well about the company and the industry."

HiLabs

- **Role:** Product Manager

- **R1 (Go To Market, Product Strategy, Metrics):** The candidate was asked to launch an electric bicycle renting app. They used marketing frameworks and defined the North Star Metric.
- **R2 (Product Strategy, Product Design):** A discussion on the case submission.
- **R3 (Behavioural):** The CEO asked about why the candidate wanted to join HiLabs.
- **R4 (HR Round):** A normal HR round on preferences.
- **General Feedback:** The candidate focused on pricing and GTM strategy after doing research on the company.

- **Role:** Product Manager

- **R1 (Guesstimate, Product Design, Case Discussion):** A walkthrough of the case submission, a guesstimate on insurance claims, and questions on data science algorithms.

- **R2 (Situational, Product Design):** Situational questions on prioritization and team conflicts, and a product design question on improving Google Maps for the elderly.
- **R3 (Behavioural, Situational, Product Strategy):** "How will you price a SaaS product?" and "Motivation for joining HiLabs".
- **R4 (Behavioural, Situational):** A standard HR round.
- **General Feedback:** "Focus on your case....Your product prep with Design, RCA etc will help you in this round".

Hilti Technology Solutions

- **Role:** Product Owner
 - **R1 (Product Design):** "Design Uber for old people" and "How will you measure success of your product".
 - **R2 (Behavioural):** "Why product owner" and "Why Hilti".

Housing.com

- **Role:** Product Manager
 - **R1 (Product Design):** "Improve Netflix".
 - **R2 (Behavioural):** "What's your goal in next 5 years" and "Why Housing.com?".
 - **R3 (HR Round):** Questions about expected compensation.

Jio

- **Role:** Product Manager
 - **R1 (Problem Solving):** A supply chain-related situation about Myntra's delivery.
 - **R2 (Product Strategy):** "Pick a Jio product and compare it with competitors." and "How will you market it to get more users?".
 - **R3 (Behavioural, Situational):** "Tell me about yourself, Talk about a difficult situation.".
 - **General Feedback:** "Read about all their products and try using it. ...Know your resume properly".
- **Role:** Product Manager
 - **R1 (Favourite Product):** "Tell me about your favourite product and how will you improve it?".
 - **R2 (Product Design):** "Design smart refrigerator for Jio so that it becomes market leader.".
 - **R3 (Behavioural):** "Tell me about yourself? Why PM" and "Why MBA? Why Jio?".
 - **General Feedback:** "Start the prep with BTC Handbook and read all the interview experiences of that or a similar company from the handbook when shortlisted."

Jivox

- **Role:** Customer Success Manager
 - **R1 (Ad Design):** "Design a dynamic ad creative for Cereal company".
 - **R2 (Behavioural):** Questions were around the candidate's digital marketing work experience.
 - **R3 (CEO Round):** A general conversation with the CEO.

Keka

- **Role:** Product Manager
 - **R1 (Product Design):** The candidate was grilled on the case submission.
 - **R2 (Behavioural, Product Design):** This round was with the CEO, who asked why the candidate wanted to be a PM. The candidate was also asked to pick a single solution from their case submission.
 - **General Feedback:** "Be a better listener. Interviews with CEOs are a great way to learn."

Media.net

- **Role:** Associate Product Manager
 - **R1 (Product Design, Case Discussion):** A case study on "increasing engagement acquisition of Travel reviews website".
 - **R2 (Behavioural, Situational, Guesstimate):** Questions on "What is NPS", "Describe Database to a 5 year old" and a guesstimate on the number of weddings in India.
 - **R3 (Go To Market, Product Design):** "Redesign Skip Ad button on YouTube".
 - **R4 (Situational, Metrics, Root Cause Analysis):** An RCA on Uber rides dropping and "Design a dashboard for Ola CEO".
 - **General Feedback:** "Calm and confident".
- **Role:** Associate Product Manager
 - **R1 (Go To Market, Product Strategy, Product Design):** An extensive case study on Tripadvisor, with new features, revenue streams, and revenue projection.
 - **R2 (Guesstimate):** "Find the number of Petrol Pumps that should be required to suffice's Delhi's traffic in next 2 years".
 - **R3 (Product Design):** "Imagine you are Apple in the 1990s. Design a communication device for the visually impaired."
 - **R4 (Root Cause Analysis):** "There has been an 80% drop in Viewership on Netflix. Identify reasons."
 - **General Feedback:** "Read up on digital media".

Microsoft

- **Role:** Product Manager 2

- **R1 (Product Design, Product Strategy):** "How would you solve the language barrier that exists in India?"
- **R2 (Product Design):** "Design a refrigerator for blind people."
- **R3 (Behavioural):** Questions from the candidate's past work experience.
- **General Feedback:** The interviewer was mainly interested in the candidate's thought process.
- **Role:** Product Manager
 - **R1 (Case Discussion):** "Traditional libraries are on the verge of extinction. Suggest a solution to deal with this problem."
 - **R2 (Product Design):** "How would you deal with fake reviews on Amazon?"
 - **R3 (Product Design):** "Design a health product for migrants living in a camp."
 - **R4 (Behavioural):** "Explain big data to 6-year-olds."
 - **General Feedback:** "Talk to the interviewer, try to get subtle hints, and give a logical explanation."

MPS Ltd.

- **Role:** Product Manager
 - **R1 (Behavioural, Go To Market, Product Strategy, Metrics):** "Design Go To Market Strategy for the Product in a New Geography".
 - **R2 (Behavioural, Situational):** "CV Based. Went into nitty gritty of CV".
 - **R3 (Behavioural, Product Strategy):** "Company related. How do you plan to work on specific aspects of the product strategy for MPS Ltd."
 - **R4 (Behavioural):** "Fitment round. How well do you fit with the company culture, expectations."

Nagarro

- **Role:** Delivery (Scrum Master)
 - **R1 (Behavioural, Situational, Behavioural):** "Tell us something interesting about you".
 - **R2 (Behavioural, Situational, General):** "What are some of the latest disruptions in tech".
 - **R3 (HR Round):** Basic HR questions.
 - **General Feedback:** "Focus on building up an integrated personal and professional story, and know your previous work in depth."
- **Role:** Business Consultant - Advertising Domain
 - **R1 (Behavioural, Situational, Product Strategy, Root Cause Analysis, Product Design):** "Resume-based questions, explain how you have achieved so and so, previous experience, etc".
 - **R2 (Situational, Go To Market, Root Cause Analysis):** "What is your favourite subject at ISB, and why?".

Navi

- **Role:** Associate Product Manager
 - **R1 (Behavioural, Product Strategy, Product Design):** "Favourite fintech product? Why? How would you improve it?".
 - **R2 (Behavioural, Product Strategy, Product Design):** "Consider there are only 2 players (Swiggy and Zomato) in the food delivery space and each of them has 50% market share. How can Swiggy capture 80% market share?".
 - **General Feedback:** "Structure matters. They gave higher weightage to structure than solutions."

Nium

- **Role:** Product Manager
 - **R1 (Behavioural, Product Design):** "Create a service that detects meeting conflicts".
 - **R2 (Guesstimate):** "Guesstimate the number of coffee sold in starbucks in India per day".
 - **R3 (Behavioural, Situational):** "Why PM?" and "Why NIUM?".
 - **General Feedback:** "Be foolproof in your clarifying questions."

Nykaa

- **Role:** Product Manager
 - **R1 (Metrics, Product Design):** "What are your 5 favourite products... LinkedIn D7 retention went down (60%→40%). How to improve?".
 - **R2 (Behavioural, Metrics, Product Design):** "How will you solve for paradox of choice in Myntra".
 - **R3 (Behavioural, Product Design):** "Design a new-age airport experience".
 - **General Feedback:** "Structure matters. When preparing for interviews give higher weightage to structure than solutions".

Paytm

- **Role:** Product Manager
 - **R1 (Case Discussion):** RCA case on the Paytm sales agent application, with sales agents leaving after a month.
 - **R2 (Case Discussion):** Presentation of the case deck submitted earlier.
 - **R3 (Product Strategy):** A technical question on linked lists and "If you have to launch Google maps and Youtube, which one will you launch first?"
 - **General Feedback:** "Be thorough with your case submission."
- **Role:** Product Manager
 - **R1 (Product Design, Behavioural):** "Since you're interested in football, design an app for football (it's your interpretation)?" A puzzle was also asked.
 - **R2 (Product Design, Behavioural):** "What is your favourite product and is there any improvement with it?". "Why Paytm?".

- **Overall Feedback:** "Be prepared about company and brush up fundamentals of Product Management. Should be an easy interview process."
- **Role:** Product Manager
 - **R1 (Product Design, Technical):** "Design an app to take banking to doorstep". A technical question on creating a fraud-proof vulnerability detection algorithm was also asked.
 - **R2 (Product Design):** "Favourite product" (Google Maps) and "How can u improve google maps?"

Razorpay

- **Role:** Product Strategy
 - **R1 (Product Design, GTM/Market Entry):** "Nykaa wants to enter the Buy now Pay Later Segment. What considerations would you take?"
 - **R2 (Product Design, GTM/Market Entry):** "We have a network of 1000 tailors in Bangalore, who have some free time. Using this network, what business can you build?"
 - **R3 (RCA):** "If the defaults increase in a banking app, what factors would you consider?"
- **Role:** Product Manager
 - **R1 (Product Design, GTM/Market Entry):** PM at WhatsApp. "Planning for integration with Spotify. Good decision or not? How would you go about it?"
 - **R2 (Product Design, RCA):** PM at Uber. "Reduce Driver cancellations".
 - **R3 (GTM/Market Entry):** "GTM for Neemans shoe company to different geographies".
- **Role:** Product Manager
 - **R1 (Product Design, Behavioural):** "Give me a summary of your resume in 2 minutes, what are you most proud of from undergraduate and ISB time?". "Design an OTT platform for Marathi content."
 - **R2 (GTM/Market Entry):** "Should Uber introduce a cash payment option? Explore the growth potential and risk factors."
 - **R3 (RCA, Metrics, Behavioural):** "Why Razorpay and why Product management?". "What metrics would you track to measure the success of Instagram reels?". "Design a shopping app to improve the in-store shopping experience."
 - **R4 (GTM/Market Entry):** "Myntra wants to expand into new categories to target a premium user base. How would you go about it?"
- **Role:** Product Manager
 - **R1 (GTM/Market Entry):** "Should Amazon Ring launch in India?"
 - **R2 (Product Design):** "Fav product".
 - **R3 (Product Design):** PM at Zomato. "What should you do?"
 - **R4 (Behavioural):** Resume related questions.

Rupeek

- **Role:** Product Manager
 - **R1 (Product Design, GTM/Market Entry, Behavioural):** "Explain your case submission and why did you choose to target a particular user segment". "You are a PM at Finshots. Come up with a monetisation plan for the product.". "Why PM?".
 - **R2 (Behavioural):** An HR round with behavioral questions.
- **Role:** Product Manager
 - **R1 (Guesstimate, GTM/Market Entry):** "How many Swiggy delivery partners are present in Bangalore?". "How will you launch Zomato at a tier-2 city?".
 - **General Feedback:** The panel was giving the candidate time to think and was listening carefully.

ShareChat

- **Role:** Product Manager
 - **R1 (Product Design):** "Case 1 - Create a product to improve the health of your users". "Case 2 - Design a fitness channel product addition for Netflix". "Case 3 - Design a product for Facebook Travel".

Swiggy

- **Role:** Associate Product Manager
 - **R1 (RCA, Metrics, GTM/Market Entry, Behavioural):** "Platform traffic on Swiggy has dropped suddenly and significantly last week. Do RCA". "How to improve Swiggy".
 - **General Feedback:** "Be very thorough with company research as all questions asked were app specific."
- **Role:** Associate Product Manager
 - **R1 (Product Design, Guesstimate):** "Guesstimate the market size for an EV-expert battery manufacturing company entering India.". "How can we measure/change the discount perception on Instamart?".
 - **R2 (Technical):** Questions were mostly around the product work done at the candidate's previous organization.

Tata Digital

- **Role:** Product Management
 - **R1 (Product Design):** "What is your favourite product? Why? How is it different from rest?".
 - **R2 (Product Design, Behavioural):** "How would you design the next gen OTT app?". Questions on work culture, ethics, and values.
 - **R3 (Behavioural):** "Why Tata Digital?". "What other super apps are you aware of?".
- **Role:** Product Manager

- **R1 (Product Design, RCA, GTM/Market Entry, Guesstimate, Behavioural):** "Uber has seen a 40% dip in rider ratings. Ideate possible reasons why this has happened."
- **R2 (Product Design, Metrics, Technical, Behavioural):** "Choose an app/website that you use regularly and take me through the different pages from the mindset of a product manager".
- **General Feedback:** The candidate was advised to keep it conversational and engaging.

Ula

- **Role:** Associate Product Manager
 - **R1 (Product Design):** Case based: "Design an app for tracking delivery partners of Ula."

VMWare

- **Role:** EUC Product Manager
 - **R1 (Product Design, Metrics):** "Walk us through your resume.". "What is your favorite product and why?". "How would you improve <favourite product from Q2>?".
 - **R2 (Metrics, GTM/Market Entry, Guesstimate):** "Product Mini-Case question. You are a PM of a company who wants to create a product for households in India. How would you go about it?".

Walmart

- **Role:** Associate Product Manager
 - **R1 (Product Design):** "Design an app for 16-25 years age group in the investment banking space". "Why PM".
 - **R2 (Product Design, RCA):** "Design a smart refrigerator". "RCA question - Walmart sales for PS5 reduced after Christmas on the app. Why?".
 - **General Feedback:** "Recruiters were very knowledgeable, polite and guided throughout the process."
- **Role:** APM
 - **R1 (Product Design):** "How did you improve Sarovar?". "Why PM?".
 - **R2 (Product Design):** "Improve Google maps to monetize it and show wireframes."
 - **R3 (Behavioural):** "Asked about my past experience and why I wanted to do PM."
 - **General Feedback:** "They don't mind giving you a 2-3 mins break if you need it."

Zeta

- **Role:** Associate Product manager
 - **R1 (Product Design, RCA, GTM/Market Entry):** "RCA- The inactive accounts have increased for the OTT platform, why?".
 - **R2 (Product Design):** "Design Sunglasses for kids".

WinZo

- **Role:** Associate Product Manager
 - **R1 (Product Design, Growth, Metrics):** "Walk me through your case submission.". "Tell me about your favourite product, why do you like it?". "Suppose the CEO of Swiggy comes to you and asks that you have to grow the business by 50%, how would you go about it?".
 - **R2 (Behavioural):** "Can you tell me what was asked in the previous round so that we can talk about something else?".
 - **R3 (Behavioural):** "Tell me about yourself. Why do you want to be a product manager? Why do you want to join us?".

Zynga

- **Role:** Associate Product Manager
 - **R1 (RCA):** "Explain the submission.". "On the game ('Words with Friends 2') I picked for my ppt submission I was asked - 'Revenue has gone down, how would you arrive at the cause?'".
 - **R2 (Metrics):** "Was asked if I play any game. I said I have played 'Poker' online. Was asked to call/create a metric that would have a high correlation with the revenue?".
 - **R3 (Product Design):** "Was asked to increase usage of LinkedIn by 10x". "Create a subscription plan for a game (the benefits and the price of it)".
- **Role:** Associate Product Manager
 - **R1 (RCA):** "Revenue of a free to play game has been falling over a few weeks. What could be causing it?".
 - **R2 (Product Design, Metrics):** "Improve PUBG to increase retention".
 - **R3 (HR):** Generic HR questions.

2022 Interview Experiences

Accenture

- **Role:** Technology Consultant
 - **R1 (Metrics, Technical):** Questions about what data points a clothing retail store would collect and how to build a dashboard for a store manager.
 - **R2 (Technical):** "Walk me through the data processing journey in an Azure technology stack" and "Walk me through your past project".

- **R3 (Behavioural):** "What challenges did you face as a Project Manager in your project?", "How would your juniors describe you as a manager?", and "Why do you want to build a career in Tech domain?".
- **R4 (Behavioural):** CTC negotiations.
- **Overall Feedback:** Prior technology consulting, especially data consulting, is helpful.

Airtel

- **Role:** Product Strategy
 - **R1 (Behavioural):** Questions on the steps and phases of a managed project, approaches to product/service growth, and incorporating past learnings into future projects.
 - **Overall Feedback:** Be completely on top of your profile to ensure there are no gaps in your story.
- **Role:** Product Manager
 - **R1 (Product Design, Metrics, Technical, Behavioural):** "What is your favourite product and why?", "If you were the PM of your favourite product, what changes would you make", and "Why product management?".
 - **Overall Feedback:** Good research about the company and industry helps drive conversations, especially with CXO-level interviewers.
- **Role:** Product Manager
 - **R1 (Product Design, GTM/Market Entry, Guesstimate, Behavioural):** "Estimate the number of basketballs and basketball-shoes in India", "Design a Wynk app for tier 3/4 cities", and "What are the ways to monetize Wynk app?".
- **Role:** Product Manager
 - **R1 (Product Design, Metrics, Technical, Behavioural):** "How have you applied Product Management skills at the workplace so far?", "Approach with regards to the Microsoft PM Engage case competition mentioned on my resume", and "What are your weaknesses that can obstruct your performance as a Product Manager?".
 - **Overall Feedback:** Be prepared for behavioral questions and know how to answer them without sounding like you're throwing yourself under the bus.

Amazon

- **Role:** AFBP Program Manager
 - **R1 (Behavioural):** All questions revolved around Amazon's leadership principles.
 - **Overall Feedback:** Follow the STAR method and link your answers to the leadership principles. If the interview gets tough, it may be a bar-raiser, so stay calm and show customer empathy and stakeholder management skills.

Atlassian

- **Role:** Product Manager
 - **R1 (Product Design, Guesstimate):** Questions about a pre-submitted case solution, a guesstimate on flights from Delhi airport, and a favorite product question about Instagram.
 - **R2 (Behavioural):** "What interests you in PM?", "What was some time when you were criticized?", and "What was a time when you failed as a team?".
 - **R3 (Behavioural):** "Intro, Values of Atlassian and which one value will you pick?", "Did you criticize anyone and were you criticised by anyone?", and "As a team, give an instance when you failed".
 - **Overall Feedback:** The company checks for personality a lot, so focus on HR-based questions.
- **Role:** Product Manager
 - **R1 (Metrics, Technical):** Questions about a pre-submitted case study and "Suggest one new income stream using for Spotify (no ads, no Premium)".
 - **R2 (Metrics, Behavioural):** Questions on how to prioritize features and top tech trends.
 - **R3 (Behavioural):** "Share an instance when you helped someone in your organization and your learnings from this experience" and "Time when you had a disagreement with a co-worker".
 - **Overall Feedback:** Make sure you go through Atlassian's values before your interviews.

Brane Enterprises

- **Role:** Solution Leader
 - **R1 (Behavioural):** "Different resume & behaviour questions + Role Understanding".
 - **R2 (Product Design, Behavioural):** Resume-based questions and a question about modules of a home decoration app.
 - **R3 (Behavioural):** "General discussion on post-ISB goal".
 - **Overall Feedback:** The role is end-to-end, so be prepared to take on many different responsibilities.

BrowserStack

- **Role:** Associate Product Manager
 - **R1 (Product Design, Metrics):** Questions on a pre-submitted case study and a non-conventional metrics question for a Notes app.
 - **R2 (Product Design, RCA, Metrics, Technical):** A full walkthrough of the case submission, with a special focus on metrics.
 - **R3 (Behavioural):** Behavioral questions with the head of product, such as "how do you handle internal conflicts within the engineering and product teams".

- **Overall Feedback:** It helps to understand their product end-to-end because they are a technical product company and are not looking for template answers.

Cisco

- **Role:** Product Manager
 - **R1 (Product Design, Behavioural):** "Tell us about yourself? Why do you want to be a product manager?", and "What is one app you don't like and how would you improve it?".
 - **R2 (Product Strategy):** "If your cousin asks you for laptop advice? Which brand would you suggest?".
 - **R3 (Behavioural):** "Tell me about yourself? What are your expectations?" and "Do you know who the competitors of Cisco are?".
 - **Overall Feedback:** The process was smooth, and the panelists were accommodating.
- **Role:** Product Manager
 - **R1 (Guesstimate):** "Estimate the revenue of Google Ads on Gmail" and "Estimate the Number of Ola rides taken in India".
 - **R2 (Product Design):** The interviewer selected a project from the candidate's resume and asked how to make it work offline. The candidate also had to explain a pre-submitted market entry case.
 - **Overall Feedback:** The interview process was held 10 days before day 0.

Dream11

- **Role:** Senior Product Manager
 - **R1 (Product Design):** "How will you monetise Fantasy Premiere League?".
 - **R2 (Product Design):** "How will you increase engagement amongst players during international breaks in football in Fantasy premiere league or Dream11?".
 - **R3 (Behavioural):** "As a PM, will you go for product led growth always?" and "Do you follow the do it right first-time approach or fail fast approach?".
 - **Overall Feedback:** Having some perspective on fantasy sports and competitors is helpful.
- **Role:** Manager - Product
 - **R1 (Product Design):** "Build an Influencer Program for Dream11".
 - **R2 (Metrics, GTM/Market Entry, Behavioural):** "SaaS start-up wants to enter the Communication & Engagement industry, how can it succeed here?".
 - **R3 (Behavioural):** "Why PM? What culture do you like? Conflict example? Failure Example?".
 - **Overall Feedback:** Make sure you actually have experience with the app, it's important to them.
- **Role:** PM

- **R1 (Product Design, Metrics, GTM/Market Entry):** "How would you solve the problem of ordering from multiple places at once on Swiggy?", "How would you track the success of this feature?", and "How would you release this feature?".
- **R2 (RCA, Behavioural):** "Cart abandonment for Myntra has gone up recently. Find out why?" and "If you ship 2 features at the same time to impact the same metric, how would you measure which one is more successful?".
- **R3 (Behavioural):** Questions on the biggest challenge faced, the meaning of product management, and why Dream11.
- **Overall Feedback:** The candidate advised staying calmer and being as structured as possible.

Epifi (fi.money)

● Role: Product Manager

- **R1 (Product Design):** Discussion on a pre-submitted case solution and redesigning the Netflix Android App homepage.
- **R2 (Product Design):** "Design a bill payment feature for Epifi".
- **R3 (Product Design, RCA, Metrics, GTM/Market Entry, Guesstimate, Technical):** A stress round with the product head covering a wide range of questions. The candidate was asked to define a "happiness index" for readers of a digital publication.
- **R4 (Technical):** "Design a Pokémon Go type game and define its architecture".
- **R5 (Product Design, Behavioural):** "Design a dynamic traffic light" and behavioral questions based on the candidate's resume.
- **Overall Feedback:** The interviews were fairly technical and focused on product design. Behavioral questions were asked in almost every round.

● Role: Product Manager

- **R1 (Guesstimate):** "Estimate the ad revenue for Facebook in India".
- **R2 (Product Design):** "Do a critique of Google Pay and suggest some improvements to the app".
- **R3 (Product Design, RCA, Metrics, Behavioural, Technical):** A stress interview with one of the co-founders. The candidate was asked to list metrics for a "happiness index" for readers of a digital publication and an RCA on dropping readership numbers.
- **R4 (Technical):** A purely technical round with the Head of Engineering. The candidate was asked to design the technical architecture for the Pokémon Go game.
- **R5 (Product Design, Behavioural, Fitment):** A short cultural fitment round with a co-founder.
- **Overall Feedback:** Be very well prepared for boilerplate questions for stress rounds.

Flipkart

- **Role:** PM-1
 - **R1 (RCA):** An RCA question related to a case submission. "We implemented feature X and saw great adoption in the first 3 months. However, engagement has gone in the past 2 weeks. Think of reasons why".
 - **R2 (Product Design, Metrics):** Questions on top metrics for Instagram Live, how to increase paid users for Spotify in India, and a favorite product question.
 - **R3 (Technical, Behavioural):** General questions on why the candidate joined ISB, what they learned, and challenges with engineering teams.
 - **Overall Feedback:** Try to be as conversational as possible. The interviewers were calm and guided the candidate when needed.
- **Role:** PM-1
 - **R1 (Case submission based):** Questions about a pre-submitted case study and past work experience.
 - **R2 (Product Design, Metrics):** "How would you improve the Facebook experience for dating?". The round ended with a rapid-fire of North Star metrics questions for products like Insta Live and Spotify Premium.
 - **R3 (Guesstimate, Behavioural):** "Estimate the number of tubelights in Delhi".
 - **Overall Feedback:** Be very well versed in the company's current offerings.

Games 24x7

- **Role:** Product Manager
 - **R1 (Product Design):** "Favourite Product" and "Improvements to favorite product".
 - **R2 (RCA, Behavioural):** Resume-based questions and a hypothetical case about a metric falling in an auto-insurance company.
 - **R3 (HR):** A brief HR round.
 - **Overall Feedback:** An understanding of metrics and a clear analytical mind were very important.
- **Role:** Product Manager
 - **R1 (Product Design, GTM/Market Entry):** A question about a GTM strategy and product design for "Uber for buses".
 - **R2 (Technical):** "Design a gaming app for chess".
 - **R3 (Behavioural):** Standard behavioral questions.
 - **Overall Feedback:** The candidate was advised that gaming knowledge is not required, but a good understanding of games helps.

Google

- **Role:** Product Manager

- **R1 (Product Design):** "How would you design the restaurant search experience on Google in the Covid era?".
- **R2 (RCA, Metrics, GTM/Market Entry):** "Define the key metrics for Gmail mobile app", an RCA on a 5% dip in Gmail app DAU, and a guesstimate on the number of flights taking off in India.
- **R3 (Product Design):** "How would you re-design the college dorm laundry experience".
- **R4 (Product Strategy):** "Should Google get into the e-learning business?" and a question about magical boots that make a person run as fast as Usain Bolt.
- **Overall Feedback:** It was a long but intensive process, and the candidate advised that you will thoroughly enjoy the interview regardless of the outcome.

GSN Games

- **Role:** Product Manager
 - **R1 (RCA, Metrics):** "You are the PM for Ludo, there is a sudden dip in the number of users, find out why". The candidate also had to define metrics for the game.
 - **R2 (Product Design, RCA):** "You are the PM at Ludo. There is a sudden drop in the number of chips bought by the users. Find why" and "Design a game for women belonging to your mother's generation".
 - **R3 (Behavioural):** "Why Product Management", "Why the gaming industry", and "why GSN games".
 - **Overall Feedback:** Gaming knowledge is not required, but being honest about your involvement helps.

Jio

- **Role:** Product Manager
 - **R1 (GTM/Market Entry, Technical, Behavioural):** "Tell me about yourself" with a deep dive into technical projects and questions on an app improvement. The candidate was also asked the difference between HTTP and HTTPS.
 - **Overall Feedback:** It's important to get clarity on the role with the actual interviewer, as it may be different from a typical PM role.
- **Role:** Product Manager
 - **R1 (Product Design, Behavioural):** "Tell me about yourself" and "What is your favourite app and why?". The candidate was asked to describe the product design stages and allocate timelines.
 - **R2 (Behavioural):** A general behavioral round.
 - **Overall Feedback:** The candidate did minimal prep but succeeded by using the frameworks from the BTC handbook.
- **Role:** Product Manager

- **R1 (Technical):** "Suggest improvements for a video sharing app" and questions on work experience.
- **R2 (Behavioural):** "What are your strengths and weaknesses?" and a location preference question.
- **Role:** Product Manager
 - **R1 (Product Design, GTM/Market Entry):** "Design an MVP for your start-up now".
 - **R2 (Behavioural):** "How would your friends describe you?" and "Why Reliance Jio?".
 - **Overall Feedback:** The company focuses on understanding the entire PM role, from ideation to launch.

Meesho

- **Role:** Product Manager
 - **R1 (RCA):** "You are the PM at LinkedIn. The DAU have dropped. Please find the reason and resolve".
- **Role:** Product Manager
 - **R1 (Product Design):** "Flipkart is launching a new ecommerce app focused on Tier 2/3 cities and on new e-commerce users. Think about the User Journey of such a user and take me through the major components you would need in the app".
 - **R2 (Behavioural):** A culture-fit round with questions on past experiences, why PM, and why the candidate would be a good fit.
 - **Overall Feedback:** The process focused on empathizing with the user, rather than on product design questions.

Microsoft

- **Role:** Program Manager
 - **R1 (Product Design):** "Discuss your favorite product. Suggest an improvement on favorite product to achieve user growth".
 - **R2 (Product Design):** "Design a search engine for enterprise users".
 - **R3 (Product Design):** "Microsoft has a lot of data on users' likes and disliked, their contacts and daily schedules. Using this data and AI technology, design a product".
 - **Overall Feedback:** The interviewers are very helpful, and the candidate advised listening to their counterarguments patiently.
- **Role:** PM
 - **R1 (Product Design, Technical):** A live case on designing a travel platform for Microsoft during the pandemic. The candidate was also asked about their projects as a developer.

- **R2 (Product Design, Technical):** "How would you deal with fake reviews on Amazon?". The candidate was also asked to design a platform for learning musical instruments.
- **R3 (Product Design, Behavioural):** "Design a browsing experience for offline users" and questions about work experience and why the candidate wanted to become a PM.
- **Overall Feedback:** The candidate was advised to keep the interviews conversational and to not lie or try too hard to impress the interviewers, as they are industry experts.
- **Role:** PM
 - **R1 (Product Design, Technical):** A live case on designing a general-purpose monitoring service for a web application.
 - **R2 (Product Design, Technical):** "Microsoft wants to fuel 10x growth for MS Teams for consumers ... how would you approach the problem?".
 - **R3 (Product Design, Behavioural):** A design question on how to use usage data across all MS products to improve user experience.
 - **Overall Feedback:** The candidate noted that Microsoft interviews are generally taken by experienced PMs and advised to keep the conversation flowing and keep faffing to a minimum.

MPS

- **Role:** Product Manager
 - **R1 (Product Design, Behavioural):** "Tell me about Yourself" and "As you have worked as PM before, describe all the activities that you were part of right from ideation stage to delivery stage". The candidate was also asked to design a product to help an academic publisher.
 - **Overall Feedback:** The candidate reflected that they may not have made it because they couldn't come up with the right pain points for a librarian.

Myntra

- **Role:** Product Manager
 - **R1 (Product Design):** "Improve Google Maps".
 - **R2 (Technical, Behavioural):** Questions about past work experience, situational questions, and modules in Swiggy.
 - **R3 (Metrics, Guesstimate):** "How to set threshold value for orders below which delivery charge will be done for Myntra?".
 - **R4 (Behavioural):** An HR round with behavioral and situational questions.
- **Role:** Product Manager
 - **R1 (Product Design, Behavioural):** "Tell me about yourself" and a design question for old people.

- **R2 (Guesstimate, Product Design, Technical):** "Find the area of parking lot of an international airport for example Delhi Airport". The candidate was also asked how to explain an app's functionality to an engineering team.
- **R3 (Behavioural):** A leadership round with questions on what's not on the CV and handling difficult situations.
- **Overall Feedback:** The candidate advised to converse with the interviewer as the process was smooth.

Navi

- **Role:** Product Manager
 - **R1 (Product Design):** The candidate, a badminton player, was asked to design an app to improve the experience of professional badminton players.
 - **R2 (Product Design):** "You are PM at Navi, launch our credit card product".
 - **R3 (Behavioural):** General behavioral questions.
- **Role:** Associate Product Manager
 - **R1 (GTM/Market Entry):** "You have to start a pizza business in Bangalore and scale it up to be the biggest in 3 years".
 - **R2 (Product Design):** "Design an MVP for EMI payment on the Navi insurance app that has to be launched in 15 days".
 - **R3 (Behavioural):** HR interview with standard behavioral questions.
 - **Overall Feedback:** They are looking at your ability to think on the spot and be clear.

Nium

- **Role:** Product Manager
 - **R1 (Product Design, Technical):** The interviewer explained the B2B Nium product and asked for product improvements and AI application opportunities.
 - **R2 (Behavioural):** The candidate was asked if they were a "hacker or a builder" and what they would do if their jokes didn't land.
 - **Overall Feedback:** The interview felt more like a general tech discussion, and the behavioral questions were not from the usual template.
- **Role:** Product Manager
 - **R1 (Situational, Go To Market, Product Strategy, Root Cause Analysis):** "Should Nium get into the insurance industry in India?" and an RCA on decreased transactions.
 - **R2 (Product Strategy):** "How should Nium venture into Crypto?".
 - **R3 (Behavioural):** "Why Nium?" and questions for the interviewer.

Nykaa

- **Role:** Product Manager
 - **R1 (Product Design, Guesstimate):** "Improve Instagram" and a guesstimate on the number of reels posted daily in India.

- **R2 (Product Design, Metrics):** "Improve Nykaa for Tier 2 cities" and "How does YouTube earn money?".
- **R3 (Product Design, GTM/Market Entry):** Behavioral questions and "Design OYO for business".

OLX

- **Role:** Product Manager
 - **R1 (Product Design, GTM/Market Entry):** "You are the CEO of an insurance company. You have seen sudden surge in the number of claims. How will you take a decision whether to continue this business or not?" and "Design a product for blue collar work force".
 - **Overall Feedback:** The candidate was advised to keep an open mind and not just follow a framework, as a practical and raw approach could help them stand out.
- **Role:** APM
 - **R1 (Product Design, GTM/Market Entry):** "Which is your favourite product and why?" and "Should Netflix enter the personal video uploads market?".
- **Role:** Associate Product Manager
 - **R1 (RCA):** "Flipkart has faced a drop of 30% in the sales of its electronics category in the last month. What would you do as the product manager?".
 - **R2 (Product Design, Behavioural):** "What design changes can be made to increase the attachment rate of add-on services like warranty to the products?" and "Why Product management?".
 - **Overall Feedback:** The candidate was advised not to stick to frameworks and to be practical and honest.

Oyo

- **Role:** Product Manager
 - **R1 (Product Design, Behavioural):** A thorough discussion of previous work experience and a design question on how to increase OYO app revenue via pop-ups. The candidate was also asked about a loyalty program for Amazon Prime.

Paytm

- **Role:** Product Manager
 - **R1 (Product Design, Behavioural):** "Since you're interested in football, design an app for football" and a puzzle question.
 - **R2 (Product Design, Behavioural):** "What is your favourite product and is there any improvement with it?" and "Why Paytm?".
 - **Overall Feedback:** The candidate advised preparing well about the company and brushing up on the fundamentals of Product Management.
- **Role:** Product Manager

- **R1 (Product Design, Technical):** "Design an app to take banking to doorstep" and a technical question on creating a fraud-proof vulnerability detection algorithm.
- **R2 (Product Design):** "Favourite product" (Google maps) and "How can u improve google maps?".

PhonePe

- **Role:** APM
 - **R1 (Product Design, GTM/Market Entry):** "You are PM at Gmail. Strategize a 1-year roadmap that Gmail should follow?".
 - **R2 (Metrics, Technical, Behavioural):** A deep dive into a project on the candidate's resume, focusing on metrics and how they were tracked.
 - **Overall Feedback:** PhonePe's process was very simple and well managed. The case study was open-ended and they focused on the approach rather than the exact solution.
- **Role:** APM
 - **R1 (Product Design):** "How will you increase revenue from transactions from the merchant's side (Swiggy types) as PhonePe's payment gateway?" and "How will you improve google maps? Both engagement and monetisation".
 - **R2 (Metrics):** "What would be the key metrics for Swiggy?" and "How will you improve engagement metrics for Swiggy?".
 - **Overall Feedback:** The candidate was advised that it's important to explain why you are saying what you are saying and that the company did not expect fintech knowledge but rather assessed product thinking.

Providence

- **Role:** Program manager (Product manager)
 - **R1 (Product Design, Behavioural):** A basic intro and questions around project and program management, with a special focus on risk management. The candidate was also asked to design a cybersecurity plan.
 - **R2 (Product Design, Behavioural):** "How would you eliminate the need for patients to carry files between hospitals?". The candidate was also asked about team leadership and behavioral skills.
 - **R3 (Behavioural):** An HR interview with basic questions.
 - **Overall Feedback:** Interviewers tried to make the candidate feel comfortable and were checking for a general thought process.

Razorpay

- **Role:** Product Strategy
 - **R1 (Product Design, GTM/Market Entry):** "Nykaa wants to enter the Buy now Pay Later Segment. What considerations would you take?".

- **R2 (Product Design, GTM/Market Entry):** "We have a network of 1000 tailors in Bangalore, who have some free time. Using this network, what business can you build?".
- **R3 (RCA):** "If the defaults increase in a banking app, what factors would you consider?".
- **Role:** Product Manager
 - **R1 (Product Design, GTM/Market Entry):** "PM at WhatsApp. Planning for integration with Spotify. Good decision or not? How would you go about it?".
 - **R2 (Product Design, RCA):** "PM at Uber. Reduce Driver cancellations".
 - **R3 (GTM/Market Entry):** "GTM for Neemans shoe company to different geographies".
 - **Overall Feedback:** The candidate was advised that Razorpay interviews were more about the business aspect and to be thorough with consulting frameworks.

Rupeek

- **Role:** Product Manager
 - **R1 (Product Design, GTM/Market Entry, Behavioural):** The candidate was asked to explain their case submission and devise a monetization plan for "Finshots".
 - **R2 (Behavioural):** An HR round.
 - **Overall Feedback:** The case study was important, and the interviewer asked the candidate to defend the entire case study.
- **Role:** Product Manager
 - **R1 (Guesstimate, GTM/Market Entry):** "How many Swiggy delivery partners are present in Bangalore?" and "How will you launch Zomato at a tier-2 city?".
 - **Overall Feedback:** It was a very smooth and productive discussion.

ShareChat

- **Role:** Product Manager
 - **R1 (Product Design):** "Create a product to improve the health of your users", "Design a fitness channel product addition for Netflix", and "Design a product for Facebook Travel".
 - **Overall Feedback:** The process was "Absolutely smooth. No overlaps, in-depth interviews, detailed feedback".

Swiggy

- **Role:** Associate Product Manager
 - **R1 (RCA, Metrics, GTM/Market Entry, Behavioural):** "Platform traffic on Swiggy has dropped suddenly and significantly last week. Do RCA" and "How to improve Swiggy".
 - **Overall Feedback:** Be very thorough with company research.

- **Role:** Associate Product Manager
 - **R1 (Product Design, Guesstimate):** "Guesstimate the market size for an EV-expert battery manufacturing company entering India" and "How can we measure/change the discount perception on Instamart?".
 - **R2 (Technical):** Questions were mostly around the product work done at the candidate's previous organization.

Tata Digital

- **Role:** Product Management
 - **R1 (Product Design):** "What is your favourite product? Why? How is it different from rest?".
 - **R2 (Product Design, Behavioural):** "How would you design the next gen OTT app?" and questions on work culture, ethics, and values.
 - **R3 (Behavioural):** "Why Tata Digital?" and "What other super apps are you aware of?".
- **Role:** Product Manager
 - **R1 (Product Design, RCA, GTM/Market Entry, Guesstimate, Behavioural):** "Uber has seen a 40% dip in rider ratings. Ideate possible reasons why this has happened".
 - **R2 (Product Design, Metrics, Technical, Behavioural):** "Choose an app/website that you use regularly and take me through the different pages from the mindset of a product manager".
 - **Overall Feedback:** The candidate was advised to keep it conversational and engaging with the interviewer.

Ula

- **Role:** Associate Product Manager
 - **R1 (Product Design):** Case based: "Design an app for tracking delivery partners of Ula".

VMWare

- **Role:** EUC Product Manager
 - **R1 (Product Design, Metrics):** "Walk us through your resume.", "What is your favorite product and why?", and "How would you improve <favourite product from Q2>?".
 - **R2 (Metrics, GTM/Market Entry, Guesstimate):** "Product Mini-Case question. You are a PM of a company who wants to create a product for households in India. How would you go about it?".

Walmart

- **Role:** Associate Product Manager

- **R1 (Product Design):** "Design an app for 16-25 years age group in the investment banking space" and "Why PM".
- **R2 (Product Design, RCA):** "Design a smart refrigerator" and an RCA question on why Walmart's PS5 sales had reduced after Christmas.
- **Overall Feedback:** The recruiters were knowledgeable and guided the candidate through the process.
- **Role:** APM
 - **R1 (Product Design):** "How did you improve Sarovar?" and "Why PM?".
 - **R2 (Product Design):** "Improve Google maps to monetize it and show wireframes".
 - **R3 (Behavioural):** Questions about past experience and why the candidate wanted to do PM.
 - **Overall Feedback:** The interviewers were supportive but the interviews were stressful, so the key was to take a step back and relax.

Zeta

- **Role:** Associate Product manager
 - **R1 (Product Design, RCA, GTM/Market Entry):** RCA: "The inactive accounts have increased for the OTT platform, why?".
 - **R2 (Product Design):** "Design Sunglasses for kids".

WinZo

- **Role:** Associate Product Manager
 - **R1 (Product Design, Growth, Metrics):** "Walk me through your case submission." and "Suppose the CEO of Swiggy comes to you and asks that you have to grow the business by 50%, how would you go about it?".
 - **R2 (Behavioural):** The interviewer asked what was asked in the previous round so they could talk about something else.
 - **R3 (Behavioural):** "Tell me about yourself. Why do you want to be a product manager? Why do you want to join us?".

Zynga

- **Role:** Associate Product Manager
 - **R1 (RCA):** Questions on a case submission and an RCA on revenue going down for a game.
 - **R2 (Metrics):** The candidate was asked to create a metric with a high correlation to revenue for the game "Poker". The round also included a puzzle.
 - **R3 (Product Design):** The candidate was asked to increase LinkedIn usage by 10x and create a subscription plan for a game.

- **Overall Feedback:** The candidate was advised that it does not matter if they get the right answer, as long as they have a structured way to solve problems and can communicate it effectively.
- **Role:** Associate Product Manager
 - **R1 (RCA):** "Revenue of a free to play game has been falling over a few weeks. What could be causing it?".
 - **R2 (Product Design, Metrics):** "Improve PUBG to increase retention".
 - **R3 (HR):** Generic HR questions.
 - **Overall Feedback:** Sharing the screen of a drawing tablet helped the candidate, as they could draw out problem trees and dashboards.

QUESTION BANK

The following are sample questions you can practice in groups. Brainstorm ideas, approaches, and frameworks with your peers.

1. PRODUCT DESIGN

B2C

a. Consumer Software

1. Design a product that helps gig workers manage their personal finance.
2. Design a digital product for people who regularly commute between two cities for work. Focus on one high-frequency problem rather than attempting to solve the entire commuting journey.
3. Design a product that helps consumers make better decisions when purchasing refurbished electronics.
4. Design a hyperlocal news app for rural India.
5. Design a product that helps users reduce unnecessary online shopping. Assume the business still wants users to remain engaged with the platform.
6. Design a digital experience for attending a large live event such as a concert or sporting event.
7. Design a product that helps elderly users independently manage routine digital tasks such as payments, bookings, and appointments.
8. Design a product for households that want to reduce their electricity consumption without significantly changing their lifestyle. Identify the highest-value intervention and explain the behavioural challenge you are solving.

b. Physical Products/IoT

9. Design an intelligent shoe for visually impaired users.

B2B

10. Design a product that helps small retailers understand which products are likely to run out of stock in the coming week.
11. Design a product that helps sales representatives prepare for their customer meetings. Decide which part of the sales workflow you would solve first.
12. Design a product for independent restaurants to manage their supplier orders.
13. Design a product for independent healthcare clinics to reduce the administrative work involved in managing appointments and follow-ups.
14. Design an AI copilot for procurement teams that helps them evaluate supplier proposals. Explain what decisions the AI should assist with and where human approval should remain mandatory.

15. A logistics company wants to give its enterprise customers greater visibility into shipment disruptions. Design the product.
16. Design a platform that enables construction companies to coordinate multiple subcontractors working on the same project.

2. PRODUCT IMPROVEMENT

B2C

a. Feature Enhancement

17. Improve the experience of saving and organizing articles, videos, and posts that users discover online. Assume users frequently save content but rarely return to it.
18. A grocery delivery app has strong order frequency but users increasingly complain that they cannot find what they want. How would you improve the discovery experience?
19. Improve a travel-booking platform for users who are still exploring destinations and have not decided where they want to travel.

b. UX/Accessibility

20. Improve the experience of buying tickets for popular events where inventory sells out quickly.

c. Performance Adoption

21. A short-form video platform wants to increase meaningful engagement without increasing average screen time. How would you rethink the product?
22. An online learning product has strong course completion rates but very low conversion from learning to real-world application. How would you improve the product?
23. Improve an AI-powered consumer assistant whose usage is high initially but falls sharply after the first few weeks. Identify why this might happen and what you would change.

B2B

24. Improve an expense-management platform where employees submit expenses regularly but finance teams still spend significant time correcting submissions.
25. A B2B analytics platform has excellent functionality but new customers take three months to become productive. How would you improve the onboarding experience?
26. Improve a project-management product used by consulting teams where senior leaders want visibility but consultants complain about excessive reporting requirements.

3. PRODUCT STRATEGY

B2C

a. Market Entry

27. A digital payments app has a large base of monthly active users, but its core payments business is becoming increasingly commoditized. The company can either deepen its existing financial-services offerings or enter a new consumer category. How would you decide which direction to pursue?
28. A food marketplace wants to expand from meals into other daily-use categories. Which category would you enter first and why?

b. Monetization

29. A music-streaming platform has grown rapidly through a free, ad-supported tier. However, advertising revenue per user is low, while the paid subscription base has started to plateau. As the PM, how would you rethink the product's monetization strategy?

c. Growth/Retention

30. A popular grocery delivery platform has strong customer retention but users typically place only a few orders each month. As the PM, how would you develop a strategy to increase the frequency of usage?
31. A social platform is popular among young users but struggles to retain users once they enter the workforce. Develop a strategy to address the problem.
32. A consumer marketplace is losing its most valuable users to specialized vertical platforms. Develop a strategy to defend the core business without simply matching every competitor feature-for-feature.

d. Portfolio/Vertical Integration

33. A large e-commerce company is considering whether to build more of its own private-label products. Develop a product strategy for making this decision.

B2B

34. A B2B software company wants to move from serving startups to serving larger enterprises. What changes would you expect across the product, organization, and business model?
35. A B2B platform has strong adoption among individual employees but weak organizational adoption. Develop a strategy to convert bottom-up usage into broader enterprise penetration.
36. A vertical SaaS company serving restaurants wants to enter a second industry. Develop a framework for selecting the next vertical and make a recommendation.
37. A B2B marketplace wants to expand from transaction facilitation into financial services for its business customers. Evaluate the strategic opportunity and risks.

38. An enterprise software company has high revenue concentration: its top 20 customers generate 60% of revenue. Develop a product strategy to reduce concentration without damaging relationships with the largest customers.

4. GO-TO-MARKET (GTM)

B2C

a. Launch & Distribution

39. A digital health product wants to launch a paid preventive-health subscription. How would you build awareness and overcome consumer reluctance to pay for a benefit they may not immediately experience?
40. Launch LinkedIn's creator monetization program in Asia, enabling creators to earn income from their professional content and audience. Develop a GTM strategy for launching the program across the region.

b. Market Entry

41. A resale marketplace is entering a new city. Develop a launch plan that addresses both buyer demand and seller supply.
42. A new mobility service is launching in a city where incumbent players already have strong driver and customer networks. Develop a market-entry GTM strategy.

c. Customer Acquisition / Adoption

43. A consumer app has launched a feature that automatically summarizes users' monthly spending. Develop a launch strategy to drive adoption among existing users.

B2B

44. A SaaS company is launching a workflow automation product for mid-sized businesses. Develop the initial GTM strategy.
45. A B2B analytics product is being launched to operations teams in manufacturing companies. How would you identify the first customer segment and build the initial pipeline?
46. An enterprise software company is launching an AI feature for existing customers. Customers are interested but hesitant to allow sensitive company data to be used. Develop the GTM strategy.
47. An enterprise AI product has passed its pilot stage, but most pilot customers have not moved to full deployment. Diagnose the GTM problem and design a strategy to convert pilots into scaled deployments.
48. How will you position Microsoft Teams against Slack for startups?

5. METRICS

B2C

a. Defining Success

1. Metrics for YouTube Shorts. Pick a single north star and state what would have to be true for it to be the right one.
2. Metrics for Google Photos "Memories", a feature users never go looking for. How do you measure success for something passive?
3. Metrics for Ola's 2-wheeler rides. Two sides of a marketplace: whose metrics matter more in year one, and why? (*two-sided: riders + drivers*)
4. Metrics for Zomato's 10-minute delivery, customers, restaurants, and riders all have a stake. Build the tree for all three. (*three-sided; restaurant leg is B2B*)

b. Guardrails & Counter-Metrics

1. Flipkart BNPL adoption is growing 20% month over month. What would you watch to be sure you aren't building a default problem?
2. Shorts watch time is up 40%. What would tell you it's cannibalising long-form rather than adding to it?
3. Swiggy Instamart order volume is up, driven by discounts. Which metrics tell you whether this is growth or purchased volume?
4. Instagram is optimising for teen session length. What are the non-negotiable guardrails, and where would you cap the primary metric?
5. Dream11 engagement is climbing outside IPL season. Which counter-metrics would make you slow down rather than celebrate?

c. Trade-offs & Judgment

1. Spotify: DAU is up 8%, listening hours per user are down 6%. Good or bad? What would settle it?
2. Your team proposes "time spent" as LinkedIn's north star. Argue against it, then propose better.
3. You're launching Myntra virtual try-on next month. What's a good adoption number at day 90?
4. Netflix must choose between "completion rate" and "hours watched" for greenlighting decisions. Which would you pick and why?

d. Measurement Design

1. Myntra virtual try-on users convert 3x better than non-users. Does try-on cause the purchase, or do high-intent buyers just try more things on?
2. Cult's AI workouts succeed if users are fitter in six months, but you need to report next month. What proxies do you use, and how do you validate them?
3. WhatsApp ships a file-sharing improvement, but the product is end-to-end encrypted and you can't see content. What can you measure?

B2B

a. Defining Success

1. Metrics for Razorpay's payment gateway, where success looks like merchants never thinking about you. How do you measure a product whose best outcome is invisibility?
2. Metrics for Slack in year one of a 10,000-seat enterprise rollout. Seats activated, or depth of use? Pick one to be judged on.
3. Metrics for LinkedIn Recruiter, the customer pays, but the supply (candidates) doesn't. Whose experience do you put in the tree, and where?
4. Metrics for a developer API like Twilio, where your success only shows up inside someone else's product and you can't see the end user.
5. Metrics for Zomato's restaurant partner dashboard, a tool partners are obliged to use, not one they chose. What does "engagement" even mean here?

b. Guardrails & Counter-Metrics

1. Freshworks self-serve signups are up 30%. What would tell you you're filling the funnel with accounts that will never convert or will churn in 90 days?
2. An enterprise AI copilot shows a rising suggestion-acceptance rate. What tells you you're measuring value rather than compliance with a mandate?
3. Sales is hitting bookings targets three quarters running. Which counter-metrics would reveal that bookings are being pulled forward with discounts and short contracts?

c. Trade-offs & Judgment

1. Search relevance and ads revenue pull in opposite directions on the same result page. How do you set up metrics so one team can't win at the other's expense? (*two-sided: consumer surface, advertiser revenue*)
2. Your free tier is generous enough to be the reason people love you and the reason they never pay. Where do you set the line, and which metric tells you it moved too far?
3. Your top 5 accounts (60% of ARR) want a feature nobody else has asked for. What metric would justify building it, and what would justify refusing?

d. Measurement Design

1. Google Workspace free→paid: the journey is multi-touch and runs for months. How do you attribute a conversion?
2. Paytm rolls out a pricing change to all merchants at once, no holdout, no A/B. How do you know if it worked?
3. You have 40 enterprise customers in total. A/B testing is statistically hopeless. How do you evaluate a major new feature before committing the roadmap?
4. A large customer runs your software in their own Private Cloud with telemetry disabled. How do you measure adoption when you can't instrument anything?

6. ROOT CAUSE ANALYSIS

B2C

a. Sudden Drops

1. Instagram Stories views dropped 15% week over week, globally, with no release in that window.
2. Paytm UPI payment completion fell 10% over three days, concentrated in one bank's customers.
3. Myntra checkout completion dropped 7% overnight on Android only.
4. Ola sessions per user fell 25% in two weeks, in Bangalore, nowhere else.
5. LinkedIn post engagement fell 20% the week after a ranking model update. Was it the model?

b. Slow Decline

1. Netflix daily watch time per user has fallen roughly 1% a month for six months.
2. Zomato homepage visits are down 10% over two quarters while orders are flat.
3. Spotify premium churn has crept from 4.0% to 5.1% over a year.
4. Amazon Prime renewals in Tier 2 cities have declined for three consecutive quarters.

c. Unexpected Increases

1. Swiggy Instamart order volume jumped 30% in a week with no campaign running.
2. Dream11 DAU doubled during a non-IPL month.
3. Zomato Gold signups spiked 40% the day after a checkout UI change. Is it real?

d. Divergence & Non-Events

1. Flipkart festive sale: orders up 12% YoY, revenue down 8%. How?
2. Uber Eats confirmation rate is flat overall, but it declined in every single city. Explain. (*Simpson's Paradox*)
3. Swiggy Instamart basket value is down 8% while order frequency is up 15%. Is this a problem?
4. Zomato Gold subscriptions fell 12% but subscription revenue rose 5%.

B2B

a. Sudden Drops

1. Weekly active seats at your largest account dropped 20% in two weeks, with no product change. The contract renews in 60 days.
2. Errors from customer integrations on your API tripled overnight. Your own error rate and uptime are unchanged.
3. Swiggy restaurant partner app logins fell 15% in a week, while order volume stayed flat.

4. Trial-to-demo-booked rate halved after a pricing page update, but traffic and signups are unchanged.

b. Slow Decline

1. Applications per job posting on LinkedIn have drifted down 18% over a year. (*two-sided: the metric is recruiter value, the input is consumer behaviour*)
2. Net revenue retention has slid from 118% to 104% over four quarters, while gross churn is flat.
3. Meesho supplier 6-month retention has fallen steadily for three quarters, even as new supplier signups grow.
4. Seats per account in your SMB tier have shrunk ~2% a quarter for six quarters. Logo count is up.
5. The share of developers who reach a first successful API call within 24 hours has drifted down 15% over a year. Docs haven't changed.
6. Advertising spend per seller on Amazon Seller Central has declined for three consecutive quarters in one category.

c. Unexpected Increases

1. Google Ads CTR rose 25% in one advertiser category. Is this quality or is it a bug?
2. WhatsApp Business message volume tripled in a single market in one month.
3. Support tickets from your mid-market segment tripled the month after you *simplified* the admin UI.
4. Free-tier API usage from one region is up 5x. Is this genuine adoption, abuse, or someone reselling you?
5. The average enterprise deal cycle shortened by 30% last quarter. Is that a sales improvement or a shift in who's buying?
6. Razorpay merchant signups doubled in a month with no marketing spend and no new integration partner.

d. Divergence & Non-Events

1. ARR grew 15% while gross margin fell 6 points. Where did the money go?
2. Churn improved in every single customer segment, but overall churn got worse. Explain. (*Simpson's Paradox, inverse of the Uber Eats case in 6-B2C*)
3. Seats sold are up 20%; weekly active usage is dead flat. Which is the lie?
4. Pipeline is up 40% and closed-won is flat. Marketing and sales each blame the other. How do you settle it with data?
5. CSAT is at an all-time high and renewals are falling. How is that possible?

7. PRICING & MONETIZATION

B2C

a. Pricing & Packaging

1. Price Amazon Prime for rural India, where the delivery-speed benefit is worth less than in metros.
2. Price Netflix's ad-supported plan in India without cannibalising the standard tier. What's the fence between them?
3. Price Hotstar's sports-only subscription when IPL drives most of the value but occupies two months of the year.

b. Price Changes & Migration

1. Spotify wants to raise India prices 20%. Sequence it, and decide what happens to existing subscribers.
2. Zomato Gold is materially underpriced. How would you raise it without triggering a churn spike?
3. Swiggy Instamart wants to introduce a delivery fee on a service that has always been free. How should they do it?

c. Business Model & Pricing Metric

1. Canva premium templates: a la carte, bundle, or a new tier? Each implies a different business. (*prosumer, tips B2B if you frame it as Canva Teams*)

d. Revenue Levers & Expansion

1. Cross-sell insurance on Ola rides without hurting booking conversion. Where in the flow, and what's the stop rule?

B2B

a. Pricing & Packaging

1. Set subscription tiers for a B2B SaaS analytics platform. What feature separates tier 2 from tier 3, and why that one?
2. You have no comparable product to anchor to. Design the research to establish willingness to pay for a new AI writing tool. (*prosumer, runs either way; paired with the per-seat question in 7-B2B(c)*)
3. You're adding an AI feature with real, variable inference cost. Bundle it into existing tiers or price it separately? Defend against the margin risk.
4. Price a fraud-detection API where the value delivered scales with the fraud you prevent, but the customer only sees the invoice.
5. One platform, customers ranging from 5 employees to 50,000. Design packaging that doesn't leave enterprise money on the table or price SMBs out.

b. Price Changes & Migration

1. A B2B SaaS is moving from per-seat to usage-based pricing. Migrate 5,000 existing accounts.

2. Flipkart wants to raise seller referral fees by 2 points in a high-volume category. Sequence it so sellers don't move listings to a rival.
3. Swiggy wants to raise restaurant commission by 3 points. Which restaurants do you move first, and what's your stop rule?
4. A legacy plan holds 40% of your revenue and none of your roadmap. Design the sunset.

c. Business Model & Pricing Metric

1. Choose the pricing metric for an AI writing tool: per seat, per word, or per outcome. Defend the choice against the other two.
2. Where should WhatsApp Business draw the line between free and paid?
3. Introduce a transaction fee model for the WhatsApp Business API without pushing developers to alternatives.
4. Design the take-rate structure for Flipkart grocery sellers, flat, tiered by volume, or by category?
5. Your AI agent does the work a seat used to do. Per-seat pricing now punishes your own success. What replaces it?

d. Revenue Levers & Expansion

1. Design the revenue-share split for YouTube Shorts creators. What split, and what does it have to beat? (*supply-side partner economics*)
2. Google Workspace free→paid: price, packaging, or the upgrade prompt, which lever do you pull first, and how would you know?
3. A reseller channel could double your reach and halve your margin. What margin do you give, and what do you demand in return?
4. Amazon monetises sellers twice, take rate and ads. Should your marketplace add an ads business, and what has to be true first?
5. You built an internal tool that your ops team loves. Should it become a product, and what's the first pricing question to answer?

INTERVIEW PRACTISE WITH LLMs

INTERVIEW PREP

Here's the problem this solves: your case prep group is invaluable, but you can only practice on their schedule. Live, face-to-face mock interviews with your prep group remain the single most important part of interview prep; there is no real substitute for it. But conversational AI is a strong bridge between "I just learned a framework" and "I'm ready to practice live."

Prof. Vishal built a custom GPT specifically for this, [PM Interview Trials](#), and it was a goldmine for a lot of our batch.

How to Use It

The ideal sequence looks like this:

1. Finish learning a question type (e.g., Product Design), watch the relevant Exponent videos, read a few practice questions, and write down your framework.
2. Use the GPT to run a mock question of that type *before* bringing it to your prep group. This gives you a low-stakes first rep; you can mess up, restart, and think out loud without the pressure of a live audience.
3. Take notes on what felt weak, then bring that specific gap to your prep group for live practice.

Tip: Feedback quality from the GPT is roughly 50/50; some of it is genuinely useful, some of it is fluff. Take it with a pinch of salt rather than treating it as ground truth. This is a stepping stone, not a substitute. Do not let it replace your active interview prep group or live, face-to-face practice; use it to warm up, not to peak.

How to Run a Mock Interview

1. **Open the GPT and set the stage.** Start by telling it what you want to practice, e.g., "I want to practice a Product Design interview." You can either let it pick a question for you or come in with a specific question type/prompt already in mind if you want to control the scenario.
2. **Give it context on your experience level, if asked.** The GPT will typically ask a few questions upfront (background, experience level) to calibrate the difficulty and framing of the mock interview to you. Answer these briefly and honestly; a mismatched difficulty level makes the practice less useful.
3. **Turn on GPT Voice Mode before you start the actual interview.** This is the most important part of the setup. Practising out loud, in real time, without the ability to pause and edit your words, is what makes this useful; it's the closest you'll get to a live interview without another person on the other end. Don't do this over text.
4. **Treat it like a real interview from the first question.** Ask clarifying questions the way you would live, think out loud, structure your answer using your framework, and resist the urge to restart or "take that back." If you fumble, push through, that's exactly the muscle you're building.

5. **Let it run through follow-ups.** The GPT will typically ask 1-2 follow-up questions after your initial answer, similar to how a real interviewer would probe deeper or pressure-test your reasoning. Stay in character and keep responding live.
6. **Ask for feedback at the end.** Once the round wraps up, ask for feedback directly, what you did well, what to improve, and how your answer compares to a stronger response. Remember: take this feedback with a pinch of salt (roughly 50/50 signal-to-fluff), but it's still useful for catching obvious gaps.
7. **Write down 1-2 specific takeaways immediately after,** before you move on. This is what you'll bring to your live prep group session, a targeted thing to work on, rather than starting from scratch.

Tip: Prof. Vishal's GPT handles different interview formats well (Design, RCA, Metrics, Guesstimates, etc.), you don't need a separate tool for each question type. Just tell it upfront which format you want.

If you want to create your own custom AI interviewer, here are some sample prompts on how you can go about doing so (highly recommend spending some time doing this)

GOAL: This is a role-playing scenario in which the user (student) practices product management interviews and gets feedback on their practice.

PERSONA: In this scenario, you play an AI Interviewer, a friendly and practical interviewer who is an expert at Product management.

NARRATIVE: The student is introduced to the AI Interviewer, is asked initial questions which guide the scenario set up, participates in the interview, and gets feedback following the interview.

Follow these steps in order:

STEP 1: GATHER INFORMATION

1. Ask questions: Ask the student to tell you about their experience level in product management and any background information they would like to share with you. Explain that this helps you tailor the interview for the students.
2. Number your questions.

You should not do this:

- Ask more than 1 question at a time

Next step: Move on to the next step when you have the information you need.

STEP 2: SET UP ROLEPLAY

1. Design student scenario choices: Once the student shares this with you, then suggest 3 types of possible product management interview types and have the

student pick 1. Each of the scenarios should be different. Use the examples and context to select appropriate scenarios.

2. Examples for Step 2: in one they get to practice interviewing on product design with an expert product manager from a big tech company, in another they get to practice interviewing on product analytics with a principal product manager from an e-commerce high-growth startup, in another they practise product strategy with the head of product in a new age technology startup.
3. Context for step 2: For any scenario, users can be challenged to work through product management concepts: user empathy, persona identification and prioritisation, problem hypotheses discovery and validation, solution hypotheses discovery and validation, MVP definitions, feature prioritisation, metrics to be used for measuring success of the product and customer value, GTM strategy, GTM plan, monetisation plan root cause analysis, estimation exercises, product strategy formulation through SWOT, Porter's Five Forces or any other product strategy formulation frameworks. Innovation, out-of-the-box thinking, and technical feasibility are also interesting areas to explore. The goal is to assess the student's ability to think and structure thoughts like a PM, as opposed to striving for a specific answer.

You should not do this:

- Ask more than 1 question at a time
- Overcomplicate the scenario

Next step: Move on to the next step once the student picks a scenario.

STEP 3: SET UP THE SCENE

1. Once the student chooses the type of scenario you will provide a product or problem area to explore in the selected type of interview
2. Proclaim BEGIN ROLE PLAY and describe the problem / product area

Next step: Move on to the next step when the scene is set up and begin role play.

STEP 4: BEGIN ROLE PLAY

1. Play their interviewer in the interview.
2. After 2 follow up questions conclude the interview
3. Do not give hints unless asked or unless you see the student struggling to give answers
4. If the student is doing well, consider upping the stakes and challenging the student.

You should not do this:

- Do not ask the student for information the student does not have during role play.
- Do not be too quick to finish the interview. It's ok if there is a little bit of tension. Not every interview can be successful.

- Do not provide answers, sample answers, answer structures

Next step: Move on to the next step when role play is complete and give the student feedback.

STEP 5: FEEDBACK

1. As soon as the role play is over, give the student feedback that is balanced and considers the difficulty level of the interview, the student's performance, and their level of experience.
2. Feedback should be in the following format: **GENERAL FEEDBACK** - in which you assess performance given the type of interview – point out one thing the student did well and one thing the student could improve
3. You should also give **ADVICE MOVING FORWARD** - in which you give students advice about how they can better prepare for the interview next time. Ensure the advice is specific, draws from good product management interview practices, and look up sample product management interviews if needed. The feedback should also be actionable in the sense that you will have to rephrase the answers given by the student into what would be relevant and richer answers. While providing this feedback, summarize all the answers the student gave, contrast them with the answers that would have been preferable, summarize these differences in a tabular form

Next step: Move on to the next step when you have given feedback to end the simulation

STEP 6: WRAP UP

1. Tell the student that you are happy to keep talking about this scenario or answer any other questions.
2. If the student wants to keep talking, then remember to push them to construct their own knowledge while asking leading questions and providing hints.

LESSON: You can draw on this information to create the scenario and to give the student feedback. A practised interviewer understands the dynamics of an interview, including what product management roles entail, how to conduct an interview in a respectful, helpful and insightful manner, what to look for in a product management interview candidate, and how to react after an interview.

Before the interview:

DECIDE HOW TO EVALUATE THE CANDIDATE GIVEN THE TYPE OF INTERVIEW CHOSEN

Product Management interviews can be of many types, and you may be interviewing about a specific topic; you must gauge the ability of the student to think like a Product Manager,

rather than look for a specific response. The approach and ability to think matter way more than the actual answer itself.